

JAMES HADOW

THE RECORD OF GOD AND DUTY OF FAITH

THEREIN REQUIRED

&

THE ANTINOMIANISM

OF THE

MARROW OF MODERN DIVINITY DETECTED

Two Works on Faith and the Marrow Controversy

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THE

RECORD OF GOD

AND

DUTY OF FAITH

THEREIN REQUIRED

A SERMON

ON 1 JOHN V. 11, 12

BEFORE THE SYNOD OF FIFE

AT ST. ANDREW'S, APRIL 7TH, 1719

JAMES HADOW

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TO

THE RIGHT REVEREND,

THE MODERATOR

AND THE

REVEREND AND WORTHY

THE MINISTERS AND ELDERS

OF

THE SYNOD OF FIFE

This Sermon, published at their Desire, is humbly offered by,

JA. HADOW.

THE RECORD OF GOD AND DUTY OF FAITH

1 JOHN V. 11, 12

And this is the Record, that God hath given to us eternal Life: and this Life is in his Son.

He that hath the Son hath Life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not Life.

MINISTERS of the Gospel are in Scripture called *Watchmen, Stewards, Ambassadors*. These honourable Titles import a Trust committed unto them, which requires Diligence and Faithfulness in the discharge of it. And the Things they are entrusted with are very precious and valuable; such as, the immortal Souls of Men, whereof they are Watchmen, *Heb. xiii. 17; the* Mysteries of God, whereof they are Stewards, *1 Cor. iv. 1, 2; and* particularly, the Word of Reconciliation, *2 Cor. v. 19*. It is on account of this Word of Reconciliation committed unto them, that they are called Ambassadors for Christ, *ver*. 20. And it is the Part of Ambassadors to keep by their Instructions. Ministers, the Ambassadors of God, ought to be well assured, that what they deliver in his Name is agreeable to his Mind: they should not vent their own Notions for Gospel and Divine Oracles. For the Gospel is the Truth of God, the Doctrine of Salvation, which Ministers are to preach, and People to believe and obey, as the Word and Record of God; a short Sum whereof is contained in the Passage we have chosen on this Occasion: *And this is the Record*, &c.

In these Words we may take notice of three Things.

I. There is a brief Account of the Way of the Recovery and Salvation of lost Sinners: *That God hath given to us eternal Life; and this Life is in his Son. And he that hath the Son hath Life, and he that hath not the Son of God hath not Life*.

II. There is the special Quality and Respect in which it is declared and proposed unto us, *viz*. as Truth which God himself bears Witness unto: *And this is the Record*.

III. There is implied our Duty with Respect thereunto, *viz. Believing*. For if this be a Truth unto which God himself gives Evidence and Testimony, then ought we to believe and receive it as such. And it is also clear from the Context, where believing this Record is commended as a Duty, ver. 9; and the not believing it is condemned as most injurious to God, in making him a Liar, *ver*. 10.

These are the three Heads that we propose at this time, through the Lord's Assistance, to discourse of. And they are Matters of that high Importance, that both Ministers and People ought diligently and reverently to enquire into them, that they may be acquainted with them.

The first contains these Truths concerning God in Christ, which are the Object of justifying and saving Faith.

The second respects the Ground and Reason of this Faith, the Record of God. And the third respects our Duty, *viz*. believing: on which Head we shall enquire into these Actings of this Faith, whereby we get an Interest in Christ and eternal Life through him.

HEAD I.

The first Head is expressed in these Words, *That God hath given to us eternal Life*, &*c*. wherein we have three Branches that deserve our serious Consideration.

1. The Spring and Fountain of the Recovery and Salvation of lost Sinners, God the Father giving eternal Life unto them.

2. The great Means through whom God of his Love and free Grace doth communicate and convey eternal Life; this is his Son Jesus Christ the Mediator: *And this Life is in his Son, not in the first Adam.*

3. The Way on our Part, whereby we are made Partakers of this eternal Life freely given through Christ the Son; and that is by an Interest in Christ the Son. He *that hath the Son hath Life: and he that hath not the Son of God hath not Life*.

Time doth not allow to enlarge upon these Things, which comprehend the Marrow of the Gospel and Mystery of Salvation. And therefore we shall only consider the Import of the Words, wherein they are expressed by the divinely inspired Apostle.

BRANCH I. *GOD HATH GIVEN TO US ETERNAL LIFE.*

Here, (1.) the great Benefit, *eternal Life*; (2.) the Granter and Bestower of it, *God*; (3.) the Way of Conveyance, by Gift, *given*; (4.) the Persons to whom it is given, indefinitely, to us.

As to the Import of the Phrase, when it is said that God hath given to us eternal Life, it implieth,

(1.) That Man, by the Entry of Sin, is destitute of eternal Life, and all Claim to it. *For* all *have sinned and come short of the Glory of God*, Rom. iii. 23; all have failed of attaining the Glory of eternal Life, which God promised in the first Covenant, and are in a most miserable Estate, dead in Trespasses and Sins, and Children of Wrath by Nature, *Eph. ii. 1, 2, 3*.

(2.) That as our Recovery from this miserable Condition, and the bringing us into eternal Happiness, is from God alone; so he is not moved thereto from the Consideration of any good Thing in us, but of his own Love and Mercy he gives eternal Life. It is his free Gift. All Love begins on his Part, and not on ours, *1 Joh. iv. 8, 9, 10*, and *Tit*. iii. 4, *5: After that the Kindness and Love of God our Saviour toward Man appeared, not by Works of Righteousness which we have done, but according* to *his Mercy he saved* us. That all might be to the Praise of the Glory of his Grace, *Eph*. i. 6.

(3.) These Words, *God hath given* eternal Life, in the past Time, as they import a Purpose in God of saving lost Sinners; so they hold forth the Certainty of the Accomplishment

thereof; that eternal Life shall be surely and actually conferred upon all those unto whom God hath designed it. So *Rom. viii. 30: Moreover, whom he did predestinate, them also he glorified*; i.e. will surely glorify.

(4.) As these Words contain a Declaration of the immutable Counsel of God concerning the Salvation of Sinners and eternal Life; so God may be said to give it, (1.) By Promise: Of the heavenly Inheritance it is said, *Gal. iii. 18, God gave it to Abraham by Promise. So 1 Joh. ii. 25, And this is the Promise that he hath promised us, even eternal Life. (2.) By an Act of Grace*, when he gives them a Right unto it in Justification and Adoption. For in Justification God adjudgeth eternal Life unto Believers, or gives them a Right unto it, *Rom. v. 17, 18: They that receive abundance of Grace, and of the Gift of Righteousness, shall reign in Life. And by the Righteousness of one, the free Gift comes upon all Men unto Justification of Life*. And by Adoption Believers are made Heirs, *Rom. viii. 17: And if Children, then Heirs*. And they are conjoined, Tit. *iii. 7: That being justified by his Grace, we should be made Heirs, according to the Hope of eternal Life*. (3.) By bringing the Heirs of Promise into the Possession of eternal Life, which Life is begun in Grace here, and perfected in Glory hereafter, *Joh. xi. 26*: Whosoever *liveth and believeth in me shall never die*. Col. iii. *3, 4: Your Life is hid with Christ in God. When Christ, who is our Life, shall appear, then shall ye also appear with him in* Glory.

(5.) To us importeth, that this Gift of eternal Life is not given to all and every one of fallen Mankind: for all are not brought into the Possession of it, neither have *all* a Right to it by Justification and Adoption, neither is the absolute Promise, which is declarative of the eternal Purpose of God, made unto all. For though it be sometimes proposed indefinitely, yet it is to be understood as made unto God's Elect, whom he hath given unto the Son, and who shall come unto him, Joh. vi. 37; and to Christ's Sheep, of whom he saith, *Joh*. x. *27, 28: I give unto them eternal Life, and they shall never perish*. And as to the conditional Promise, *He that believeth shall be saved, it is* made to

Believers only, exclusively of others. And so the Apostle shows in the following 12th *Verse, He that hath not the Son hath not* Life.

(6.) This Phrase, *God hath given*, &c. imports also that God hath likewise, of his condescending Love and Grace, provided and given all Means requisite for rendering this his Gift effectual. Thus he hath given his Gospel and Ministers to publish it; his Calls, Exhortations, Commands, Promises, Threatenings, and all Gospel Ordinances to be Means of conveying it. And particularly he hath given the great Means, the blessed Mediator, his only begotten Son, that he might purchase this Life to Sinners by his Obedience unto the Death, and effectually apply it by his Spirit of Grace, *Joh. iii. 16; Rom.* viii. 32; 1 *Joh.* iv. 9, 10; which is the greatest Pledge of his Love and Grace, *Rom. v. 8. And* this leads us to,

BRANCH II. ***And this Life is in his Son.***

ἐν τῷ υἱῷ αὐτοῦ, *in or by his Son. It is* laid up in Christ the Mediator, and put into his Hand, with all Stores of Grace requisite thereunto, *Col. i. 19: It pleased the Father that in him should all Fulness dwell. He is full of Grace and Truth*, Joh. i. 14. And this Life is so in the Son, that by and through him it may be conveyed and made effectual to lost Sinners, *Joh. i. 16: Of his Fulness we all receive. Joh. xvii. 2: Thou hast given him Power over all Flesh, that he might give eternal Life to as many as thou hast given him.*

It is in the Son, and so it is better secured than when entrusted to the first *Adam*. So this Phrase imports, that God the Father hath appointed his Son to be the Saviour of the World, *1 Joh. iv. 14; and this* Life is in him as its Author. Hence he is called ἀρχηγὸς τῆς ζωῆς, Acts iii. 15, *The Prince* (or Author) of *Life; and* ἀρχηγὸς τῆς σωτηρίας, *Heb. ii. 10, The Captain of Salvation*, as our Version hath it; and αἴτιος σωτηρίας αἰωνίου, *Heb. v. 9, The Author of* eternal *Salvation*. And he is so both by Purchase and effectual Application. (1.)

He, by his Blood, purchaseth the Pardon of Sin and Deliverance from Wrath, *Eph. i. 7; and by* his Obedience he purchaseth eternal Life, and a Right to it, *Rom. v. 19: By the Obedience of one shall many be made righteous*. And he purchaseth all Grace whereby his People are made meet for the Possession of this Life, even the Grace of Faith itself, *Phil. i. 29: For unto you it is given in the behalf of Christ, not only to believe on him*, &*c. (2.) He* effectually applies and gives out his purchased Salvation unto all for whom he hath procured *it, Joh. x. 27, 28: My Sheep hear my Voice, and I give unto them eternal Life*. This he doth by his Intercession, Heb. vii. 25; and by sending his Spirit to convince and renew them, and prepare them for the purchased Glory, *Joh. xvi. 13, 14: Howbeit when the Spirit of Truth is come, he will guide you into all Truth: He shall glorify me; for he shall receive of mine, and show it unto you*. The Spirit worketh Faith in them, and thereby uniteth them to Christ, whereby they come to have Interest in him, and in all his rich Purchase. And this brings us to,

BRANCH III. *He that hath the Son* hath *Life, and he that hath not the Son of God hath not Life.*

To have the Son is to be united to him, and have Interest in him as Mediator. To have eternal Life is to have an Interest in it and a Right unto it. And the having of Life is inferred from the having of the Son, and that exclusively of others that have him not. So that,

The Words import, 1. That there is an inseparable Connection betwixt an Interest in Christ, and a Right unto eternal Life.

2. That though God of his Love and Grace doth freely give to Sinners this Life, yet he hath committed the dispensing of all Grace and Glory unto Christ the Mediator: so that he hath appointed an Interest in Christ his Son to be the Way of Sinners attaining unto eternal Life.

3. That this is the only Way, exclusive of all others; for *he that hath not the Son of God hath not Life. Vide* Acts iv. 12.

That which is required of us, in order to our having the Son, or our Union with and Interest in him, is Faith, as is evident from *Joh. iii. 36: He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting Life*, &c. of which afterwards.

Now these Truths, containing a Sum of the Gospel, are proposed unto us as the *Record* of God; and this is what we formerly mentioned as,

HEAD II.

This is the Record, i.e. This is the Truth recorded. In the Original it is μαρτυρία, which ver. 9 is rendered, *the Witness* of *God*; and *1 Cor. ii. 1 there is* an alike Word, τὸ μαρτύριον, and there it is translated, *the* Testimony *of God*. So that these Things are Truths, which God, who cannot lie, bears Witness of, and gives Testimony unto.

The Words import that the Gospel is a Doctrine which proceeds from God, who is Truth itself, and sovereign Lord of the Souls and Consciences of Men; and so it bears upon it the Stamp of his Veracity and Authority.

Hence, 1. The divine Doctrine concerning the Salvation of Sinners can be known only by divine Revelation. Wherefore I see no ground for asserting, that Men, from the Light of Nature and Works of Creation and Providence, may know that there is a Remedy provided. For God's Design to give eternal Life, and his providing a Remedy unto fallen Mankind, do not necessarily flow from his Nature, but are sovereign Acts of his free Love and Grace, and cannot be discovered but by his own Testimony and Record concerning them.

2. If Gospel Truth be the Record of God, then ought we to receive it as such. The Veracity and Authority of God bring us under Obligation to receive it. And we ought to receive it with that Faith which contains an acknowledging of his Veracity

and Authority. Joh. iii. 33: He *that hath received his Testimony hath set to his Seal that God is true*. Here is an acknowledging of the divine Veracity. 1 Joh. iii. 23: *And this is his Commandment, that we should believe*, &*c*. Here, in believing, there must be an owning the divine Authority. And therefore whatever other Knowledge Men may have of sacred Truths, if their Assent unto them be not upon divine Testimony, if it want this owning of the divine Veracity and Authority, it is not that Faith which God requires in the Gospel.

3. The Ground and Reason of that Faith, by which we are required to assent unto revealed Truths, is and ought to be the Veracity and Authority of God bearing Witness unto them. And therefore divine Faith should not be resolved into the Authority of Men, or into the Principle of human Reason, or evident Propositions naturally revealed; but into the Authority of the divine Record evidencing its own Original. Hence the *Thessalonians* are commended, 1 *Thess*. ii. 13.

HEAD III.

The Duty which this Record of God calleth us unto is the receiving it as such; the receiving it, not as the Word of Men, but (as it is in Truth) the Word of God, 1 Thess. ii. 13. And this is *Believing*. The not believing it excludes Sinners from this eternal Life, and leaves them under the Wrath of God, Joh. iii. 36. Seeing therefore the believing this Record of God, concerning eternal Life in his Son, is the Duty required of us, in order unto our Justification and Salvation; we shall here enquire what this Believing is, or what are these Acts of Faith, which give us an Interest in the Son and eternal Life through him? And,

1. In this Faith there is an Assent of the Mind unto the Truth of this Record of God. We are bound by its divine Authority to receive it as Truth. And this Assent is so necessary, that without it there can be no justifying, saving Faith. *For he that*

believeth not God hath made him a Liar, because he believeth not the Record that God gave of his Son, 1 Joh. v. 10.

Some maintain that this bare Assent is all that belongs to justifying Faith. *Socinians* will have this Act of Faith, with our own personal Obedience comprehended in it, to be that Righteousness upon account whereof we are justified before God. Arminians hold that this Assent, as it is an Act of Obedience and contains a Purpose of further Obedience, is graciously accepted of God for our Justification, in place of that perfect Obedience required in the Law. Some modern Divines run much the same Way. Dr. *Whitby*, in his Paraphrase and Commentary on the New Testament, and particularly in his Preface unto the Epistle to the *Galatians*, contends that "*Faith in the Matter of Justification, is only a cordial and firm Belief, or a full Assent to, or firm Persuasion of Mind concerning the Truth of what is testified of our Lord Jesus Christ, viz*. That he *is the true Messiah, the Son of God and Saviour* of *the World*." And whereas our Confession of Faith, chap. xiv. § 2, asserts, *That the principal Acts of saving Faith are, accepting, receiving and resting upon Christ alone for Justification; he* rejects this as a false and unscriptural Description of Faith. And indeed, according to the Doctor's Principles, he cannot admit of these Acts into the Notion of Faith. For (1.) His Opinion is, that Justification, in the Sense of the Apostle Paul, importeth only the Remission of Sins past under the old Covenant, and not God's accepting us as righteous in his Sight, or adjudging Life eternal unto us. (2.) That Faith alone, without a Course of sincere Obedience included in it, is the Condition of this Justification; and that the Assent of Faith, or the Act of Believing, is imputed to us for Righteousness: and so Faith justifies as it is our Act, and not as it receives Christ and his Righteousness. (3.) That a Right to eternal Life must be obtained by our own personal sincere Obedience and Perseverance, as the Conditions of the New Covenant. And (4.) That there is no Imputation of the Righteousness or active Obedience of Christ unto us in our Justification before God. And so, having excluded the

Obedience of Christ from our Justification, and his Righteousness from being the Ground of our Acceptance with God, and of our obtaining a Right unto eternal Life, he finds no Place for such Actings of Faith as *accepting, receiving and resting on Christ alone for Justification*. This Scheme is subversive of the received Doctrine of the Reformed Churches, and I hope is not taught by any in the Communion of this Church. I shall therefore only endeavour briefly to vindicate our Confession of Faith in this Matter. Wherefore,

2. Besides this Assent of the Mind unto the Truth of the Record of God, *the principal* Acts *of saving Faith are, accepting, receiving and resting upon Christ alone for Justification, Sanctification and eternal Life*. For clearing and confirming this, consider,

(1.) This Record; wherein (as we explained it before) there is the Record or Testimony, and the Thing recorded or testified, which is that Way which God, in his Wisdom, Love and Grace, hath appointed for the Recovery and Salvation of lost Sinners, *viz. That God hath* given *eternal Life*, &c. Now, in answer to this Record of God, the convinced, sensible Sinner not only gives his Assent unto the Truth of the Record itself, but also accounts the Way therein proposed to be good, suited unto the Glory of the Grace of God, and safe for him to venture upon, and the only Way he must betake himself unto, with a forsaking of all other Ways. And further, in the Exercise of Faith, he approves of this Way in his Heart, he is satisfied with it, and accordingly betakes himself to it. And thus there is in saving Faith an accepting of that Way of eternal Life proposed in the Record of God.

Moreover, seeing God hath placed this Life in his Son, as the Author and Purchaser of it by his Sufferings and Obedience unto the Death, and proposeth him, in this Way of Salvation, as the great Means of communicating and conveying his Gift of eternal Life unto perishing Sinners: the convinced Sinner, destitute of all Righteousness of his own, must *accept, receive and rest* on Christ the Son of God, as thus

proposed unto him. *Lastly*, in this Way of Salvation, our having Life is appointed to be by having the Son. Now, how can we have the Son, and an Interest in him as the Author of eternal Life, unless we heartily accept of this Way of Salvation, and receive him as thus proposed unto us? And if we receive him as an all-sufficient Saviour, we may also trust in him and rest upon him for Justification and eternal Life, and all Things requisite thereunto. And by believing on the Son, we have that Interest in him unto which eternal Life is annexed, Joh. iii. 36. So that believing on him importeth more than a bare Assent unto the Truth of his being the *Messiah*, however firm it may be. From all which we may see, that the Thing recorded, the Way of Salvation proposed as the Object of justifying and saving Faith, doth require and lead us unto these principal Acts of accepting and approving of that Way, and of receiving and resting on Christ and his Mediation for Justification and eternal Life. Consider,

(2.) The Descriptions given in holy Scripture of justifying, saving Faith, which plainly import these Acts of accepting, receiving and resting on Christ for Justification and Life. As,

(1.) It is described and expressed by believing in Christ *for* Remission of Sins through his Name, *Acts* x. 43; and by believing on him for Salvation, Acts xvi. 31; and in many other Places. Now this believing in and on Christ implies more than a firm Assent unto the Truth of his being the sent *Messiah* and Saviour of Sinners. For the Devils believe with this Faith of Assent. They believe that there is one God, *Jam*. ii. 19; and so believe the Things revealed of God concerning Christ to be true. But the Faith whereby a Sinner is justified must have more in it than the Faith of Devils. God doth not give eternal Life unto Devils, nor propose the Way of their Recovery and Salvation through Jesus Christ; and therefore they are not called to believe on him. But Christ, and the Way of Salvation through him, is proposed unto Sinners of Mankind, for their Recovery and eternal Life; and therefore are they called to believe on him, by approving of this Way, closing with it, and

betaking themselves to Christ therein set forth unto them. And this plainly imports that accepting, *receiving and resting on Christ* are the principal Acts of saving Faith. 1 *Tim. i. 15: This is a faithful Saying, and worthy of all Acceptation, that Christ Jesus came into the World to save* Sinners. Not merely this Saying itself is worthy of Acceptation, but the Thing contained and proposed in the Saying, *viz*. That Jesus Christ came to save Sinners. And therefore Christ, as come on this Design, must be accepted by Faith.

(2.) Faith, as justifying and saving, is expressed by receiving Christ, *Joh. i. 12: To as many as received him*, &*c. So Col. ii. 6; by* receiving the Atonement in his Blood, *Rom*. v. 11; by receiving abundance of Grace, and of the Gift of Righteousness, *Rom. v. 17, 18*, 19. Christ being thus tendered in the Gospel for the Relief of perishing Sinners, that Act of Faith which answers to this Tender must be a principal Act; and this is *Receiving*. And the wilful rejecting of him, and this Way of Salvation through him, even the not *receiving* him, is Unbelief, Joh. i. 11, and v. 45.

(3.) It is frequently expressed by trusting and staying upon the Lord, especially in the Old Testament, Job xiii. 15: *Though he slay me, yet will I trust in him. Isa. l. 10: Let him trust in the Name of the Lord, and stay upon his God. Ps. ii. 12: Kiss the Son; blessed are all they that put their Trust in him*. And surely this imports a receiving of Christ and resting on him for these Blessings, for which he is proposed and tendered unto us.

The same is imported when Faith is expressed by looking, Isa. xlv. 22; and coming to Christ, *Matt. xi. 28; Joh. vi. 35; by* flying for Refuge and laying hold on the Hope set before us, *Heb*. vi. 18; and embracing the Promises, *Heb. xi*. 13. And these might be further insisted on; but what hath been said may evince, that the Compilers of our Confession have given no false and unscriptural Description of saving Faith, when they affirm that its *principal* Acts *are accepting, receiving and resting upon Christ alone for Justification, Sanctification and eternal Life*.

3. There is another Act, which is commonly called the Faith of *Assurance*, whereby a Believer is persuaded of his particular Interest in Christ and his Mediation, that his Sins are pardoned for Christ's Sake, and that he hath Interest in eternal Life, and shall certainly be saved through Christ. And there is Ground for this in the Record of God, which we have explained. For herein it is said, *He that hath the Son hath Life*. Now it is supposed that a Believer may know that he *hath the Son*, and that he hath truly believed on Christ, and therefore may conclude and be persuaded that eternal Life belongeth unto him. For this is a Part of the Record of God, that he *that hath the Son hath Life, and he that believeth on the Son hath everlasting Life*, Joh. iii. 36. This is confirmed from the 13th *Verse*, the Words immediately following our Text, where the Apostle intimates his Scope in writing this Epistle: These *Things* (saith *he) have I written unto you that believe on the Name of the Son of God, that ye may know that ye have eternal Life*. This Knowledge then and Persuasion is attainable, and it is the Duty of a Believer to endeavour it and seek after it. Yea, I shall say further, that this Faith of Assurance is necessary, not only unto the Believer's Comfort, but also for the right performing of several Duties he is called to in the Course of new Obedience according to the Gospel. This we maintain against *Papists, Socinians, Arminians*, and all the *Pelagian* Brood; who, from their preconceived Principles concerning the Power of Free-will, and the final Apostasy of the Saints, do deny that Believers ought to make particular Application of the Promises of Forgiveness and eternal Life, to assure their own Interest therein.

But it may be enquired, if this be an essential Act of justifying Faith, which Sinners are immediately called unto, upon the first Proposal of the Gospel and Record of God unto them? We answer, that it is indeed a Fruit and Consequent of justifying Faith; but we deny that it is absolutely necessary and essential thereto. We dare not exclude all from a saving Interest in Christ who have not yet attained unto a full Assurance of their own Pardon and Salvation. For the

Scripture shows us that there may be some *who fear the Lord and obey the Voice of his* Servant, *and yet walk in Darkness and have no Light*; who, meanwhile, are exhorted to *trust in the Name of the Lord and stay themselves upon their God*, Isa. l. 10.

Some seem to have been of another Mind, and particularly Mr. *Marshall* on Sanctification, and the Author *of the Marrow of Modern Divinity*. Perhaps it may not be well taken, that I have mentioned this last Book. But seeing some have been at so much Pains, by Word and Print, to recommend and defend it, I may use the like Liberty to take notice of what I judge to be amiss in it. *The Marrow of Modern Divinity is* blamed (and I think justly) for defining Faith in Terms which import Assurance. In Vindication of it, in a late Pamphlet, it is answered, 1st. That Mr. Marshall *upon Sanctification demonstrates very clearly and fully, that somewhat of Assurance is an essential Ingredient of Faith*. Here is a plain Approbation of Mr. *Marshall* in that Opinion. But I must own I think his Demonstration neither clear nor full. I shall make only one Remark upon it: He maintains, *page* 178, that the Thing we are bound by the Command of God to believe (viz. *that God freely giveth Christ and Salvation to* us *particularly*) is not a Truth before we believe it. This, in my Opinion, is an Imputation upon the Honour and Purity of God, as if by his Authority he obliged his Creature to believe what is not true before it be believed. It is also a Reflection upon the Record of God, as if its Truth did not depend upon his own Veracity and Faithfulness, but upon a Man's giving Credit to it, or persuading himself of it: for I suppose that what a Man is commanded to believe is the Record of God. The 2nd Answer is, That *the Marrow doth not make Assurance essential to Faith*. And this is a Denial of the Charge laid against it. Wherefore, to clear this Matter, I shall, 1. Show the Opinion taught by this Author from his own Words. 2. I shall point out what I think unsound and blameable therein. And, 3. I shall offer some Grounds why this his Doctrine ought not to be received.
1. In this Book, called *the Marrow of Modern Divinity* (page 118,

119 of the *Edinburgh* Edition), *Evangelista*, or the Gospel Minister, is brought in explaining the Nature and Terms of the Covenant of Grace, in opposition to the Law or Covenant of Works, *viz. That in the Covenant of Grace there is not any Condition or Law to be performed on Man's Part by himself; no, there is no more for him to do, but only to know and believe that Christ hath done all for him*. Then, turning his Speech unto *Neophytus*, he saith, *Here ye are to work nothing, here ye are to do nothing, here ye are to render nothing unto God, but only to receive the Treasure, which is Jesus Christ, and apprehend him in your Heart by Faith. Again, Nothing cometh betwixt but Faith only, apprehending Christ in the Promise*. Wherefore, as Paul *and Silas said to the Jailer, so say I unto you*, Believe on the Lord Jesus, and thou shalt be saved. Then he gives his Gloss on these Words of the Apostle, *Believe*, &*c. That* is (saith he), be verily *persuaded in your Heart, that Jesus Christ is yours, and that you shall have Life and Salvation by him; that whatsoever Christ did for the Redemption of Mankind, he did it for you*. And in the Foot of the Page there is marked upon this, A Definition of Faith.

Here it is plain, (1.) That this Author speaks of that Faith whereby a Sinner hath Interest in Christ, and is entered into the Covenant of Grace: that Faith which a convinced Sinner, such as the Jailer was, is directly and immediately called unto by the Gospel; that Faith which the *awakened* Sinner is exhorted to, in answer to that weighty Question, What *shall* I do to be *saved*? And that Faith which hath Salvation annexed to it. And therefore it is justifying, saving Faith itself that he treats of, and not any Fruit or Consequent of it. (2.) All the Acts that he ascribes to Faith, such as receiving Christ, apprehending him in the Heart by Faith, knowing and believing, he explains to be a Sinner's persuading himself of his particular Interest in Christ and his purchased Salvation. For, in giving the Sense and Meaning of this Gospel Call, *Believe*, &c., he says, *That* is, be verily persuaded, &c. (3.) He makes the Object of justifying Faith, proposed to a Sinner in the Gospel, to *be, Jesus Christ is yours; you shall be saved by him;*

whatsoever Christ did for the Redemption of Mankind, he did it for you. And he makes the Act of saving Faith, as answering unto the Object proposed, to be a firm Persuasion thereof. Believe, &c., that is, be verily persuaded. (4.) For a Foundation of this Faith, or firm Persuasion, he supposeth some kind of universal Redemption, and thereupon a Gift and Promise of eternal Life to Mankind; and that every one under the Gospel Dispensation is called to make Application of this to himself in particular, and verily to persuade himself that whatsoever Christ did for the Redemption of Mankind was done for him, and that the Gift of eternal Life belongs to him in particular.

This will be more evident, if we shall consider what follows in the same Book. Neophytus, or the young Christian, puts the Question, Hath such a one as I any Warrant to believe in Christ? (that is, as above, to persuade myself that Jesus Christ is mine, &c.) *Evangelista* answers, *That God in Christ, of his free Love to Mankind lost, hath made a Deed of Gift and Grant* unto them all, *that whosoever of them all shall* believe in this his Son (that is, according to the above Definition, shall be verily persuaded in his Heart that Jesus Christ is his, that whatsoever Christ did for the Redemption of Mankind was done for him, and that he shall have Life and Salvation by Christ) shall *not perish, but* have eternal Life. And for Proof of this he cites our Lord's Words to his Disciples, *Mark* xvi. 15: *Go ye into all the World, and preach the Gospel to* every Creature. On which he gives this Comment, That is (*says he), go and tell every Man*, without *Exception, that here is good News for him, Christ is dead for him, and if he will take* him *and* accept his Righteousness (i.e. if he will be persuaded that Christ is his), he *shall have him. Therefore* (saith a godly Writer), forasmuch *as* the holy Scripture *speaketh to all in general, none of* us ought to distrust *himself, but believe that* it doth belong *particularly* to himself. Now, how can Ministers of the Gospel tell every Man, as the Truth of God, that Christ is dead for him, without the Supposition of an universal Redemption? This then is, in his Opinion, the general Warrant; and the particular Application

hereof is made by a Sinner's believing or being persuaded that it doth belong particularly to himself. And he illustrates this by a Simile of an earthly King giving a general Pardon to all his rebellious Subjects: Even so (saith he) hath God, for the Obedience and Desert of Jesus Christ, pardoned all our Sins. And so, in his Opinion, justifying Faith must be a Man's Persuasion that God, for Christ's Sake, hath pardoned all his Sins.

2. Having thus showed the Sentiments of this Author from his own Words, I come next to show what I conceive to be unsound and blameable therein. And, (1.) I think him faulty in making Assurance to be essential to saving Faith; yea, in making the very Essence and *formal Nature* of justifying, saving Faith to be a Man's persuading and assuring himself of his particular Interest in Christ and the Benefits of the New Covenant. (2.) I think him culpable in maintaining that every Man, upon the first Proposal of the Gospel, is by its Call and Command bound to believe directly and immediately that Christ is his, that his Sins are pardoned, and that he hath Right to eternal Life by him. (3.) I think it unsound to build this upon the Foundation of an universal Redemption, and Gift or Promise of eternal Life made unto all Men, or to assert that Ministers of the Gospel have Warrant from the Record of God to tell every one of their Hearers that Christ is dead for him. For divine Truth is the Object of Faith; and the God of Truth never commands any Man to believe a Lie.

3. I come now to offer some Grounds why this Doctrine ought not to be entertained. And I think it disagreeable both to the Word of God and to our Confession of Faith. And, to evince its Inconsistency with Scripture, I offer these Considerations.

(1.) Justifying Faith doth not consist in an Assurance of our Interest in Christ and eternal Life, nor is this Assurance essential unto it. Because the Apostle, in the Words of our Text, inferreth an Interest in eternal Life from an Interest in the Son: He *that hath the* Son *hath Life*. Wherefore he that hath

Assurance of his Interest in eternal Life must first know that he hath an Interest in the Son; and he gets this Interest in the Son by believing on him. And therefore saving Faith, which unites to Christ and gives Interest in him, must be prior to an Assurance of eternal Life. And ver. 13: *These* Things *have I written unto you that believe on the Name of the Son of God, that ye may know that ye have eternal Life*. Here their Assurance, or knowing that they have eternal Life, doth presuppose their believing on the Son of God, and therefore is a Consequent of this Faith, and not the Essence of it. Yea, the Apostle plainly supposeth that they may be Believers, though they have not yet attained unto the Knowledge of their having eternal Life. And therefore throughout this Epistle he gives many Marks whereby they might come to know that they were true Believers and born of God.

(2.) A Persuasion that we shall have Life and Salvation by Christ, if it be true, implieth a like Persuasion that we are pardoned, justified and adopted through Christ. Now Assurance must follow after an Interest in these Benefits; for a Man must be pardoned before he can be verily persuaded that he is so, unless he presume and deceive himself. But justifying Faith goes before these Benefits in order of Nature, and therefore must be prior unto, and distinct from, the true Assurance of them. Faith goeth before Pardon, which is promised upon believing, Acts x. 43: To him give all *the* Prophets Witness, that through *his* Name, whosoever believeth in him shall *receive Remission of Sins*. Justifying Faith is also prior to Justification, Gal. ii. 16: We have *believed in Jesus Christ, that we might be* justified by the Faith of Christ. When the Spirit beareth Witness with our Spirit that we are the Children of God, Rom. viii. 16, it is supposed that we are truly Children; for the Spirit of God doth not give Witness to an Untruth. But we are Children of God by Faith in Jesus Christ, *Gal. iii. 26; Joh. i.* 12. Therefore justifying Faith is before Adoption, and consequently Assurance of our Sonship is not essential to this Faith.

(3.) The principal and saving Acts of justifying Faith have their Object revealed in the Gospel, which is the Record of God concerning the *Way* of Salvation by Jesus Christ. But the Object of this Assurance is not revealed in the Gospel. This or that Man's particular Interest in Christ is not there recorded; it is nowhere testified in Scripture that *Thomas*, James or John have Remission of Sins, and a Right to the Gift of eternal Life. And Mr. *Marshall* himself acknowledges, page 178, that we have no absolute Promise or Declaration in Scripture that God certainly will, or doth, give Christ and his Salvation to any one of us in particular. Therefore this Assurance is none of the principal and saving Acts of justifying Faith.

(4.) The essential Acts of saving Faith are required of all that hear the Gospel, by that Call and Command that hath Salvation annexed to *it: Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and* thou shalt be *saved*. And every one to whom the Record of God concerning the Way of Salvation through Jesus is proposed becomes thereby bound, with a direct Act of Faith, to believe and betake himself unto this Way of Salvation for his Relief. But the Act of Assurance is not required of every one that hears the Gospel; neither is every Man to whom the Way of Salvation is proposed thereby bound directly to believe that Christ is his, that he hath Remission of Sins, and that eternal Life belongs to him in particular. For this is not true of every one of the Hearers of the Gospel, there being many who have not the Son of God, nor eternal Life through him. Wherefore this Assurance is not essential to that Faith which is required in the Gospel Command, *Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ*.

(5.) This Doctrine is not to be admitted, because of many Absurdities and Evils that would follow upon it. As, (1.) That Ministers would be thereby engaged to tell their Hearers that Christ is dead for every one of them without Exception, which would be a going beyond their Commission. (2.) This Doctrine leads to an universal Redemption; nor can the Defenders of it ever satisfyingly answer the *Arminian* Argument, *viz*. What every one is bound to believe, that is true: But every one (at

least of those to whom the Gospel is sent) is bound to believe that Christ died for him; therefore, &c. (3.) This Doctrine tends to a more gross Universalism, *viz*. That God by absolute Promise hath given eternal Life to all who live under the Gospel. For, without a Supposition of this, Ministers could have no Pretext to say to every one of their Hearers, *Be verily persuaded in your Heart that Christ is yours, and that you shall have Life and Salvation by him*; and this you are required to do by that *Command, Believe on the Lord Jesus* Christ. (4.) This Doctrine, which thus calls Men to believe Things that are not true, hath a Tendency towards that false Position, *That the God of Truth may by his Authority oblige Men to believe an Untruth*. (5.) It tends to the Discouragement of such who may be true Believers, but through Temptations or Desertions cannot attain unto an Assurance of their particular Interest in Christ and his Salvation. For such Persons by this Doctrine must conclude against themselves, that because they want this Assurance, therefore they have no saving Faith at all. (6.) It tends to the encouraging of self-deceiving Hypocrites in the vain Conceit they entertain, that all is well with them when really it is not so. For when they hear from this Doctrine that Believing is a Man's persuading himself that Christ is his, and that he shall have Life and Salvation by him; when they hear that every one is bound thus to persuade himself, they will readily conclude, from the good Opinion they find they have of themselves, that they are true Believers, and thereby be further hardened in their Presumption.

Lastly, this Doctrine is not to be received into this Church, because it is inconsistent with what we profess in our approved Confession of Faith. For chap. xiv. § 2: The principal Acts of saving Faith are said to be, *accepting, receiving and resting on Christ alone for Justification*, Sanctification *and eternal Life*. And § 3: That *this Faith in many grows up to the Attainment of a full Assurance through Christ*. Where this Assurance is plainly made a Fruit and Consequent of saving Faith, and not an essential Act. And *chap*. xviii. § 3: *This infallible* Assurance

doth not so belong to the Essence of Faith, but that a true Believer may wait long, and conflict with many Difficulties, before he be partaker of it. And therefore, according to our Confession, a Man *may* be a true Believer and yet want this Assurance. Wherefore I think that Ministers of this Church ought to make no Question whether they should receive this Doctrine *of the Marrow of Modern Divinity*, or retain the Doctrine of our excellent *Confession*, which they have signed with their Hands as the Confession of their Faith, and have solemnly engaged to maintain and defend.

If I have insisted too long upon this Subject, let a due Concern, which we ought all to entertain for the Truth of the divine Record, and for the Purity of Doctrine and Peace of this Church, be an Excuse for the Prolixness of this Discourse. And that I may not farther encroach upon the Time and Patience of the Synod, I shall pass a large Field of practical Observations that might be insisted upon from this Passage of holy Writ.

May the Father of Spirits, by his holy Spirit, give us Faith savingly to believe the Record concerning his Son Jesus Christ; and that believing on the Name of the Son of God, we may come to know that we have eternal Life; and give Glory unto the Father, Son and holy Spirit, for ever and ever. *Amen*.

APPENDIX

As our Confession of Faith denies Assurance to be of the Essence of saving Faith, so it no less disowns all *Universalism*, whether with Respect to the Decree of Election, or the Undertaking of the Son as Surety, or his Purchase, or the absolute Promises of saving Grace. All these it restricts to a certain Number of Mankind appointed unto eternal Life. Confession, chap. iii. § 6: As God hath appointed the Elect unto Glory, so hath he, by the eternal and most free Purpose of his Will, foreordained all Means thereunto. Wherefore they who are elected, being fallen in *Adam*, are redeemed by Christ, are effectually called unto Faith in Christ by his Spirit working in due Season, are justified, adopted, sanctified and kept by his Power through Faith unto Salvation. Neither are any other redeemed by Christ, effectually called, justified, sanctified and saved, but the Elect only. *Chap*. vii. § 3: In the Covenant of Grace, God freely offereth to Sinners Life and Salvation by Jesus Christ, requiring of them Faith in him, that they may be saved, and promising to give unto all those that are ordained unto Life his holy Spirit, to make them willing and able to believe.

Chap. viii. § 1: Unto Christ the Mediator God did from all Eternity give a People to be his Seed, and to be by him in Time redeemed, called, justified, sanctified and glorified. § 5: The Lord Jesus hath fully satisfied the Justice of his Father, and purchased not only Reconciliation, but an everlasting Inheritance in the Kingdom of Heaven, for all those whom the Father hath given unto him. § 8: To all those for whom Christ hath purchased Redemption, he doth certainly and effectually apply and communicate the same, effectually persuading them by his Spirit to believe and obey. Chap. x. § 1: All whom God hath predestinated unto Life, and those only, he is pleased, in his appointed and accepted Time, effectually to call. *Chap*. xi. § 4: God from all Eternity did decree to justify all the Elect, and

Christ did, in the Fulness of Time, die for their Sins and rise again for their Justification; nevertheless they are not justified until the holy Spirit doth, in due Time, actually apply Christ unto them. *Chap*. xv. § 3: Repentance is of such Necessity to all Sinners, that none can expect Pardon without it.

How the following *Assertions* can be evinced to be consistent with this Doctrine of our Confession, I acknowledge is above my Comprehension. They may essay it who maintain them, *viz*. That,

> "Jesus Christ in the Covenant of Redemption stood as Surety, not for the Elect only, but for fallen Mankind, for the whole lost World. He engaged in their Place to satisfy Justice for them, and thereupon they are absolved from all their Sins, and therefore are virtually and really justified from Eternity, in Christ.
>
> "According to this Undertaking, the Son of God by his Death did take away the Sins of the World, and procured their Discharge, which is Pardon purchased; and also purchased for them all the Grace and Benefits of the New Covenant. He is bound to save all; he came to save all Sinners, though he doth not save all.
>
> "Christ the Saviour and Salvation by him are freely purchased, freely offered, freely given. No Condition here at all; no Condition of Christ's coming to save Sinners; no Condition of this Offer.
>
> "God by his Promises declares the Right of Sinners unto this free Gift, yea, gives an absolute Right to all that hear the Gospel.
>
> "So that they have all a Right to Christ and all his Benefits by absolute Promise and Disposition, and confirmed by the Seal of the Sacraments. This is a proclaimed, intimated, published Right; a sure Right, having no Nullity in it; a free, absolute, constant and universal Right to all that hear it, even to the unregenerate and unbelieving. For the Lord stands engaged to perform all; so that there wants nothing to your Title but your receiving it. God gives absolute

Promises, but he addeth this, Unless ye believe, ye shall not be established.

"Yet even this Condition itself is promised. The absolute Promises of giving the new Heart, Life, Light and Faith are made to Sinners as Sinners. For the Lord requires nothing of Men but what he hath first promised to fulfil, do and work in them. Nevertheless, Unbelief may stop the Execution of an absolute and peremptory Promise; by which Means the Lord may, in Justice, make Men know the Breach of his Promise.

"God conveys the Benefits of the New Covenant by way of absolute Promises, to assure us of the Certainty of the Things promised. They give Right and Claim absolutely, but the Fruits of them (the Things promised) are given upon Condition of Faith. The Promise itself, insofar as it conferreth the Right, is absolute; but as to the Event, it is conditional, and without believing it shall not be fulfilled. The Lord's absolute Promises declare the Sinner's Claim and Title, but not what he will do; though he hath taken the Work on himself, and said, A *new Heart will I give* you. The absolute Promises give Right unto all, in Respect of external legal Destination; but they are only to the Children of the Promise, in Respect of divine Intention, intending it for their Good.

"Faith justifies only declaratively, by letting a Sinner see what he is in Christ Jesus, and what in Respect of the Gospel, which declares to him Remission of Sins. And therefore every Sinner is really and actually pardoned and justified before the Gospel Promise be declared unto him, and before he believe it, &c."

When the Patrons of this Scheme shall be pleased to explain more fully their Meaning, and attempt its Reconciliation, either with the Revelation and Attributes of God, or with the Confession of Faith signed by all Ministers of this Church, or even with itself, what they shall advance may be considered.

FINIS.

THE ANTINOMIANISM

OF THE

MARROW OF MODERN DIVINITY

DETECTED

Wherein the Letter to a Private Christian, about Believers receiving the Law, as the Law of Christ, is specially considered.

JAMES HADOW

EDINBURGH · 1721

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PREFACE

TO THE READER

THE following Treatise, written on Occasion of some Pamphlets, published in Favours of the *Marrow of Modern Divinity*, was communicated only to a few in Private: But after that a *Representation*, in Defence of the *Marrow*, signed by twelve Brethren, had been given in to the late General Assembly, craving, That the Fifth Act of the General Assembly 1720, wherein it was censured as erroneous, might be repealed; Some who had seen this Treatise in Manuscript, thought the publishing of it might be of Use to prevent the spreading of the *Antinomian* Gangrene of that Book; The Infection appearing the more Dangerous, in that twelve Ministers had undertaken to maintain its Reputation against the Censure of the supreme Judicatory of this Church; And advised, that the sooner some Remedy were applied, it might prove the more seasonable. These Considerations prevailed with me, to let this Essay go abroad such as it is.

The *Antinomian* Scheme was always formerly set forth under the specious Show of a peculiar Zeal for free Grace: and the same Pretext is still the most plausible for the promoting of it. The Brethren in their Representation go on in the same Way. In their Zeal for the Reputation of the *Marrow*, they charge the General Assembly with injuring the Doctrine of free Grace; as if it could not be preserved in its Purity, without admitting the censured Errors of that Book. But the Charge, as themselves may and ought to know, is unjust. This Church doth steadfastly maintain the Sovereignty, Freedom and Efficacy of Grace; but according to the Gospel Revelation, without extending it to all and every one; and without Prejudice to the Justice of God, and the Satisfaction and Merit of Christ; and without Disparagement unto the Holiness and Authority of the Divine Law-giver; and the Honour and Obligation of his

Law; and without Detriment unto personal Holiness in Heart and Life, and its Necessity unto Salvation.

And the Brethren, whatever Ways they take to distinguish themselves, may be pleased to know, that there are Ministers of the Church of *Scotland*, who will cede to none of them, in owning and asserting the Gospel Doctrine of free Grace; though they cannot go into new Schemes, and the Modern Divinity of the recommended *Marrow*. And for a Testimony hereof, I shall exhibit the following *Assertions*, wherein I have the Concurrence of the Reverend the Moderator of the late General Assembly, and Mr. *Allan Logan* of *Culross*; and the Approbation of others. And we assert,

"That the Lord Jesus Christ, is the only Surety and Mediator of Elect Sinners, and their only Saviour by Price and Ransom, who, by his expiatory Death and Sufferings, and meritorious Obedience, has magnified the Law, satisfied Justice in their Room, and brought in everlasting Redemption and Righteousness. That this his Death is the only Atonement and Propitiation for lost Sinners, the only Sacrifice through which they have Redemption and Remission of Sins. That by this perfect Obedience and Sacrifice of himself, He has fully answered, in their Stead and Place, the Demand of the Law, as it is a Covenant of Works, both as to the Obedience required for Right to Life, and the Punishment threatened in Case of Failure; fully satisfied God's Justice for all their Sins against Law and Gospel, both before and after their Believing; and fully appeased his Wrath, and purchased complete Reconciliation, with all Grace and Glory for them."

"That all whom God has ordained unto Life, and for whom Christ is become a Propitiation, all those, and those only, he also effectually calleth by his Word and Spirit, in his own Time, out of a State of Sin and Death, in which they are by Nature, into a State of Grace and Life, infusing into them a supernatural Principle of spiritual Life, powerfully determining, and effectually drawing them to Jesus Christ by

invincible Grace, and causing them to accept, receive, and rest on him as he is offered in the Gospel for Righteousness and Salvation. Which effectual Calling is of God's free and special Grace alone, not from any thing previously existing or foreseen in the Sinner, who is altogether Passive, until, being quickened and renewed by the Holy Ghost, he is thereby enabled to answer the Call, and embrace the Grace offered and conveyed to him in the Gospel."

"That those whom God effectually calls, he also freely Justifies, not by infusing Righteousness into them, but by pardoning their Sins, and accounting and accepting their Persons as Righteous, not for any thing wrought in them, or done by them, but for Christ's sake alone; not by imputing the Habit of Faith, or any other Grace, the Act of Believing, or any other Duty, or Act of Obedience whatsoever performed by them, unto them as their Righteousness; but by imputing the Obedience and Satisfaction of Christ unto them as the only Ground of their Justification; which being received and rested on by Faith, is accepted of God as performed by their Surety in their Stead, and imputed to them for their Redemption and Righteousness. Nor have they any other Plea to oppose unto the Curse of the Law, and Demands of Justice, and for obtaining Acceptance with God, and a Title to eternal Life; but the Satisfaction, Obedience, Righteousness, and Merit of Christ the Surety imputed to them. That when a Sinner gets a lively discovery of the Holiness and Severity of the Divine Law, indispensably requiring a complete and perfect Righteousness, and a full Answer and Satisfaction unto the Sanction of the broken Covenant of Works, and the Demands of the Holy Violated Law; and gets an affecting sight of his sinful and miserable State, his awakened Conscience pursuing him with the cutting Sense of his grievous Guilt, and the dismal Representations of his Soul-danger, as being shut up under Sin, lying under the Curse of the Law, and under that Sentential Judgment of God, that he is worthy of Death, and as having the Wrath of God abiding upon him. And when these

Convictions of Sin are sharpened by the awful Apprehensions of the Greatness, Majesty, sovereign Authority, unspotted Holiness, and impartial and exact Righteousness of the All-seeing God, with whom he has immediately to do, in this Matter, as the Judge concerned, and before whose Bar he is sisted as a guilty and offending Criminal, to be justified or condemned eternally. A Sinner in this Case, under the Terror of the Lord, who is a consuming Fire, will soon be drawn from all Pleas and Pretences of any Righteousness of his own, Nothing inherent in him, or done by him, can be here pleaded for his Justification; He'll now see that he needs a Righteousness without the Law, even the Righteousness which is by the Faith of Christ, and that he has no other Foundation, no other Ground to lean to, and rest upon for his Deliverance from Wrath, and Acceptance with God."

"That the Self-destroyed Sinner may obtain an Interest in this Righteousness, God requireth of him, to believe on Christ. That the Thing proposed in the Gospel to a Sinner, to be believed by the direct Act of justifying Faith, is not that Christ is his, and hath died for him in particular; nor, that God hath loved him, and pardoned his Sins; nor, that Christ hath purchased Redemption for every one of Mankind without Exception, and for him in particular, and that he shall be saved by Christ; seeing these are not Things revealed in the Word, and commanded to be believed by every hearer of the Gospel: But the Thing proposed, is the Testimony of God concerning Christ the Saviour, and the Method of Salvation through him; And every hearer of the Gospel is called not only to give his Assent unto the Truth revealed, but also his Consent unto the Way of Relief and Salvation proposed to him, and so to accept of and receive Christ, and to rest on him alone for Salvation, as he is offered in the Gospel. That this Faith justifies a Sinner, not because of any intrinsic Worth in itself, nor because of the other Graces which do always accompany it, or the gracious Actings and good Works which are the Fruits of it; but only as

it is an Instrument, by which he receives and applies Christ, and his Righteousness for Pardon and Acceptance."

"That though Faith be required to instate a Sinner into Covenant with God, and to Interest him in Christ's Righteousness; yet is Repentance also required in order unto the Remission of Sins; and is of such Necessity to all Sinners, that none may expect Pardon without it. And though all who fly to Christ, must have a Principle of spiritual Life, and flowing therefrom, a spiritual Sight and Sense of the Evil of Sin, its Filth and Hatefulness in the sight of God; its Contrariety to his Law; its Demerit, Guilt, and Power, with the dreadful Curse denounced against it, and Wrath due to it: A spiritual Sight and Sense of their lost and undone State in themselves, and their utter Inability to deliver themselves out of that miserable Condition, and utter Insufficiency of all Creatures to give them any Relief, and of the absolute and indispensable Necessity of a mighty Saviour to Ransom them by Price, and Redeem them by Power: And a gracious Discovery of the Lord Jesus as the alone Saviour, and of the glorious Way of Redemption and Salvation through his Purchase; and of the Method of the Application thereof by his mighty Spirit, with an Heart affecting dislike of, and Grief for Sin, as offensive to God, and as the Source and Spring of all their Misery; and an high Esteem of the Lord Jesus as a complete and sufficient Saviour, worthy of all Acceptation, and able and willing to save unto the uttermost all that come unto God through him: And though all these Things must be wrought in them by the Spirit of Life and Grace, and are requisite in order to their actual express receiving of Christ, and closing with him on his own Terms: Yet they are not to bring them unto God, or offer them to Christ, as a Satisfaction for Sin and cause of Pardon, or as Qualities to make them Worthy, or to recommend them to the divine Favour, or as any Price in their Hand to purchase and procure Mercy from God, or an Interest in Christ, and his Purchase (which are the usual Calumnies of the more refined *Antinomians* against the

Orthodox Doctrine.) But these Things are required to make them to give up with all Conceit and Confidence in themselves, and their own Attainments, to esteem highly of the unexcited Love, and condescending Mercy of God in Christ; to prize the free and ample Offer of rich Grace in the Gospel, and to go fully out of themselves, and close heartily and willingly with the Lord Jesus Christ."

"That Believers in their Justification are freed from the revenging Wrath of God, and actual Condemnation, and shall never fall from the State of Justification, and Title therein obtained to Eternal Life: Yet personal Holiness and good Works, are so indispensably required in the justified, while they live in this World, in Order unto their obtaining the Enjoyment of eternal Salvation hereafter, that without them none shall see the Lord, or be meet to partake of the Inheritance of the Saints in Light. And so indispensable is the Obligation of the Moral Law upon Believers, not only in Regard of the Matter contained in it, but also in Regard of the Authority of God, the Creator who gave it; that it constantly binds them to hate and avoid all Sin, to make Conscience of every Duty, and to follow Holiness in Heart and Life. And their not observing of, and doing against its Commands, are truly Transgressions and Sins, which deserve God's Wrath and Curse, and bring on Guilt, which is not expiated, but by the Blood of Christ, and need to be pardoned for his Sake; and God doth continue to forgive the Sins of those that are justified; so that they shall never come into actual Condemnation: Yet by their Sins they may fall under God's fatherly Displeasure, and not have the Light of his Countenance restored unto them, until they humble themselves, confess their Sins, beg Pardon, and renew their Faith and Repentance."

These *Assertions*, we conceive, are agreeable to the holy Scriptures, and the Doctrine of this Church contained in our Confession and Catechisms. And though the Brethren have most injuriously charged the General Assembly with receding

from it, yet if they can justly charge any one Minister of this Church with preaching Doctrine contrary to it, I think he ought to be taken notice of. And if the Brethren shall sincerely own these Truths, and vent nothing inconsistent therewith, they are not to be charged with *Antinomianism* in these Points: Though their Undertaking in such a Manner the Defence of an *Antinomian* Book, and recommending it as Orthodox, cannot be justified. But if they have adopted the Errors of that Book, I wish they may be convinced and reclaimed.

The Reverend Vindicator of the *Marrow* was pleased, in its Defence, to direct a Letter unto a Private Christian; and that he may be apprised of the genuine Sentiments of a Private Christian concerning his Conduct, and that of his Friends; I have allowed the following Preface to be prefixed to this Treatise: It was sent me by a Friend, with Power to make such Alterations and Amendments, as I should judge meet; But I chose rather to let it appear in its own native Dress. I observed in it a Spirit of Piety, Ingenuity and solid Judgment, and a serious Concern for the Purity and Peace of this Church; wherewith I was so well satisfied, that I thought the publishing of it could not prove unacceptable to such, who truly wish the Welfare of our present Constitution. That they may prosper who love it, is the Prayer of

JA. HADOW.

July 22, 1721.

PREFACE

TO THE RECOMMENDERS AND DEFENDERS

OF THE MARROW OF MODERN DIVINITY

By a Private Christian

THE State of the Church of God in this lower World, is very deservedly called Militant; for it is evident both by the Intimations we have from Holy Scripture, and the daily Experience of the Saints, that all that are determined to embrace Christ, as he is offered in the Gospel, ought to resolve on a continued Course of Warfare on their Journey Heaven-ward: Yea, the Multiplicity and Variety of those Temptations and Afflictions wherewith a Believer is compassed about, are such as require him to be always upon his Guard; and to have his spiritual Armour in Readiness; and certainly the Danger is greatest, when the grand Adversary (who often *transforms* himself into an Angel of Light) decks his Temptations with the specious Covering of Duty to God.

Among the manifold discouraging Occurrences that Christians meet with in the Strait and narrow *Way* that leads unto Life Eternal, the Disputes, Contentions and Divisions which often fall out amongst Professors about Matters of Religion, are not the least; especially when Ministers of the Gospel are engaged in them; and it is observable, that no Set of People *manage* their Discords and Differences about these Matters, with so much excessive Heat and Fiery *Zeal* as Churchmen, who oftentimes are pushed on by their Pride and Vain-glory, to invent new, or adopt old Opinions, different from, yea, contrary to the Form of sound Words contained in the Gospel of Jesus Christ: And they have defended the same with such indefatigable Pains and Industry, as to draw Multitudes in to their Support, to the lamentable Ruin, and Overthrow of Churches and Kingdoms: And all this has been done under the most plausible Pretence of *Zeal* for God, Shows

of Holiness, and strict Devotion: as may be made evident from the Instances of *Arius, Pelagius*, and others in the earlier Ages of the Christian Church, and of *Arminius* in the latter Times, and of *several* Men of Note in our own Time, who are reviving *Arianism* in our neighbouring Church.

I believe it will be easily found, upon Enquiry, That some Inventers and Fomenters of dangerous Opinions have gone far beyond what they first intended in supporting their Schemes; yea, the Length not only to trample upon the lawful Authority of the Church, but to enter into Alliances with, and to take Auxiliaries from Heretics and common Enemies: Who, if they had been told at their first setting out, that they would take such Courses, and thereby break the Peace, and mar the Success of the Gospel, would be ready to give *Hazael's* Answer, when the Prophet told him what inhumane Cruelties he would commit upon the Jews: And yet they have obstinately persisted, till the Tranquillity of the Church has been unhinged, and she brought into deep Sufferings and Afflictions: And we cannot shun the Observation, That upon such Emergencies, the practical Exercise of Godliness, with many, degenerates into warm Disputes and Janglings: And in stead of Christian-Love, Self-Denial, Mutual-Forbearance and Forgiveness; a Spirit of Hatred, Revenge and Resentment takes Place.

From these and many other Considerations it may appear, That all who love *Zion's* Peace and Welfare, ought to mark them who cause Divisions, especially by supporting dangerous Doctrines in a well governed Orthodox Church, and to avoid such, how high soever their Pretensions to Holiness, and extraordinary Devotion may be.

There are some good Christians that are apt to dream, that something like Infallibility is entailed on Sanctity; and therefore are ready to take too much upon Trust, the Lawfulness of all Opinions and Actions, especially of

Ministers of strict Piety: But we ought to follow no Man further than he follows Christ.

There is a Bias of Corruption in the best of the Saints here in this imperfect State, which may sometimes lead them out of the Way of Duty: So that it is a bad Inference to conclude, because I have Ground to believe a Person in a gracious State; therefore his Judgment in Matters of Faith is still to be approved.

Purity of Doctrine, and Harmony in the Duties of Religion, according to the Rules of the Gospel, are Blessings highly valuable, and Jewels to be preserved with the utmost Watchfulness and Care.

The Presbyterian Church of *Scotland* has always shined with a peculiar Lustre and Brightness, with Respect to the Purity of her Doctrine and Worship: and has still had her Discipline and Government founded on the Rules and Examples of Christ and his Apostles, and has been honoured with many glorious Confessors, who have sealed their Adherence to our Reformation with their Sufferings and Blood, when put to the Trial. Therefore it highly concerns us who have had this pure Reformation transmitted to us by our worthy Ancestors at these dear Rates, to hand down the same to our Children and Successors in its Gospel Purity, and to be watchful, that no Part thereof be corrupted; especially that our Doctrine be not blended with any Principles that tend to wrong either the Matter, or Form of sound Words: And even we who are private Christians, ought to contribute our joint Endeavours in our Spheres, for attaining this great End.

Although we have just Ground to bewail our Barrenness under, and Misimprovement of our pure Gospel Light, and that so many have deserted our Communion, without any just Ground, and that Impiety so much abounds, which no Doubt affords Ground of deep Humiliation and Mourning: Yet I am bold to assert, That there is a greater Measure of Orthodoxy and Sanctity to be found among the Body of our Ministry, than

in any Church now on Earth; and that our Church Judicatories discover a greater Measure of Care to preserve our sacred Constitution, and that they do not merit to be treated with these Reproaches, and unjust Calumnies, wherewith some warm Zealots strive to sully the Church's Reputation, in Order to raise their own.

I must here remark, That all Church-Officers are obliged, by the Acts of our Assembly, to subscribe our Doctrine, and so to come under solemn Ties, to maintain the same, with the other Parts of our Reformation; and none is admitted a Member of our Supreme Judicatory, without this Qualification: By this Care of our Church, not only the Remembrance of our covenanted Work of Reformation is kept up, but all in Ecclesiastic Capacities, brought under formal Bonds, to maintain the same: And I believe, it will be found, from the ordinary Practice of Ministers, that they are at Pains to impress such as are admitted to sealing Ordinances, with a Sense of their solemn Obligations to maintain this our Reformation; From which I think, that the Clamour raised against our Church, of neglecting and burying our Engagements to maintain our holy Constitution, is an unjust and uncharitable Reproach; and I am persuaded it would be no Loss to the Interest of Religion, if there were less Calumny of this Nature, coming both from Pulpit and Press. I would gladly ask, If there be a moral Possibility of renewing a national Covenant, so as to bring the Body of the People into it, as we are at present circumstanced? Must the Church usurp a Civil Power for this End? Or can she force the Parliament of *Great Britain* to interpose their Authority? If both these be impracticable, I think they do not act a friendly Part, who labour to raise Prejudices at the Church in the Minds of the People, as if she were supinely negligent, in maintaining our Reformation; especially, when besides the Course of Diligence above-mentioned, she is again and again using Endeavours, with Civil Authority, to get these Grievances we labour under, redressed. The Reason why I make this Digression from my

chief Design in this Preface, is, That I find some who seem too inclinable to drive separate Courses, and maintain different Opinions in Matters of Faith, using this little Artifice to make themselves Popular: For evincing which, I appeal to the Hearers of some of their Sermons, and their Pamphlets that are just now handed about.

For the better Illustration of some present Practices, I must further observe, That as all Christians are obliged in their different Stations, to contribute toward the Preservation of Purity, Peace, and the Unity of the Church; so Ministers of the Gospel in a more positive, formal, and explicit *Way*: For besides the forementioned Ties, I think it deserves Regard, how at their Ordination, they are, in a very solemn Manner, strictly bound to maintain the Doctrine, Discipline, Worship and Government of our Church; and particularly to be subject to her Judicatories; and in a Word, to all the Duties that tend to promote the Ends of the Gospel. I must own, I scarcely meet with any Thing more stumbling and Offensive to me, than to see Ministers act the Reverse of any of these Obligations; nor do I think Satan has a greater Handle to work by, when he tempts Men to believe Religion to be a Cheat. I know no Emergent since I was capable to be a Witness of Ecclesiastical Actings, that affords so many afflicting Considerations of this Nature, as the Conduct of some reverend Ministers, with Respect to the Book entitled, *The Marrow of Modern Divinity*, so industriously supported, in Opposition to the Authority of the Church of *Scotland*. 'Tis not my Province, nor have I Abilities to enter into the intricate Disputes of School Divinity: Nor do I need to offer my Judgment, How far the Book is sound or unsound; (that is set in a pretty clear Light by the Act of Assembly, passed in *May* 1720, concerning it, and by the following Treatise illustrating the Grounds of the said Act; in which Treatise I hope the judicious unprejudiced Reader, will find such satisfying Arguments, as to convince him of the Danger of the *Marrow*; and to put him upon his Guard in using and recommending the same) yet I think I do not go out of my

Sphere of a Private Christian, in noticing some Things as Grounds of Offence, with Respect to the same.

1st, I consider it is owned by those who defend the *Marrow*, That there are unguarded Expressions in it, and Assertions liable to Misconstruction, which if not well understood, by comparing them with the rest of the Book, may mislead People: Therefore I conclude there is certainly at least some Appearance of evil in it. 2*dly*, I consider, that many very Discerning Ministers, and also not a few Judicious Private Christians, apprehended some Things very dangerous in it, at its being recommended, without Exception, as Orthodox and edifying; and therefore were offended, before the Church had passed any Sentence against it. Now I demand, If the Appearance of Evil, joined with offending many of the Lord's People, might not have been a solid Foundation to forbear further defending and recommending that Book, even though there were no Authoritative Act against it. If the great Apostle Paul would forbear eating of Flesh, to avoid offending his fellow Christians; the Argument is much stronger here; and I was very sorry, when I found it had not the Weight to put a Stop to any further Recommendations of the Book; and I thought in that Case the Church acted a faithful Part, in interposing her Authority, for discouraging such a Practice, and hoped, that Regard to this Authority, and the comely Order, Purity and Peace of our Ecclesiastic Establishment, would have produced the desired Effect. But alas, to my great Grief and Surprise! I find myself very far disappointed: For instead of obeying the Authority of our General Assembly, I see the Undertakings and Resolutions to support the Credit of that Book, still rising higher and higher, notwithstanding of the Act of the penult Assembly passed against it, without a contradictory Voice; except three or four, which one would have thought might have been sufficient to extinguish the Flame; but in stead thereof, the Act is contemned; and new Measures taken to enervate its Force. Pains are used, with too great Success, to raise Prejudices against the Church, in the

Minds of serious Christians, to maintain the Reputation of the *Marrow*, not only in private, but from Pulpits: Pamphlets and Libels are handed about, containing bitter and reproachful Reflections, having no other Tendency than to harden the profane, and foment Divisions among weak Christians, and raise in them a Dislike at pure Gospel Ordinances, administered by some worthy Pastors, at whom these Libels directly point. 'Tis very well known, that Effects of this Nature are too too visible in the City of *Edinburgh* especially: For though the Ordinances of the Gospel are dispensed there in as much Purity and Plenty, by faithful Ambassadors of Jesus Christ, (who recommend Religion by their holy Example) as in any Place of the Earth; are not Gospel Administrations in their Hands, falling under Contempt, with some Professors: And though none in *Scotland* have such frequent and easy Access to the Sacrament of the Lord's Supper, as People in that Place, by Reason of its Frequency there, and in other neighbouring Congregations; are not these blessed Occasions slighted by some who used to attend them, who seem to place too much Religion in communicating with such Ministers as support new Schemes; there are not a few who turn their Backs upon Communions in *Edinburgh*, or the Suburbs thereof, and choose at the very same precise Time, to attend them, perhaps at the Distance of a Day's Journey; as if the Efficacy of Ordinances were to proceed from Ministers, who distinguish themselves, by some singular Opinions: And does not daily Experience testify, that many Professors cannot hear these new Schemes, or the *Marrow* in the least condemned, and the Care of the Church to maintain our Purity against them commended, but they lose that meek and calm Temper of Spirit, that's necessary for Christian Love and Unity.

It might have been reasonably expected, that when the Reverend Brethren, who had for some Time patronized the *Marrow*, saw the Ferment thus increasing, that for Edification's Sake, they would have evidenced so much Tenderness, as to drop their Undertaking: But so far are they from any such

Thoughts; that they enter into new Measures, and exert their utmost Endeavours, to frustrate the Design of the Assembly's Act; and to this End, present a Representation, signed by twelve of their Number, to the last Assembly, complaining of the said Act, craving the same might be repealed, and vindicating the *Marrow*. This bold and unprecedented Practice, fires the honest People, whom they had drawn into their Sentiments, with new *Zeal* for the Reputation of the Book, and dangerous Opinions therein contained; and at the same Time, lessens their Esteem of, and Regard to the Authority of the Church. This alarming Conduct, was very affecting and afflicting to many of the Lord's People; but more especially to the Assembly, who, notwithstanding acted with the greatest of Tenderness towards the twelve Brethren, and gave them fair Opportunity, betwixt the Time of their lodging their Representation, before the Committee of Bills, and the hearing of the same, to retract it; and much Pains was taken without Doors to this Effect, unsuccessfully.

Before the Affair could be overtaken, the Assembly (by Reason of the Commissioner's Indisposition) came to a Conclusion, after that they had empowered their Commission, to go upon the Merits of the Cause: The Commission accordingly set apart a Diet for the same, and proceeded to hear the Minds of the Court, upon the Representation: Many of the Learned Brethren, and some other Members were heard thereon, at great Length, who did to the Satisfaction of several Hundreds of Auditors, vindicate and support the Penult Assembly's Act; and by clear Reasonings, lodged the former Charge upon the *Marrow*: Not one Member opening his Mouth to support the Conduct of the twelve Brethren; so that they had a second Time, a solemn Declaration of the Sentiments of our Church, in Opposition to the Errors of the *Marrow*: I say our Church, because these very Members of the Commission, did constitute the Assembly two Days before, without any considerable Alteration; so it was upon the Matter the same Judicatory, under another Denomination.

I was yet hopeful, that the Reverend Brethren having heard such convincing Arguments against the *Marrow*, and not one Member having spoke to defend their Cause, they would have owned, at least, that in some Measure they were satisfied, and dropped the same; but all these Hopes were again disappointed, for they stand their Ground, with as much Resolution as ever; wherefore, a Committee is appointed to deal further with them.

Upon the Whole, I am at Loss to know, how these Reverend Brethren (who I believe desire the Prosperity of Christ's Kingdom) can satisfy their own Consciences, by such a Conduct in this Matter, which I think unjustifiable, unless I hear better Reasons than have yet appeared. Can I believe any of them, when standing on the last Point of Time, looking Death and Judgment in the Face, would venture to approve of their Balancing the Purity of our Doctrine, and the Peace of our Church, with the Esteem of the *Marrow of Modern Divinity*, and some mistaken Notions of Reputation.

I am aware of the Force of Arguments arising from two different Topics; *Primo*, These Ministers are, in the Course of Providence, encouraged by the Countenance they have from the People, more than others: For their public Administrations are more frequented, by not only the mixed Multitude, whose Affections cleave to them, but even by the truly Godly, who are remarkably edified by them: Therefore they (these Ministers) seem to have God's Call for what they do. I answer, *First*, If the Countenance of Multitudes be a good Argument, *Arianism, Mahometism* and *Popery* may lay Claim to it. 2dly, I refuse that they are more followed or approved by the truly Godly, than other Ministers; yea on the Contrary, new Schemes of Doctrine, and Divisive Courses are a Grief to more solid, exercised Private Christians, than those of their Followers; and some are deeply wounded with the Offence given, who lament over the same in Secret, and wrestle with God in Prayer, that he may preserve our Purity and Peace. I answer further, That though I will not doubt, but some of

those, who countenance these Ministers, are truly Godly; yet I much question, if these good People be Edified, by supporting this new Cause, although 'tis very plain they are Pleased, for to be Pleased and Edified are very different, and the one may be, and often is without the other.

A second Topic is, That these Ministers find themselves much assisted by the Spirit of God, in the Defence of their Cause; yea, 'tis said of some of them, That they have immediate Emotions and Impulses from Heaven, clearing up their Duty to insist: But I ask, How shall we know that these Impulses are not Delusions, seeing Good Men, even Ministers are not without *Hazard* this Way? And 'tis known that there are Multitudes of *Enthusiasts*, that pretend immediate Calls from God, both for Opinions and Actions, Diametrically opposite to his Revealed Will: But even we that are Private Christians, ought to know, that we have a more sure Word of Prophecy, that the Canon of the Scripture is closed, and no Doctrine disagreeable to the same, is to be received, though the most Eminent Minister in the World, or an Angel from Heaven should preach the same. Christians ought to contend for Truth, and not always for Victory; and to reckon it more their Duty and Honour to yield, when Religion and Reason fail to support them, than to continue obstinate in their own Opinion.

I do in the deepest Humility, offer it as my Opinion to my Fellow Christians, who are ready with *Eli*, to tremble for the Ark of God, when it is in Hazard, that we should, with Frequency and Fervour, Address the Throne of Grace, for the Preservation of the Purity and Peace of our Dear Mother Church; and particularly, that her Judicatories may be graciously directed to effectual Measures, for this End: And that her Authoritative Acts may be duly regarded, by Her own Officers especially; and when either Ministers or others of Her Children, fall under a wrong Bias, that leads them out of the Way, all Pains for Reclaiming such may be blessed; and more especially in the present Situation of Affairs, that the Reverend

Ministers, who now stand as Her opposite Party, may beware of Endangering the Beautiful Work of our Reformation, by Error, Division or otherwise; but may yet unite themselves in Judgment and Practice, Love and Obedience with their Brethren: And let us in our Private Capacities, study to act the Part of Her Genuine Children, by Loving, Honouring, and Obeying Her, and Guarding against every Thing that may in the least mar Her comely Order. Let us have our Peace and Comfort wrapped up in the Peace of our Zion; and let us study the Frame of the Holy *Psalmist*, in the whole cxxxii. *Psalm, and the* cxxxvii. *Psalm*, v. 5, and 6. If I *forget Thee*, O Jerusalem, *let* my *Right-hand forget her Cunning: If I do not remember Thee, let my Tongue cleave to the Roof of my Mouth; if I prefer not Jerusalem before my Chief* Joy.

CHAPTER I

Of the Charge of Antinomianism against the Marrow, and that it is not taken off by the great Names who recommend it.

The Reverend Mr. *James* Hog, Minister of the Gospel at Carnock, was induced to prefix a *Preface* to a late Edition of the Marrow of Modern Divinity, printed at *Edinburgh* in Anno 1718, wherein he highly, though too unadvisedly, recommends that Book, without giving any Caution against the *Errors* and unsavoury *Expressions* contained in it. His Reputation being engaged, he resolved, it seems, to defend the *Marrow* against all Opposers: And finding that some had their private Exceptions against it, though they had not troubled the Press with them, he emits about *March* 1719 his *Explication of Passages excepted against in the Marrow of Modern Divinity, in a Letter to a* Minister of *the Gospel*: Concluding with six pungent Queries, to any that shall adventure to speak against the *Marrow*. Yet to verify that Proverb, *Nitimur in vetitum*, in a short while after, a Pamphlet came abroad, entitled, *The Snake in the Grass, or Remarks upon the Marrow* of *Modern Divinity*. There was also a Sermon published by P. *Hadow*, at the Desire of the Synod of *Fife*, wherein he took notice of the *Marrow's* Definition of Faith, and was so unlucky as to differ from the Sentiments of *the Author of the Explication of Passages*.

The recommended Marrow must be defended, and therefore the P's Sermon was attacked in the first Place, and himself pretty rudely treated in a Pamphlet, called, A *Conference betwixt* Epaphroditus *and* Epaphras, with an Intimation in a Postscript, *That the Prefacer to the last* Edition *of the Marrow intended an Answer to the* Snake, &c. which he published not long after, in A *Letter to a Gentleman, containing a Detection of Errors in a Print, entitled*, The Snake in the Grass.

Thereafter was published a Pamphlet, entitled, A *Review of the Conference betwixt* Epaphroditus *and* Epaphras; which he soon answered *by Remarks on the Review of the Conference*, with Queries concerning the Extent of Christ's Death, contained in a Letter to a Minister of the Gospel. How satisfying his Remarks are, the World is left to judge: For, it seems, the Reviewer has not thought it worth his While to make any Reply. But the Author of the Snake, &c. being charged by him with gross and dangerous Errors, and lodged among the vile Herd of *Socinians*, thought fit to vindicate himself in a Reply, under the Title of *The* Cromwellian *Ghost conjured, and put from creeping into Houses*, &c. or Epaphroditus *and* Epaphras *called to a new Conference*, &*c. which Ghost, as* yet, wanders about without an Answer.

The Author of the Preface to the late Edition of the *Confession of Faith*, had (in Page cxxxv, &c.) given some Hints of the Tendency of some Positions and Opinions contained in the *Marrow*, as not well suited to promote Holiness of Life: Neither must he pass without being refuted, though poorly enough, in a small Pamphlet, under the Title of *Some few of many Passages collected from the Marrow of Modern Divinity, for clearing it from the Charge of Antinomian Licentiousness*; where he complains in the Close, That in this Preface to the Confession, many other Aspersions are cast upon the *Marrow*, without any Shadow of Proof; and concludes with these remarkable Words, *And* instead of *repeating them, which I could not do without extreme Heaviness, I rather choose to hold my Peace, and not answer a Word*.

The Report of a Committee brought the Affair of the *Marrow* before the late Venerable *General Assembly, in Anno* 1720; wherein some of the many erroneous Positions excerpted from it, were exhibited, with the Texts of Scripture and Articles of our *Confession of Faith* and *Catechisms*, to which these Positions are opposite. And that this Matter might be fully heard and considered, the *Assembly* appointed a Diet, wherein all, not only Members, but others, had Access to

propose what they had to offer in Defence of *the Marrow*, or against the Report of the *Committee*. And there Mr. *Hog*, and others, were fully heard and answered. And afterward the *Assembly* having heard the excerpted Passages read from the Book, and compared them with the Texts of Scripture, and Articles of our Confession and Larger Catechism, they judged them contrary to both: And therefore prohibited all Ministers of this Church, either by Preaching, Writing or Printing, to recommend the said Book, as their Act more fully bears.

But, it seems, neither his own Resolution, nor the Venerable *Assembly's* Prohibition, could oblige him to keep Silence: For about that Time, or soon after, there appeared in Print a Pamphlet, entitled, A Letter to a *private Christian; Wherein it is plainly demonstrated, That the Believers receiving the Law as the Law of Christ, is the only effectual Method for attaining Gospel Holiness*, &c. The Style whereof, and superficial Way of writing, doth sufficiently show, that it comes from the same Hand.

He might have considered how tenderly the Venerable *Assembly* had dealt with him, that when they condemned these Passages in the *Marrow*, they did not also presently censure him, who had so amply recommended the whole Book, without any Exception or Reserve: And indeed, to such who consider not the whole Circumstances, the *Assembly's* Lenity may seem very unaccountable. But he not being directly sifted before them, such Affairs were referred to their Commission, to be further inquired into. May the gentle Treatment he has met with reclaim him so, as he may not oblige the *Church* to take further Notice of him.

The above-mentioned *Letter to a private Christian*, seems to be designed against that Part of the *General Assembly's* Act, which affirms the Groundlessness of that Distinction of the Law, as it is the Law of Works, and as it is the Law of Christ, by which the Author of the Marrow defends his six *Antinomian* Paradoxes. Wherefore, in Vindication of the Venerable

Assembly, I shall show how miserably Mr. *Hog* misrepresents the Opinion of the *Marrow*, and imposeth upon the private Christian, to whom he addresseth this Letter.

And seeing he introduceth his main Scope, by a new Recommendation of the *Marrow*, I shall attend him therein, with some Observes. First, He endeavours to remove the Suspicion of *Antinomianism* from the Author, and thinks the calling him an *Antinomian* without Restriction or Limitation, is a severe Censure, Pag. 1. I shall not approve the Severity of this Censure, but shall admit of a Limitation, viz. That the Author was not one of the gross *Antinomians or Ranters*, he did not justify their lewd and wicked Practices; but sets up for a middle Way betwixt them and the *Legalists*: So that he was only a more sly and *refined Antinomian*, one in Mask, without owning the Name: For that Appellation being somewhat odious, the most known and noted *Antinomians*, such as Mr. *Towne* and others, disown and reject the Name of *Antinomians*. But with this Restriction the Author of the *Marrow* may be justly called an *Antinomian*, being that he was accounted such from the first publishing of his *Book in Anno* 1645. For soon after, Mr. J. A. in his Treatise printed *in* Anno 1646. and entitled, A *manifest and brief Discovery of some of the Errors contained in a Dialogue, called*, The Marrow of modern Divinity, chargeth it with *Antinomianism*. He says in his Preface, "That upon reading the Title Page he was rejoiced, hoping God had raised up some Man to compose the Differences between the *Legalist* and the *Antinomist*. But that after reading the Book, he found himself much deceived, seeing its Author had gone the direct Way with the *Antinomist*, especially in the Manner of the Justification of a Sinner. Mr. *Trap* gives the like Judgment of him, in his *Annotations* on Heb. iii. 2. As *also Moses was* faithful, &c. saying, *And yet how unworthily handled by the Author of the* Marrow of Modern Divinity, that sly Antinomian, in *divers Passages of his Book, as might be easily instanced*.

And Mr. *Blake* shows his Sentiments of him in his *Treatise on the Covenant, Pag. 56. in* these Words, *Away with stammering*

Moses, saith the Marrow of Modern Divinity, a *Morsel* in *which few Divines can find Sweetness*.

Again, the Author of the *Marrow*, ranks himself with *Antinomians*, seeing he quotes such with Approbation, Marrow, *Page* 180. he cites *Robert Towne (the Author of the Assertion of Grace, against* Dr. Taylor) with the high Commendation *of an Evangelical Man. And Page 136. Edit*. 2. he quotes Mr. Cornwell on *Gospel Repentance* as Author of the following Words, *viz. The Lord hath said in his Word, in divers Places, That he justifies his Children before they repent, or truly humble themselves*: Which is an *Antinomian* Error. And both these Evangelical Men are refuted by the learned and godly Mr. *Rutherford,* as known and signal *Antinomians*, and in these very Points for which the *Marrow* adduceth them. See *Rutherford's Christ's Dying and drawing*, and his *Survey of the spiritual Antichrist*. And further, the Author of the *Marrow* shows himself to be a sly *Antinomian*, by dropping in *Antinomian* Tenets into his Book, and cunningly mixing them with Gospel Truths; under the specious Pretext of refuting *Antinomians. The General Assembly* hath condemned some of these; and this will be further cleared in the Instances adduced by the Author of the *Letter* for his Vindication. And this alone is a sufficient Proof of the *Marrow's* being *Antinomian*.

Next, He endeavours to vindicate the *Marrow* from *Antinomianism*, by the great Names who have recommended it. Letter *Pag*. 1. and 2. "Sure (saith he) the great Mr. *Caryl* and *Burroughs*, Members of the *Westminster* Assembly, with other Divines of good Note, had other Sentiments of the Author and his Performance, when they recommended it."

When Ministers publish Letters in Print to private Christians, it were to be wished they advanced nothing but what they know to be true, and well founded. For Trial of the Truth of what he here averreth, with so much Assurance, I shall inquire into the Characters and Circumstances of these Recommenders of the *Marrow*: And perhaps it will appear not

so very surprising, that they were induced to lend their Recommendations to it.

It is true, Mr. *Joseph* Caryl, and Mr. *Jeremiah Burroughs*, were Members of the Westminster Assembly: But they were of these Independents named by the *Parliament*, who were engaged in a Party, in Opposition to the settling *Presbyterian* Government then in *England*, and were therefore called the *Dissenting Brethren*: Who to strengthen their Interest against the Presbyterians, did too much cherish the other *Sectaries*, who all set up for *Independency*, that they might shelter themselves under their Wings; and with the more Freedom vent their Errors: And by the Assistance of these *Sects*, the *Independent* Party grew so strong, that through their prevailing Influence with the Parliament, and in the Country and Army, the Government of the Church was kept unsettled, notwithstanding of their most sacred Engagements in the solemn League and Covenant: It is not unknown (even in our Days) what Stretches Men will make to serve their Turn in a Party Quarrel. It was in the Heat of these Factions, *viz. in Anno* 1645, and 1646, that *Caryl* and *Burroughs* recommended the *Marrow*, which I am persuaded no Presbyterian Minister would have done at that Time: Nor hath any done it ever since, that I know of, except the Reverend Mr. *Hog* of Carnock. But Edward *Fisher* the Author of the *Marrow* was a Tool, whom the *Independents* thought fit to encourage in that Juncture. He was as to Employment a Barber in *London*, who took upon himself to be a Minister of a separate or independent Congregation, as may be gathered from the Book itself, and so set up for the independent Way, in Opposition to Presbyterian Government. Such an Intruder into the sacred Ministerial Office, would not readily at that Time have obtained the Recommendation of any true Presbyterian, who had a real *Zeal* for the Covenant, and sworn Reformation of the Church of *Scotland*. What hath been said of the Management of these Independents, is no forged Story, as may

be learned from the History of these Times. See *Rushworth, Collier* and *Hollis*.

Mr. *Rutherford* in his Epistle prefixed unto his *Survey of the spiritual Antichrist*, complains heavily on the Independents, for siding with and supporting the *Antinomians and* other Sectaries, in Opposition to the *Presbyterians*, and the Settlement of their Church Government. Our *General Assembly* frequently complained of them; and particularly, in their Letter to the *Westminster* Assembly, of *August 2d, Anno* 1648. They assert, That the dissenting Brethren's *Tenet of Independency*, kept open a Door for Errors and Heresies. They were on Account of the Opposition they made to Presbyterians, and the Trouble they gave to the Westminster *Assembly*, called dissenting Brethren: As Doctor *Calamy* observes in his *Abridgment* of Mr. Baxter's *Life*, where he mentions Jeremiah *Burroughs*, and other Independents to this Purpose in the following Words, *Vol. I. Pag*. 83, 84. "Six or seven Independents were joined with them, that all Sides might be heard. Five of these, *viz*. Mr. *Philip Nye, Thomas Goodwin, Jeremiah Burroughs, Sydrach Simpson, and William Bridge*, were called the dissenting Brethren. - But when they came to Church Government, they engaged the Assembly in long Debates, and kept the Matter as long as they could undetermined: And after that, they kept it long unexecuted, in almost all Parts of the Land, except *London* and *Lancashire*, that their Party had Time to strengthen themselves in the Army and Parliament." See also, *Pag*. 96, 97. Where, after an Account of the Disorders and Confusions of the *Sectaries*, he adds, "A few dissenting Members of the Westminster Synod began all this, and carried it far on. That good Man Mr. *Jeremiah* Burroughs joined himself to them in Name."

The Independent Party prevailed so far in the Army and Parliament, that at length they excluded the Presbyterian Members from the House of Commons, broke off the Treaty with the King at the Isle of *Wight*, and brought that unfortunate Prince to an ignominious Exit on a bloody Scaffold.

Forty seven Ministers of the Province of London, did at that Time sign a bold Address to General *Fairfax* and his Officers, remonstrating against the unaccountable Proceedings against the King. But these Addressers were all Presbyterians, not one of the Independents appearing among them. And afterwards, when Mr. *Love*, who was one of the Signers of that Address, was condemned and executed by the prevailing Party, did any of the Independent Brethren plead for him? Did any one of them join with the Presbyterian Ministers, in petitioning the Parliament for his Life? No. When factious Humour carrieth Men to such Heights, how little are their Recommendations to be regarded?

And as *Caryl and Burroughs*, though they might be sound in the Faith, were biased by Party Interest: So perhaps they had but overly considered the *Marrow; (as I believe Mr. Hog* did, when he penned his recommendatory Preface to its late Edition) and so following more their Affection and Humour, than sound Judgment, they might the more easily be imposed upon by the Barber's fair Pretences to refute *Antinomianism*.

By the other Divines of good Note; who also have recommended the *Marrow*; I suppose he means *Joshua Sprigge, William Strong and Samuel* Prittie. Now it may be reasonably demanded of the Reverend Vindicator, that he inform us how and whence he knows they were *Divines* of good *Note*: That so he may not be thought to support his Cause by his own groundless Imaginations, instead of true Matter of Fact. As to *Strong* and *Prittie*, of whose good Note I know nothing, I leave it to Mr. *Hog* to give his Account of them. Meanwhile, I shall mention what I have learned of Mr. *Sprigge's* Character. Dr. *Calamy, ibid. Pag*. 99. says, He was Chief of the open Disciples of Sir *Henry Vane*, whose wild and extravagant Opinions and Practices he there describes; and adds, that *Sprigge* is too well known by a Book of his Sermons. This Book of *Sprigge's* is pointed at by Dr. *Owen*, in an Appendix to his *Treatise of Redemption*, where he chargeth him with most horrid Heresies; such as, the denying of Christ's Satisfaction, and teaching that

he came not to purchase, but to preach Peace to us: And that he vented such Opinions on Pretence of exalting free Grace, which was at that Time the usual *Antinomian* Cant. Dr. *Owen* also takes Notice that a Licence had been procured to that Book of *Sprigge's*, by Trick; and the Reverend Licenser imposed upon, who, when spoken to of it, disclaimed the licensing of any more thereof, than that Sermon on *Cant*. i. 1. This Appendix of Dr. *Owen's*, is dated from *Coggeshall, April* 25th 1648. And if Mr. *Strong* and *Prittie were* Divines of a like good Note, and of the *Antinomian* Kidney, their Recommendations will add small Weight to the Reputation of the Marrow, with any who have a due Regard to the Purity of Doctrine and Discipline maintained in the Church of *Scotland*.

CHAPTER II

The Marrow not cleared from the Antinomian Error, that the Believer is not obliged to mourn for Sin.

In further Vindication of the *Marrow*, he says, Page 2d, that the Author condescends upon some chief Opinions of the *Antinomists*, and refutes them. And he gives some Instances, alleging that the Author *of the Marrow* maintains the opposite Truths in the known and received Orthodox Meaning, and that therein he agrees with the learned and godly Mr. Rutherford, and other sound Divines.

Here I observe, in the first Place, That in none of these Instances, doth he adduce the Words of the Author, or any Proof of the Orthodox Meaning of the *Marrow* in them. All must be taken upon his Word, though he would not be satisfied with this Way of Dealing in others.

Now, if even in all these Instances, which his Vindicator brings in his Defence to prove his Orthodoxy, it shall be found, that he goes on in the *Antinomian* Way: It may pass for full Proof, that the Author of the *Marrow* was *Antinomian*.

Next, As to his Instances, the first, which he says the *Marrow* refutes, is, *That the Believer is not obliged to mourn for Sin*. This indeed is an *Antinomian* Opinion, but where doth the *Marrow* refute it? Let us hear the *Marrow* speak for itself, *Page* 200. "Now if the Lord be not angry with a Believer, neither doth chastise him for his Sins, as they are any Transgression of the Law of Works; then hath a Believer neither Need to confess his Sins unto God, nor crave Pardon for them, nor yet to fast, nor mourn, nor humble himself for them, as conceiving them to be any Transgression of the Law, as it is the Law of Works." Here instead of refuting, he affirms that Antinomian Paradox to be true, and defends it by his Distinction of the Law, as it is

the Law of Works, and as it is the Law of Christ. This Distinction the *General Assembly* have rejected as groundless; and in Vindication of their Judgment, it shall be further considered afterwards.

Again, he says, *Page* 208. "And therefore, you are never to confess your Sins unto the Lord, as though you conceived them to be committed against the Law of Works; and so making you liable to God's everlasting Wrath, and Hell Fire; neither must you crave Pardon and Forgiveness for them, that thereupon you may escape that Penalty, neither do you either fast, or weep, or mourn, or humble yourself, out of any Conceit, that you shall thereby satisfy the Justice of God, or appease his Wrath, either in Whole or in Part, and so escape his everlasting Vengeance. For if you be not under the Law of Works, and if the Lord see no Sin in you, as a Transgression of that Law, and be neither angry with you, nor doth afflict you for any Sin, as it is a Transgression of that Law; then consequently you have no Need either to confess your Sins, or crave Pardon for them, or fast, or weep, or mourn, or humble yourself for your Sins, as conceiving them to be any Transgression of the Law of Works." And *Page* 207. "No, nor yet as touching your Justification, and eternal Salvation; Will He [*God*] love you ever a whit the less, though you commit never so many and so great Sins?"

Will the Reverend Recommender of the *Marrow* aver, that its Author doth here refute the *Antinomian Error, That the Believer ought* not to *mourn for his Sins*? Though the Believer be not under the Law, as it requires perfect personal Obedience for his Righteousness; and as it binds over unto the Curse for every Transgression, without giving Hope of Relief: Yet is he not still under the Law, as the commanding Will of his Creator and Sovereign Lord? Will the Reverend Recommender justify the *Marrow* in these horrid Tenets? Will he maintain that Murder, Adultery, Theft, Lying, are in a Believer no Sins, no Transgressions of the Law of his Creator, which is indispensably binding upon all *Adam's* Posterity? Will he say

that Lying, disingenuous Tricking, &c. are, in a Believer, no Sins? or that they have no Guilt annexed to them; and do not deserve eternal Wrath, which would be actually inflicted, had not the Death and Satisfaction of our blessed Redeemer interposed?

And though no Man ought to mourn and humble himself out of any Conceit, that he shall thereby satisfy the Justice of God, or appease his Wrath either in Whole or in Part; (which is the usual *Antinomian* Calumny against the Orthodox Doctrine of Repentance) Will it thence follow, that a Believer ought not to mourn and be humbled before the Lord for his Sins, as they are Transgressions of the Law of his Creator, displeasing and dishonouring to a holy God, and deserving his eternal Vengeance? Yea, are not such Sins really Transgressions of that Law, which was the Rule of Obedience in the Covenant of Works? Do they not then deserve the Wages of Sin? Ought not a Believer then to make Confession of them unto God, and acknowledge that he hath deserved Wrath to be inflicted upon him for them? And ought he not to beg Pardon for Christ's Sake, and be humbled and mourn for them? yet all these are denied by the *Marrow*.

Moreover, I should be satisfied, the Reverend Recommender would be pleased to inform us of the Sentiments of the *Marrow* in this Point, *viz*. Whether or not Christ suffered and satisfied for such Sins committed by Believers? For if they be not properly Sins, or Transgressions of the Law, even of that which was in the Covenant of Works; and if Wrath and eternal Death be not threatened against them, as he maintains it is not, What Need was there of Christ's being made a Curse for them?

There is one Thing more, which I may justly demand of the Reverend Recommender, that is, that he show us how godly Mr. Rutherford, and other sound Divines do agree with the *Marrow* in this Point?

Mr. *Rutherford,* as I conceive, teacheth quite opposite Doctrine, *Survey of spiritual Antichrist, Part 2d, Page 24*. "*Antinomians* (saith he) will have no Sin remaining at all in Believers, and nothing contrary to God's holy Law. And Crispe saith, It is close removed, as if it had never been. All which is true of the Law-Guilt, and actual Obligation to eternal Wrath; but of the Essence, Being, or Blot of indwelling Sin in us, 'tis most false." And *Page* 221. "But that when the justified Person whores, swears, kills the Innocent, denieth the Lord Jesus, as did *Peter* and David, God loveth them as much as when they believe, pray, walk in all holy Conversation; and that God is not a Whit displeased with the Saints for these Sins, because all his Displeasure or revenging Justice was drowned, or swallowed up in Christ's Sufferings, is to *us abominable*." *And Witsius in Irenico*, Cap. xi. Par. 18. Neque profecto *verum est, haud indigere Homines justificatos Dolore, pœnitentia, Confessione, precibus ad* consequendam *veniam peccatorum quæ, quotidiana*, ut Tertullianus *ait, incursionis sunt, aut atrociorum* etiam, si committantur, Criminum.

CHAPTER III

The Marrow not vindicated from the Antinomian Error, that saving Faith is not to be tried by distinguishing Marks.

The second Antinomian Error which he says the Marrow refutes, is, That saving Faith is not to be tried by distinguishing Marks. I grant that the Author of the Marrow declares himself for Marks and Signs, Page 167. "Wherefore Friend Antinomista, if either you or any Man else, shall under a Pretence of being in Christ, exempt yourselves from being under the Law of the Ten Commandments, as they are the Law of Christ: I tell you truly, it is a shrewd Sign, you are not yet in Christ." And *Page* 168. "Yea indeed I stand so much upon Marks and Signs, that I say unto you in the Words of the Apostle John, In *this* the *Children of God are manifested, and* the Children of the *Devil*, 1 Joh. iii. 10. Whosoever doth *not Righteousness, is not of God*." And Pag. 286. He gives some Grounds upon which a Believer may build his believing, that he hath believed, or some Marks by which a Believer by reflecting on himself and his own Actions, may conclude his being in a State of Grace.

But this will not vindicate the *Marrow* from the Charge of *Antinomianism*; seeing there have been noted *Antinomians*, who say as much: So Robert *Towne* in his Assertion of Grace, *Page* 120. "But I wonder that you blush not so Papistically to slander us, as if those good Works which arise from a true and lively Faith, for the Joy of Favour and Blessedness already obtained by Christ, to declare the Truth of our Conversion, to glorify God, &c. Were our great Eye-sore, whereas your own Heart in your Bosom will sufficiently acquit us." And *Page* 171. "This discovereth the Vanity of *their* Profession and Faith, in whom Christ, and the Love of God in him, doth not effectually move and constrain to walk worthy of so high and heavenly a

Calling, such have not heard Christ, nor been taught by him, as the Truth is in Jesus; true Faith purifieth the Heart," &c. And *John Saltmarsh's Free-Grace, Pag*. 31. Edit. 1st, allows a lower Way of Persuasion unto Man from Sanctification. His *Words* are, "*And for* establishing *Souls upon any Works of their own, as Way, Means, or Ground of Assurance, as that upon such a Measure of Repentance or Obedience they may believe by, I dare not deal in any such Way of our own Righteousness; because I find no infallible Mark* in any *Thing of our own Sanctification, save in* a lower Way of Persuasion *or Motive*."

Seeing then that Antinomians speak after the same Manner, we must enquire if the Author of the *Marrow* explain himself in this Matter, according to the known and received Sense of the Orthodox.

1. And, *First*, I observe, That the Author of the *Marrow* overturneth the Necessity of seeking after Assurance, by Marks of saving Faith; seeing he placeth Assurance in the Nature and Essence of that Faith, which the Gospel requireth of all its Hearers. He describes believing on Christ (P. 119.) to be a Man's persuading himself in his Heart that Jesus Christ is his, and that he shall have Life and Salvation by him; and that whatever Christ did for the Redemption of Mankind, he did it for him in particular. He teacheth, That a Sinner is to make sure his Election by believing it, P. 122. That he is to believe that Christ hath loved him, and given himself for him, as *Paul said, Gal. ii. 20. who loved* me; not doubting but that he is one of those to whom this [me] belongeth, P. 123. and that by Christ he is freely and fully justified and acquitted from all his Sins, P. 175. Now, if this be saving Faith, what Need is there of looking after Marks and Signs for attaining Assurance? If the Sinner want saving Faith, in vain will he seek after Marks in himself, to evidence the Truth of it. If he hath Faith, he hath this Persuasion, That God hath loved him, Christ hath died for him; that his Sins are pardoned, and that he is fully and freely justified. To what Purpose then shall he by Marks and Signs of his Faith, seek after Assurance of these Things, when he hath it

already? Hence the Author of the *Marrow* seems to be against Self-examination; for P. 220. upon that Passage of Scripture, 2 Cor. xiii. 5. where the Apostle exhorts, saying, *examine your selves whether ye be in the Faith*; he, in modest Contradiction to the Apostle, *tells Neoph*. "*I would not have you to make any Question of it, since you have grounded your Faith upon such a firm Foundation as will never fail you*." And to show how far he is from agreeing with godly *Rutherford* in this Point, I shall adduce a few of many Passages in his Writings, *Christ dying, Page* 249. "It is utterly false, that the Gospel Faith commanded to all Elect and Reprobate, is the Apprehension of God's eternal Love to me in particular, the Scripture saith no such Thing. P. 259. To believe that God hath loved you with an everlasting Love (before that ye will; *Simon* Magus, Judas, or others) is *the Antinomian* Faith." And P. 450. "But Faith is formally no such Persuasion, as to be persuaded, That every Man is loved with an everlasting Love, chosen and redeemed in Christ; for it changeth the whole Gospel into a Lie; Christ obligeth no Man to believe an Untruth. — It is mere Presumption, not Faith, That all Hypocrites, &c. should immediately believe Christ is their Saviour; died for them, &c." And in *his* Survey of the spiritual Antichrist, he *says*, P. 143. "So then here is the *Antinomian* Faith, That all and every one immediately, without Sense of Sin or Sickness for Christ, be they Elect or Reprobate, believe and be persuaded, that God decreed to give his Son for them in particular, loved them with the special Love of Election, and that Christ has satisfied, and was crucified for their Sins. Sure this is not the Object of Gospel Faith, but is a transparent Untruth and a Lie." And judicious Mr. Durham on the Revelation, P. 263. in 4to. saith, "It is to be adverted then, That when we are called to believe in Christ, we are not called instantly to believe that Christ hath offered up himself a Satisfaction for us in particular; but we are to conceive of it in this Order: — But if any will invert the Order, and persuade himself at first, That the Benefits of Christ's Purchase do belong to him, as being particularly

redeemed by his Death, before he actually rest on him by Faith; this will prove but strong Presumption, and never give Title to Christ, or any Thing that is his: But on the Contrary greatly provoke the Lord. — And so according to these Grounds we see, That all Hearers are not simply and instantly called to believe, that Christ did die for them."

2. I observe, The Author of the *Marrow*, in explaining his Mind about the Marks of Faith, and the Assurance arising therefrom, doth maintain this Assurance to be in the direct Act of Faith, which therefore must be prior and preferable to the other, see *Pag*. 220, 221. A Friend of the Reverend Recommender, in a Letter dated *November* 18. 1718. explains this in the following Words, "There is a two-fold Assurance, one in the Reflex Act of Faith, and the other in the direct Act: But this is more noble, more permanent, more satisfying, and gives more eminent Glory to God, being immediately built upon the Divine Object, and sure Testimony of God, without the Man, and not upon the created Work of God within the Man, in the clear Discovery thereof, which for ordinary is of a short Continuance: and then, where is the Act of Assurance? And if there be such an Assurance in the direct Act of Faith, they must agree with *Saltmarsh* above cited, that the Assurance arising from the reflex Act, and Marks of Sanctification, is in a lower Way of Persuasion or Motive. Yea, the Author of the *Marrow* makes Assurance, by Marks and Signs, a very low Way of Persuasion; for he accounts all Marks to be but deceitful, if they be looked upon without having Reference to Jesus Christ as the Root and Fountain of them, *Page* 170. "If any Man pitch upon the Sign, without the Thing signified by the Sign; that is, If he pitch upon his Graces (or Gifts rather) and Duties, and conclude Assurance from them, as they are in him, and come from him, without having Reference to Jesus Christ as the Root and Fountain of them; then are they deceitful Marks and Signs: But if he look upon them with Reference to Jesus Christ, then are they not deceitful, but true Evidences and Demonstrations of Faith in Christ. Well, *what is*

the Meaning of *this*? *it is explained as follows*. And this a Man doth, when he looks upon his outward Actions, as flowing from the inward Actions of his Mind; and upon the inward Actions of his Mind, as flowing from the Habits of Grace within him; and upon the Habits of Grace within him, as flowing from his Justification; and upon his Justification, as flowing from his Faith; and upon his Faith, as given by, and embracing Jesus Christ: Thus I *say*, if he rests not till he comes to Christ, his Marks and Signs *are* not deceitful, but true." He had before professed that he was for Marks and Signs, P. 168. and that herein Works are to be extolled and commended, in that they are Fruits and Signs of Faith, P. 169. But here, what he had given with the one Hand, he takes away with the other, by rendering these Marks and Signs useless, to clear a Man's Interest in Christ, unless he know it, and be persuaded of it before.

The Case stands plainly thus: I am to examine and try myself if I be in the Faith, if I be a true Believer, if I be in Christ, and justified freely by his Grace. How shall I know this? By the Graces of the Spirit and holy Duties, which are Fruits of Faith, and Marks and Signs of an Interest in Christ. Well, but how shall I know that these Marks and Signs are true, and not deceitful? Replies the Author of the *Marrow, They are true Signs, if you look upon them as flowing from your Justification*. But what is this looking? is it only my Apprehension that may deceive me, or is it a certain Knowledge, that they do flow from my Justification? surely it must be a certain and well grounded Knowledge: Then I must know certainly that I am in Christ, and justified, before these Marks can be true Evidences to me that I am in Christ: I must know certainly that my Faith is given me by Christ, before these Marks can be Evidences to me of the Truth of my Faith. But now again, how shall I come to know certainly that I am in Christ, and justified, and that my Faith is given me by Christ? and what is the Ground and Evidence upon which this Knowledge is founded? If I shall be here again sent back to the

Fruits of my Faith, as the true Marks and Evidences of my being in Christ, and justified; then I must know that they flow from my Justification by Faith, and that my Faith is given me by Christ. And so I must run Round in a perpetual Circle, without ever coming to a comfortable Issue of Assurance by these Marks and Signs. Here seems to be a Passage in *the Marrow*, of such Difficulty, that it may well deserve a Place in the *Explication of Passages*.

But what can be the Meaning of the Marrow? doth he mean, That a Man must be persuaded of his being in Christ, and justified, before the Marks can be any true Evidence unto him that he is so? Yea, he means so; and further, he plainly maintains, *That a Man cannot* forsake Sin, *nor exercise any Christian Grace, or perform any Christian Duty aright, till first he apprehend God's Favour, and believe that his Sins are pardoned; and till by Faith he know that God hath loved him in Christ; and where this Assurance of God's Love is wanting, all is Hypocrisy. See Marrow, Pag. 137*. and 176, 177, &c. How then can a Man attain Assurance of his being in Christ by these Marks, seeing according to the *Marrow*, they are all Hypocrisy, if they do not flow from a previous Assurance of his being beloved of God in Christ?

It may also be reasonably enquired, What Foundation there is for this Assurance, in the direct Act of Faith, which is before all Exercise of Grace? It must be a Revelation which the Man is bound to believe, or else his Assurance is groundless: But this Revelation is not made in the written Word of God: It is not therein revealed to every Hearer of the Gospel in particular, that God hath loved him in Christ, that Christ hath died for him, and that all his Sins are freely pardoned. This Revelation therefore must be made unto him immediately by God: And then his Faith, whereby he believes it, cannot be an Assent unto a Divine Truth, upon the Divine Testimony recorded in the holy Scriptures: But it must be an Assent unto an inward Inspiration, manifesting unto the Man God's electing, and Christ's redeeming Love to him in particular. And this the

Author of the *Marrow* seems to point at, when calling *Neophytus* to reflect upon what had passed in his Soul at his first Believing, he says, P. 221. *And I am persuaded, you have thereupon felt a Secret Persuasion in your Heart, that God in Christ doth bear a Love to you*.

CHAPTER IV

The Doctrine of the Marrow about Justification from Eternity, and in Time doth not purge it of Antinomianism.

The third Antinomian Opinion, which he says the Marrow refutes, is, *That* Justification is *from all Eternity*; and adds, P. 2. In Opposition whereunto our Author shows, *That the justifying Sentence passeth in Time, in the known and* received *Sense of the Orthodox. He also rejecteth and refelleth the Antinomian Opinion concerning* Justification *by Faith; which they say is to be understood only declaratively; and he evinceth to be really in the known Orthodox Meaning. In all which the learned* and godly Mr. Rutherford, *and other sound Divines, who have treated these Controversies, do* agree with him.

1. Here I observe, First, That though the Author of the *Marrow* deny Justification to be from all Eternity; yet that doth not purge him of *Antinomianism*: For some *Antinomians* also deny this; and hold that Men are justified from the Death of Christ on the Cross; and others of them hold, That Men are justified from their Birth. Antinomians (as *Rutherford* saith, Survey, *Part* 2. P. 142.) fall out among themselves touching this Point.

2. *Next*, I observe, The Reverend Vindicator gives us no Account where the *Marrow* speaks of a declarative and a real Justification, or what he means by Faith's justifying declaratively and really, and what he understands by the known Orthodox Meaning in this Point, that so we might have compared the same with the Sentiments of sound Divines: but keeps in general Terms, as if every Thing he advanceth were to be received upon his simple Word.

3. I observe further, That if we inquire impartially into the true Meaning of the *Marrow*, we shall find it favourable unto the *Antinomian Way. Speaking of Neophytus now become a Believer*, he

saith, *Page 148. It is true*, in Respect *of God's Decree, he was justified from all Eternity, and he was justified meritoriously in the Death and* Resurrection *of Christ; but yet he was not justified actually, till he did actually believe in Christ*. Here in his first and second Way of Justification, he favoureth the *Antinomians*, and speaks in their, and not in the Orthodox Dialect: It is true, God from Eternity decreed to justify the Elect in Time: But to say, That a Man was justified from Eternity, in Respect of God's Decree, is an *Antinomian* Way of speaking, and disproved by Mr. *Rutherford,* who saith, *Survey, Part* 2. *Page 19. Justification in God's Decree and Purpose from Eternity, is no more Justification than* Creation, Sanctification, &*c. for all those were in the eternal Purpose of God*. Again, it may be truly said, That the Death of Christ on the Cross, (comprehending his Obedience, which was then consummate) is the meritorious Cause of Justification; yet it cannot be properly said, That a Man was justified in Christ's Death. Mr. *Rutherford* disclaims this also, *ibid. P. 20. The Scripture no where speaketh of Justification, but by Faith only. The meritorious Price of our Justification was paid on the Cross, but that is* not *Justification*. His third *Way* of Justification is expressed in an Orthodox Phrase, when he says, *He was not actually justified, till he did actually believe in Christ*: For here actual Justification is placed as a Consequent of Faith in Christ. But what means he by actual *Justification*? He doth not here say, That this Justification by Faith is not to be understood declaratively, but really, as his Vindicator pretends.

To set this Matter in a clear Light, I suppose the Reverend Defender of the *Marrow* will not refuse, That it is real and actual Justification, which in our shorter Catechism is described to *be, An Act of God's free Grace, whereby* he pardoneth *all our Sins, and accepteth us as righteous in* his Sight, *only for the Righteousness of Christ imputed to us, and received by Faith alone*. Here the Object of justifying Faith, is Christ and his Righteousness; the Act of it is a receiving and resting thereon; and the Effect following thereupon is Justification, or God's gracious pardoning and accepting the Sinner thus believing:

This is believing unto Righteousness, *Rom*. x. 10. and believing in Jesus Christ, that we may be justified, Gal. ii. 16.

Again, If any Man shall maintain, That the Object of the Faith required of all the Hearers of the Gospel, and proposed to be believed, is, God hath loved you in Christ, Christ hath died for you, and your Sins are pardoned for Christ's Sake; and that the Act of this Faith is a Man's believing and Persuasion, that his Sins are pardoned; and shall consequently hold, that Justification is prior to Faith, or that a Man is justified before he believe: I suppose it will be granted, that this Man understands Justification by Faith, to be only declaratively, and not in the received Orthodox Meaning.

Now if it shall be made evident, That the Author of the *Marrow* is of this latter Opinion; it will as plainly follow, that his Vindicator was mistaken in saying, That he understood Justification by Faith in the known Orthodox Sense.

That this is the Opinion of the *Marrow*, may be gathered from what we observed before of his making *Assurance, or a Man's believing that God hath loved him in Christ, to be* essential to Faith, and in the direct Act of it. And for further Proof thereof, we shall adduce some other Passages, *Marrow, Pag. 120*. "*Even so our good King, the Lord of Heaven and Earth, hath* for the *Obedience and Desert of our good Brother, Jesus Christ, pardoned all our Sins, and made a Proclamation throughout the whole World, that every one of us may safely return to God in Jesus Christ: wherefore I beseech you make no Doubt of it*, but *draw near with a true Heart, in full* Assurance of *Faith*." Here he is exhorting *Neophytus* to believe the Gospel preached to every Creature under Heaven; the Thing he proposeth to him to be believed, is that God hath pardoned all our Sins, and made open Proclamation of this Pardon: The Act of Faith required is to make no Doubt of it; which is to be verily persuaded. Now God's pardoning our Sins, is a Part of our Justification: Therefore, he must hold that a Man is pardoned, i. e. justified

before he believe. For the Act of Faith presupposeth its Object, and God doth not command Men to believe an Untruth.

Again, the Marrow placeth the Nature of this Faith in a Man's applying particularly to himself what is spoken in General concerning God's pardoning of Sin; and that by persuading himself that God hath loved him, and pardoned his Sins. *Pag. 120. Forasmuch as the holy Scripture speaketh to all in General, none of us ought to distrust himself, but believe that it belongeth particularly to himself. Page 121, 122. God offers* the *Pardon generally to all: — I should rather move every Man to give Diligence to make his Calling and Election sure, by believing it. Page 123. Say then with a firm Faith, The Righteousness of Jesus Christ belongs to all that believe*, [i. e. persuade *themselves that it doth belong particularly to them,] but I believe, [i. e. I am really persuaded that it belongs particularly to me;] and therefore it belongs to me. And on these Words*, Gal. ii. 20. Who *loved me; he saith, O print this Word [me] in your Heart, and apply it to your own self, not doubting but that you are one of those to whom this* [me] *belongeth*. And P. 124. speaking of espousing the Soul to Christ, he saith; *Wherefore* I beseech you *to believe it, and then you shall be sure to enjoy* it. Hence he teacheth Men to conclude from the General Scripture Phrases, that they have particular Interest in *them: Marrow, Page* 127, *128. I am sure he hath said, He came not to judge the World, but to save the World, Joh. xii. 47. And therefore I do believe, that he will save me*. Yea from their being convinced of Sin, he teacheth them to infer their Justification, *Page* 129. If *you were a righteous and godly Man, you were neither capable of calling, justifying or saving; but being a sinful and ungodly Man, I will be bold to say unto you, as the People* said to blind Bartimeus, *Mark x. 49. Be of* good Comfort, arise, he calleth thee; and will justify and save thee. *Pag*. 172. *Let every true convicted Person then, who fears the* Wrath *of God, Death and Hell, when they* hear or *read any such Places of Scripture, as do appertain* to the Law, *not think the same to belong to them. And P. 274. But let all self-denying, fearful, trembling Souls, apply the gracious and sweet Promises of God in Christ unto themselves; and rejoice, because their*

Names are written in Heaven. Here legal Conviction is made the Ground of Assurance, which Assurance, he says (as *was* showed before) must be in the Soul before any true Repentance, or Love to God.

And *Pag. 175. Neophytus giving* an Account of his Faith, which he had been exhorted unto, saith, I *do now in some small Measure believe, that I am by Christ freely and fully justified, and acquitted from all my Sins*. So his Justification is made the Object of his Belief: And *Page* 176. The Author describes this Faith to be a Man's believing God's Love to him in Christ: And *Page* 177. "A seeing and conceiving of God as a merciful and loving Father, who hath freely pardoned and forgiven him all his Sins. A knowing himself to be beloved of God. A believing the Love of God to him in Christ, in pardoning his Iniquity, and passing by his Transgressions." And *Page* 186. A Man's believing that he is justified freely by God's Grace through that Redemption that is in Jesus Christ. And *Page* 191. He exhorts *Nomista* to believe this Interest in Christ, that so he may work. And P. 192. He makes the Thing proposed unto Sinners to be by them believed, to be, That their Sins are pardoned, when he says of a Preacher, that durst not exhort nor persuade Sinners to believe their Sins were pardoned, before he saw their Lives reformed, that he was ignorant of the Mystery of Faith.

From all which we may conclude, that the Mystery of Faith in the Opinion of the Marrow, is, That Christ died for every one to whom the Gospel is preached, that thereupon God pardons all their Sins, and proclaims this Pardon to the whole World, that every one is to believe that this Pardon belongs to him in particular. And if he say that hereupon the Man is justified, let every Private Christian judge, if this Justification can be any other but declarative.

As to the Agreement of Sound Divines with the *Marrow* in this Point; the pious Mr. *Rutherford* is so far from making this the Object of Faith proposed in the Gospel, *viz*. I am beloved *of God, Christ intended to die for me, I* am justified, *and my Sins are*

pardoned: That he plainly asserts it to be no Gospel at all. Because this belongs to God's secret Purpose of Election of particular Persons, which is kept hid in God's Mind, till he be pleased to reveal it by the Fruits thereof. *Christ dying*, Page 452. "We do not read in the Old or New Testament, that the Decree, Purpose or Intention of God to save and redeem Persons in particular, is the Object of that saving Faith required in the Gospel. — That he came to save me in particular is apprehended by Sense, not by Faith. For the Election of me by Name to Glory, and the Lord's Intention to die for me, is neither Promise, nor Precept, nor Threatening. If it be a History that I must believe, 'tis good: But show me Histories of particular Men now to be believed," &c. See further, *Page* 449, 450, 451. where Mr. *Rutherford* cites and confutes this Opinion of *Saltmarsh* the *Antinomian*; but doth not with the *Marrow* persuade Persons to make their Election sure by believing it. And in his Treatise Of *the Covenant of Grace, Page* 209. he delivereth his Judgment in the following Words, "The Faith of God's special Grace is two Ways so called. 1. As it leaneth upon, and apprehendeth God in Christ, for the obtaining of Mercy and Remission of Sins, and imputed Righteousness: So Faith goes before Justification, and we believe that our Sins may be pardoned, and that our Sins may not be imputed, and that we may be justified and freed from Condemnation: So by the Act of believing, Righteousness is imputed to us. And this Justification and Remission, i. e. Relaxing of our Persons from a State of eternal Condemnation, (as is meant, *Rom*. viii. 1.) Is not the Object of Faith, but the Effect and Fruit of Faith. 2. The Faith of special Mercy to me, is considered as it apprehendeth and believeth, or rather feelingly knoweth, special Mercy, Imputation of Christ's Righteousness now given to me, and as Christ hath payed the Ransom for me, and satisfied Justice for me; and so imputed Righteousness and Justification are the Object of Faith, or rather the Object of the Sense of Faith, which is most carefully to be observed." See also Mr. *Durham* on the *Revelation, Page*

263. in 4to, in the Passage above adduced, which I shall not here repeat.

From all which I conclude, That the Author of the *Marrow* doth not agree with Mr. *Rutherford* and other Sound Divines, in the several Instances adduced by his Vindicator to clear him from the Charge of *Antinomianism*.

CHAPTER V

The Marrow teacheth that Repentance goeth not before Justification.

The *Marrow* might be justly charged with other *Antinomian* Errors, besides these mentioned by its Reverend Recommender. I shall add their erroneous Doctrine about Repentance, concerning *which Antinomians* teach,

1. That true Repentance doth not go before Justification; and therefore Ministers of the Gospel ought not to call Sinners to repent, or forsake their Sins, in order unto the Pardon of them.

2. That all Gospel Repentance flows from a Sense and Persuasion of the Forgiveness of Sins; and therefore, before a Man truly repent, he must not only be justified, but also have Assurance of the Love of God to him in pardoning his Sins.

The Reverend Recommender of the Marrow doth own, That the former Instances adduced by him are *Antinomian* Errors: But I doubt if he will also acknowledge this their Doctrine of Repentance to be erroneous. The Reason of my Doubt is, because this Doctrine of Repentance is of very nigh Affinity with the *Auchterarder* Position, which says, *That it is not sound to teach, that we must forsake Sin in Order unto our coming to Christ, and being instated in Covenant with God*: And he has undertaken the Defence of this Position in a Print, entitled, A *Letter to a Gentleman concerning the* Auchterarder *Affair*. I suppose that a Man's being instated in Covenant with God, will be allowed to import a justified State; and if we must not forsake Sin in Order unto it, then Repentance doth not go before Remission of Sins. Wherefore, I choose the rather to insist upon this further Instance of the *Antinomianism* of the *Marrow*, that it is omitted by its Recommender. And I shall, *first*, Show that the Doctrine about Repentance above-

mentioned, is the Opinion of the *Marrow*; and in the next Place, I shall prove it to be erroneous.

First, It is a great Presumption, That the Author of the *Marrow* favours this Doctrine, while in his whole Book (though he wanted not Occasion) he doth not teach the Necessity of Repentance, in Order unto the Remission of Sins, nor doth he exhort Sinners to repent, that they may obtain Forgiveness. Yea, on the contrary, he accounts them ignorant who do so, in his Preface, *Page 3. And is there not at Hand some ignorant, miserable Comforter ready to say, Yet do not despair Man, but repent of thy Sins, and ask God Forgiveness, and reform your Life, and doubt not but he will be merciful unto you*, for he *hath promised (you know) that at what Time soever a Sinner repenteth him of his Sins, he will forgive him*. Why is a Minister to be branded with Ignorance, who deals thus with Sinners? Doth not God command all Men every where to repent? And hath he not by his gracious Promise connected Forgiveness with Repentance? If indeed a Minister should teach Repentance only, and not preach Christ, and the *Way* of Salvation through him, nor call Sinners to believe on him for Remission of Sins, he were blameworthy. But are not both Faith and Repentance to be joined together, unless God hath made Faith, but not Repentance necessary, in Order unto his forgiving of Sins? Would he thus simply, and without Limitation, condemn the Preaching of Repentance unto Sinners, if it were not his Opinion, that it is not necessary in Order to the Remission of Sins? If a Sinner shall rest on his Repentance for his Righteousness, it is his Fault; if his Repentance do not bring him to Christ for obtaining Remission of his Sins, 'tis no true Repentance: But the Preaching of Repentance is not to be condemned, because Sinners may abuse it.

Secondly, The Author of the *Marrow* exhorts unto Believing in such a Manner, and in such Expressions, as exclude Repentance from being necessary in Order unto Forgiveness. *Pag. 118. In this Covenant [of Grace] there is not any Condition or Law to be performed on Man's Part, by himself; no, there is no more*

for him to do, but only to know and believe that Christ hath done all for him. If this be so, then a Man must believe that Christ hath repented for him, and that his own repenting is not requisite for his obtaining Remission of Sins. Again, Ibid. *Here you are* to do *Nothing, here you are to render Nothing unto God, but only to receive the Treasure which is Jesus Christ, and apprehend him in your Heart by Faith*, although *you be never so great a Sinner, and so you shall obtain Forgiveness of Sins, Righteousness, and eternal Happiness*. — If the Sinner is to do Nothing, but only to believe, then in this Author's Opinion, he is not called to repent him of his Sins, in Order unto his obtaining Forgiveness. *Thirdly*, He delivers this his Opinion yet more plainly in Edition 2d of the Marrow, Pag. 135, 136. To Nomista's Objection, viz. Suppose he hath not as yet either humbled himself, or repented for his great and many Sins, hath he any Warrant to come to Christ till he hath done so? He answers, "I see you have not yet quite thrown down your tottering Building, you still conceive that a Man himself must do Something in the Case of Justification, you think he must bring some Money in his Hand to buy his Salvation: But I beseech you consider, that God's Covenant in Christ, is a Covenant of Grace, and so every *Way* a free Covenant; and therefore he makes a general Proclamation, saying, Isa. lv. 1. — And the Lord saith in his Word in divers Places, That he justifies his Children before they repent or truly humble themselves." [Here he cites *Cornwell* on *Gospel Repentance, Page* 6.] "The Truth is, it is only required that a Man come with the Hand of Faith, and receive Christ without any Thing else at all."

Here now is plain Dealing, Repentance is expressly excluded, as not required in Order unto Justification; and in his Opinion God justifieth Sinners before they repent or truly humble themselves. And this he confirms by the Authority of Mr. Cornwell a noted Antinomian. He also introduceth this Answer with the usual *Antinomian* Calumny against sound Protestant Divines; as if they, when they exhort Sinners to repent and believe, taught them to bring their Repentance as

Money in their Hand to buy their Salvation, and to rest on it as their Righteousness before God: Whereas, they teach that Repentance is neither the meritorious nor instrumental Cause of our Justification before God, but a Qualification wrought by his Spirit in the Person, whom he will freely justify, and to which he has been pleased graciously to annex the Promise of Pardon. But the Author of the *Marrow* will not allow so much as this Place unto Repentance. For *Nomista* having objected, that he doth not conceive that this Humiliation and Repentance are to be tendered unto Christ for a Price; but as what he hath appointed these to be qualified withal that come unto him: He answers, "I, but yet so long as Christ hath said you must come without it, and only incline your Ear and hear, and your Souls shall live, and that by hearing that, he will make an everlasting Covenant with you, even the sure Mercies of *David*; methinks you should perceive that Christ doth thereby call you from the Ways of Repentance and Humiliation, and Works of Righteousness in the Case of Justification, and to pitch directly and immediately upon the free Covenant of Grace." And cites again on the Margin, *Cornwell the Antinomian on Gospel Repentance, Page* 21.

Here the Man opens his Mind, in a bold Assertion, that Christ calls Sinners from the Way of Repentance and Humiliation, and bids them come without it. Then farewell Repentance; you were by ancient Divines esteemed a Companion of Faith, and necessary unto Forgiveness; but now, on Pretence of exalting free Grace, you are by the *Modern Divinity* of this *Antinomian*, dismissed and discarded as useless and hurtful. But doth not Christ himself call Sinners to Repentance, hath he not said, Mark i. *15. Repent ye, and believe the Gospel*?

His Answer to this is a further Confirmation of his Opinion, *ibid. Page 137. Indeed, sometimes the Name of Repentance is given to these preparatory Beginnings, and Introductories* thereof, *which are these legal Fits of Fear and Terror, which are both in Nature and Time before Faith*. And truly, *all that Repentance*

that goes before Faith in Christ, can be no other; for Evangelical Repentance being a Fruit of Faith in Christ, cannot be before Faith in Christ. So it is his Opinion, that when our Saviour came preaching the Gospel of the Kingdom of God, *Mark i. 14, 15. he* did not call Men to true, gracious, and Evangelical Repentance, but only to some legal Fits of Fear and Terror. What Thoughts could this Man entertain of Christ's preaching the Gospel? would he blasphemously account our blessed Saviour a legal Preacher? would he have him reckoned worse than his ignorant and miserable Comforters, mentioned, *Preface, Page* 3. For they there call Men unto something more than legal Fits of Fear and Terror, when they exhort them to repent of their Sins.

In the Editions of the *Marrow*, that were published after this second, the Author hath made some Alterations in the Passages above cited; he hath left out the Quotations from *Cornwell* the *Antinomian*, particularly that Expression, *The Lord hath said in his Word in divers Places, that he justifies his Children before they repent, or truly humble themselves*; and that other Assertion, That Christ *hath said, You must come without Repentance*. He also gives another Answer to the Objection from *Mark i. 15*. But though he hath made some Changes by omitting and adding, yet he only acteth the *sly* Antinomian, without retracting his Opinion, as may be evident to any who will be at Pains to compare the second Edition with the Subsequent; and particularly that at *Edinburgh*, to which the Reverend Recommender's Preface is prefixed, and which I shall follow.

In P. 134. Nomista saith, Suppose he hath not as yet truly repented for his many and great Sins, hath he any Warrant to come unto Christ by believing, till he hath done so? He answers, I tell you truly, That whatsoever a Man is, or whatsoever he hath done or not done, he hath Warrant enough to come unto Christ by believing, if he can; for Christ makes a general Proclamation, Isa. lv. 1, &c.

Here, by this Answer, Repentance is laid aside; a Man may come without it, whatsoever he hath done, or not done: And what doth he come for? surely for Righteousness, and Remission of Sins. And so a Sinner may be pardoned, and justified without repenting of his Sins. He doth not here mention the Object of Believing; but he shows afterward, that he meaneth A Man's believing God's Love to him in pardoning his Sins, which, he thinks, must go before Evangelical Repentance.

He thinks the Invitation, Isa. lv. 1. excludes Repentance as not necessary in Order to Remission; but he might have seen the Contrary from v. 7. But the Call here is directed to every one that thirsteth: Is not then Thirsting required in them that come? No, not so much as this in his Opinion. For unto this Objection he answers, P. 135. from *Rev. xxii. 17. And* whosoever *will, let him take of the Waters of Life freely, even without thirsting, if he will. So*, according to the Sentiments of the *Marrow*, a Sinner may obtain the Waters of Life, at least the Benefits of Pardon, and Righteousness, without repenting of his Sins, or so much as Thirsting for these Blessings. Thirsting imports an anxious Sense of Need, and an ardent Desire after what we want: And can a dead Sinner have a Willingness to come to Christ for spiritual Blessings, before this Thirsting be wrought in him?

Moreover, *Page* 136. having given a Description of Repentance, That it consists in a Man's humbling himself before God; and sorrowing and grieving for offending him by his Sins; and in turning from them all to the Lord; He adds, *And would you have a Man to do all this truly, before he come to Christ by believing*? — *Why, then I tell you truly, you would have him to do that which is impossible*. This appears pretty decisive; and the Question is not, what a Man may do by his own natural Powers, but through the efficacious Grace of God: As is evident from the Reasons he assigns of this alleged Impossibility. His first and second Reasons are, "That Humiliation and Sorrow for displeasing God by Sin,

necessarily argue the Love of God; and it is impossible we should ever love God, till by Faith we know ourselves loved of God. *And in his third Reason he says*, The Truth is, a repentant Sinner first believes that God will do that which he promiseth, namely pardon his Sin, and take away his Iniquity, then he resteth on the Hope of it; and from that, and for it he leaves Sin, and will forsake his old Course, because it is displeasing to God, and will do that which is pleasing and acceptable to him. So that at first of all, God's Favour is apprehended, and Remission of Sins believed: Then upon that cometh Alteration of Life and Conversation." Thus he judgeth it impossible, that there can be any gracious Repentance in a Sinner, before he know that God hath loved him, and pardoned his Sins.

In *Page* 137. To the Objection, *That the Lord hath appointed Repentance to go before Faith; because it is said, Mark i. 15. Repent and believe the Gospel. He answers, That the Word* Repent, *in the Original, signifies, A Change of our Mind from false Ways to the Right, and of our Hearts from Evil to Good*. By false Ways he understands Errors in Judgment, such as were these of the *Pharisees* and *Sadducees*, as he afterwards explains: But what he means by a Change of the Heart from Evil to Good, is not so obvious. If he mean any gracious Change, he confounds it with Faith, the second Duty our Saviour exhorts unto in that Text. But seeing he is speaking of Repentance, as it goes before Faith, it is more probable that he means that Change whereby a profane sensual Man becomes a strict *Pharisee* or legal Professor, as he expresseth it; For it can be no gracious saving Change, seeing he placeth Faith before all Habits of Grace, P. 179. and before the new Principles of Actions, P. 189. And therefore, in his Opinion, there can be no gracious Change in the Soul before Faith. And that he is speaking of a Change that goes before Faith, is evident, from the Conclusion of his Answer, P. 139, 140. *Now, with Submission to better Judgments, I do conceive, that if there be in the Book of God any Repentance exhorted unto before Faith in Christ; or if any Repentance go either*

in Order of Nature or Time, before Faith in Christ, it is only such a like Repentance as this.

But though he deny any gracious Repentance to go before Faith and Justification, yet he doth not exclude it altogether, but allows it to follow after Assurance of God's Love. To this Purpose he saith, P. 141. "Yea indeed, I hold That although it go not before as an Antecedent of Faith, yet it follows as a Consequent; for when a Man believes the Love of God to him in Christ, then he loves God, because he loved him first: and that Love constrains him to humble himself at the Lord's Foot-stool, and to acknowledge himself to be less than the least of all his Mercies; yea, and then will he remember his own evil Ways and Doings that were not good, and will loathe himself in his own Sight for his Iniquities, and for his Abominations."

Here again, the Object of a Man's Faith is said to be the Love of God to him in Christ; and a Man's believing this Love of God to him in Christ, is said to go before all true gracious Repentance.

Enough hath been said to clear the Opinion of the *Marrow*; I shall only adduce one Passage more to confirm all, P. 177. "Though a Man, before he believe God's Love to him in Christ, may have a great Measure of legal Humiliation, Compunction, Sorrow and Grief, and be brought down (as it were) to the very Gate of Hell, and feel the very Flashings of Hell Fire in his Conscience for his Sins; yet it is not because he hath thereby offended God; but rather because he hath thereby offended himself; that is, because he hath thereby brought himself into the Danger of eternal Death and Condemnation: but when once he believes the *Love of God to him in Christ, in pardoning his Iniquity, and passing by his Transgressions*, then he sorrows and grieves for the Offence given to God by his Sin, reasoning thus with himself, And is it so indeed? Hath the Lord given his own Son to Death for me, who have been such a vile sinful Wretch? — And this is true Gospel Mourning, and this is right Evangelical Repentance."

According to this Account of the Marrow, true Gospel Repentance flows from a Man's believing the Love of God to him in pardoning his Sins, and all that goes before this, is but legal Humiliation, or legal Fits of Fear and Terror, which may be in the Reprobate who perish eternally. And therefore, a Man must not only be justified, but also have the Assurance of his Pardon, before he repent with a gracious and Evangelical Repentance; and consequently Ministers of the Gospel ought not to call Sinners to Repent and forsake their Sins, in Order unto the Pardon of them.

These Passages laid together, and compared one with another, may give full Satisfaction concerning the Opinion of the Author of the *Marrow* to any who shall be at Pains impartially to consider them: So that I hope there shall be no just Ground of Complaint, that the *Marrow* is unfairly Represented in this Matter.

CHAPTER VI

That Gospel Repentance goes before Remission of Sins, proved against the Marrow.

It is evident from what hath been said, That the Question is not about that Repentance that may be in the Unregenerate, or legal Fits of Fear and Terror, such as was in *Judas*, whose Repentance issued in self Murder, *Mat*. xxvii. 3, 4, 5. For the Author of the *Marrow* grants that this may go before Remission. Nor is the Question about that Self-loathing and mourning for Sin, which flows from a Sense of Pardon, or an Intimation and Assurance that a Believer may have, of God's Love to him in blotting out his Iniquities: for that plainly supposeth his being already Justified.

Neither is the present Question concerning Repentance unto Life, its going before the justifying Act of Faith. The Vindicator of the *Marrow* in his Answer to the *Snake*, P. 8. doth indeed quarrel the Author of the *Snake* for naming Repentance before Faith, and determines dogmatically for the Precedency of Faith. His Words are, *Neither setteth he the Blessings, viz. Faith and Repentance, in their proper Order, being that in which our Catechisms rank them. He speaks of that Penitency which hath Faith accompanying it, and therefore he ought to have put Faith in the first Place, forasmuch as Repentance unto Life issues from saving Faith*. But the Vindicator might have spared this his Remark, if he had allowed himself to consult our *Larger Catechism, Quest*. 153. where the *Westminster* Divines put Repentance in the first Place, as well as in the Passage of their *Directory*, adduced by the Author of the *Snake*. And they give very good Authority for their so doing, by citing the Words of the Apostle, Acts xx. 21. who taught Repentance toward God, and Faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ. Our Lord puts Repentance in the first Place; Mark i. 15. *Repent ye, and believe the* Gospel; and when he is

said there to preach the Gospel of the Kingdom of God, I hope he will allow our Saviour's Order to be proper. He may also consider our Lord's Words unto the Priests and Elders of the *Jews; Mat*. xxi. 32. *And ye repented not afterward, that ye might* believe *him*. But this not being the precise Question, I insist not upon it.

Again, The Question is not, If a Man must have the Knowledge of his Repentance, that it is true and genuine *saving* Repentance, before his Sins are pardoned. For a Man may have true Repentance and Faith also, and consequently may be truly justified before God; who yet walketh in Darkness as to his Knowledge of his having these Evangelical Graces in himself: But the Question is, concerning Repentance itself. And when we affirm it to be requisite, in Order unto the Remission of Sins, we do not mean, that a Sinner spiritually dead can produce it himself, by the natural Powers of his own free Will; or that he must bring it to God as *any* Part of that Righteousness, whereupon he is justified; or that it is any Cause of the Remission of his Sins: But that it is required of God, and must be in the Person whom he will freely Pardon for Christ's Sake.

The truth therefore which I undertake to prove against the *Marrow*, is, That the Evangelical Grace and Duty of Repentance goeth before Pardon of Sin, in God's Method of bestowing them; that Remission of Sin is a Consequent Blessing annexed unto Repentance by Divine Promise; and that therefore Ministers in preaching the Gospel, may, and ought to call Sinners to repent, and forsake their Sins, in Order unto their obtaining the Pardon of them, as well as to believe in Christ for their Justification.

The holy Spirit in the written Word, owned by all true Protestants to be the only infallible Judge of Controversies, hath determined in Favours of the Truth proposed. For,

1. Repentance is placed before Pardon, in the proper Order, wherein Christ bestows his purchased Benefits, Acts v. 31. He

gives Repentance and forgiveness of sins. And that this is understood of true Gospel Repentance, will not, I think, be refused by any who considers, that it is given by the exalted Prince and Saviour, and joined with Forgiveness. And the same Order is to be observed in preaching the Gospel, *Luke xxiv. 47. And that Repentance and Remission of Sins should be preached in his Name*. And so, as that Repentance goes before, and is required unto Forgiveness, which follows thereon. Thus *John* preached *the* Baptism *of* Repentance for, or unto the Remission of Sins, *Mark i. iv. Luke* iii. 3. And our Lord holds forth the same Order in the Parable, *Luke* xviii. *13, 14. Here* Humiliation, Fear, Shame and sorrow for Sin, with a needy Look unto the Mercy of God, are represented in the penitent Publican, as previous unto his going down to his House justified. And when He sends the Apostle *Paul* unto the *Gentiles*, He authorizeth him, in preaching the Gospel, Acts xxvi. *18. To open their eyes, and to turn them from darkness to light, and from the power of Satan unto God, that (saith Christ) they may receive forgiveness of sins, and inheritance among them that are sanctified by faith that is in me*. The Turning here spoken of, is Gospel Repentance, as is evident from the Account the Apostle gives of his obeying this Commission, v. 19, 20. I *was not disobedient unto the heavenly vision; but showed, — that they should repent and turn to God, and do works meet for repentance*. The End and Design of this *Turning or Repenting*, is, That they might receive Forgiveness of Sins by Faith in Christ. And it is also observable, That Faith in Christ doth not exclude Repentance from being likewise requisite unto their receiving the Forgiveness of Sins.

2. Repentance, or Forsaking of Sin, hath the Promise of Pardon annexed unto it, and the Duty is enforced from the encouraging Promise of this gracious Benefit following thereon, Isai. lv. *7. Let the wicked forsake his Way, and the unrighteous man his Thoughts, and let him return unto the Lord, and he will have mercy upon him; and to our God, for he will abundantly pardon*. This Divine Oracle doth look the *Antinomian*

Error out of Countenance; and will stand its Ground against all Opposition. In the beginning of this Chapter, the Market of free Grace is opened, with a Call to every one that thirsteth, to *come without money, and without Price*. And in v. 7. the Offer of Mercy is extended to the Wicked and Unrighteous. But that the Doctrine of Grace might not be reproached, as if it gave any Encouragement to impenitent Sinners to expect Pardon, the Wicked are required to forsake their Way, else they come not within the Compass of this Gospel-Promise of Pardoning Mercy.

And here 'tis evident, (1.) That the wicked Man's forsaking his *Way*, and the unrighteous Man his Thoughts, and his returning unto the Lord, go before his obtaining the Pardon of his Sins. (2.) That this forsaking and returning are not Acts of Man's free Will, produced by his own natural Powers, nor a mere Law-work; but they are Fruits of the renewing Spirit, and Actings of the new Creature, they are even repentance unto Life, seeing they have, by Divine Promise, pardoning Mercy annexed unto them.

The Author *of the Marrow of Modern Divinity*, as above cited, would have us believe, that in the Offer of Mercy, *Isai*. lv. 1, 2, 3. Christ doth call us off from the Ways of Repentance and Humiliation; as if the allowing of Repentance to go before Pardon, were to bring our own Works of Righteousness into the Case of Justification. Yet he gives no Answer to v. 7. which calleth the Wicked to forsake his Way in Order to pardon. But a Reverend Divine, in his printed Sermon preached at Denny, *August* 11, 1718, lends a helping Hand to the *Marrow*, by the Turn he gives unto this Text. 'Tis true, he doth not mention the Marrow, nor is he speaking directly in Defence of it, but of the *Auchterarder* Position condemned by the *General Assembly, viz. That it is not sound to teach, That we must forsake Sin, in Order to our coming to Christ, and instating us in Covenant with God*. But his Gloss on the Text favours the one, as well as the other. In his Sermon, P. 32. he gives the Import of *Isai. lv. 7. Let the wicked man forsake his way, and the unrighteous* man his *thoughts*

(his Ways and Thoughts of Relief) and in returning to *the Lord, he will find Mercy and Pardon*. His plain Meaning then is, That in this Text the wicked and unrighteous Man is not called to forsake his wicked Ways and evil Thoughts, his Hatred and Contempt of God, his Envy and Malice against his Neighbour, his abominable Lusts and Wickedness of Life, in Order to Forgiveness; But only to forsake his own Thoughts and Ways of Relief, such as trusting to his own Righteousness for Justification, and setting about Reformation to bring it as a Price in his Hand to commend him to Christ: And if he forsake these Ways of Relief, he shall obtain Mercy and Pardon, tho' he do not yet forsake his sinful and wicked Ways. We acknowledge the Gospel calleth Men to give up with all Confidence in their own Righteousness, and to come empty handed to Christ for Mercy; and in so far the Promise of Pardon and Covenant of Grace is not absolute, and altogether unconditional unto all the Hearers of the Gospel. But this Gloss is contrived and advanced to exclude the Necessity of the wicked Man's forsaking his Sins, in Order unto his obtaining the Pardon of them. And for vindicating this Text from it, and for confirming the Truth proposed, I offer the following Observations.

(1.) The Author of this Gloss makes an Addition to the Text, without any Ground or Countenance from the Words. The Text speaks of the wicked and unrighteous Man's Ways and Thoughts, and he adds, of *Relief*. And if such like Additions were allowed, the holy Scripture would be turned into a Nose of *Wax*, to be plied to every one's Fancy.

(2.) It is not agreeable to the simple and genuine Meaning of the Words, as used in Scripture. For when Persons are designed by any Epithet or Quality, the Actions ascribed to them as such, are determined by that Epithet or Quality, when they are no otherwise specified. Thus here, the Man spoken to is designed by the Epithet of *wicked* and *unrighteous*; and therefore, the Actions ascribed to him as such, are thereby determined to be of the same Quality: The wicked Man's Ways

must be understood to be *wicked Ways*, and the unrighteous Man's Thoughts, to be *unrighteous Thoughts. So Ezek. xxxiii. 8, 9. — If thou dost not speak, to warn the wicked from his Way*, &c. And, *if thou warn the wicked of his Way to turn from it, if he do not turn from his Way*, &c. Here, *his Way* is his wicked *Way*; the Quality of such a Man's Way is understood from the Epithet of *Wicked*, by which he is designed. And that no Doubt may remain; see the Parallel Passage, *Ezek*. iii. 18, 19. where the Epithet of the Man is expressly added unto his *Way, to warn the wicked from his wicked Way*. Many such Examples might be adduced; see Psal. i. 6. *The Lord knoweth the Way of the Righteous, i. e*. his righteous *Way: But the Way of the Ungodly shall* perish, i. e. his ungodly Way. So here the Ways and Thoughts, which the wicked and unrighteous Man is required to forsake, are wicked and iniquous Ways and Thoughts. If it had been said, Let *the Man that trusteth in* himself as *righteous forsake his Way*, this might be understood of his *Way* of Relief. But the Words as they stand in the Text, do not admit of this Interpretation. (3.) This Gloss is not agreeable to the Scope and Context. For the Invitation, *ver*. 1. *to come without Money and without Price*, doth import that the Man must lay aside all Conceit and Confidence in his own Righteousness. I also grant that the Expostulation, *ver. 2. (Wherefore do ye spend your Money for that which is not Bread*? *and your Labour for that which satisfieth* not?) may comprehend God's rejecting their Thoughts and Ways of Relief. For the Exhortation in the first four Verses is directed to the *Jews*, a People who went about to establish their own Righteousness, *Rom. x. 2*. But in v. 5. there is a Prediction of the bringing in of the *Gentiles, Behold thou shalt call a Nation that thou knowest not, and Nations that knew not thee, shall run* unto thee; and the Call is extended unto them, *vers*. 6, and 7. Wherefore, the wicked and unrighteous are the *Gentiles*, which followed not after Righteousness, *Rom. ix. 30. And so* the Thoughts and Ways they are called to forsake, are not those of Relief, which they sought not after, but their wicked and unrighteous Ways, which they were pursuing, when they

knew not God. Moreover, this Gloss restricts the Call unto those who set up for their own Ways of Relief, to the Exclusion of the *Gentiles*, and those wicked who seek not after Relief. And when such come most properly under the Designation of [*Rashangh*, and *Ishaven*,] wicked and unrighteous, or Men of Iniquity, shall we think that they are not comprehended in this Call so expressly directed unto them?

(4.) By this Gloss, a Sinner may obtain Pardon while he is yet impenitent, and return unto the Lord, without turning from his Sins. For it makes the Term from which he turns to be, not his Sins and gross Abominations, but his Ways and Thoughts of Relief; and if he shall but forsake these, tho' he forsake not his wicked Ways, tho' he repent not of his iniquous Thoughts, tho' he hath no true Sorrow and Grief of Heart for his God-provoking and dishonouring Sins, yet our God will abundantly pardon him: Which is so gross, that I hope its Author will not own it.

(5.) The true Meaning of the Text, which I have given in Opposition to this Gloss, is confirmed from the parallel Passages, where the Pardon of Sin is annexed unto the Duty of Repentance. Acts ii. 38. *Repent and be baptized, — for the Remission of Sins. Acts iii. 19. Repent ye therefore, and be converted, that your Sins may be blotted out*. See also *Isa. i. 16, 18. Prov*. xxviii. 13. Here Sinners are exhorted to repent, that their Sins may be pardoned: Which would be very unaccountable, if Remission of Sins were not a Blessing promised unto, and following upon Repentance.

3. In Scripture, Repentance is not only put before, in the proper Order, and hath Pardon as a consequent Blessing annexed to it by divine Promise; but also it is held forth to be of such Necessity, in Order unto Remission of Sins, that none may expect to obtain this Blessing without it. Ezek. xviii. 30. *Repent, and turn your selves from all your Transgressions; so Iniquity shall not be your Ruin*. Which plainly imports that the Sinner, without Repentance may expect no Pardon, but utter

Ruin. Luke xiii. 3, 5. *Except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish*. And they that perish come short of the Forgiveness of their Sins.

The Truth we have been proving from Scripture, is maintained by our Church, against the opposite *Antinomian* Error; *Confession of Faith, Chap*. xv. §. 1. "Repentance unto Life is an Evangelical Grace, the Doctrine whereof is to be preached by every Minister of the Gospel, as well as that of Faith in Christ. §. 3. It is of such Necessity to all Sinners, that none may expect Pardon without it. §. 6. As every Man is bound to make private Confession of his Sins to God, praying for the Pardon thereof; upon which, and the forsaking of them he shall find Mercy, &c." And Larger Catechism, *Quest*. 153. "That we may escape the Wrath and Curse of God due to us, by Reason of the Transgression of the Law, he requireth of us Repentance toward God, and Faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ."

When Ministers are solemnly engaged to own and teach the approven Doctrine of our *Confession*, they should beware of recommending Errors plainly inconsistent therewith.

Having established the Truth proposed from the sacred Rule of Faith, and evinced it to be the Doctrine of this Church from our *Confession* and *Catechism*; we may with the more Freedom expose the opposite *Antinomian* Error, without being guilty of charging the Doctrine of Grace with *Antinomianism*. For the Gospel of the Grace of God, is a sound, pure, and holy Doctrine, it commands all *Men every where* to *repent, and teacheth them to deny Ungodliness and worldly Lusts, and to live soberly, righteously and godly in this present* World: Which cannot be said of this Doctrine of the *Marrow*. For it is not the Doctrine of Grace, as hath been proved; but is cut out for leading People into dangerous Delusions. And,

1. It may lead People to do an Injury and Dishonour to the Spirit of Grace, and his gracious Operations in the Elect. For it allows no Gospel Repentance to go before Pardon, and a Believer's knowing that his Sins are pardoned. But if there be a

special Work of the Holy Spirit upon the Elect, in Conviction of Sin and Misery, Humiliation, Sorrow, Forsaking of Sin, and other like Actings of the New Creature, to which Remission of Sins is annexed by divine Promise; then there is true Gospel Repentance begun in the Elect before Pardon and Assurance. And to deny and disown these to be the peculiar gracious Operations of the Spirit, to *say* that they are only Actings of, or in Men yet unregenerate, and to call them by the Nickname of Fits of legal Fear and Terror, such as are common to the Reprobate, is a reproaching of these gracious Operations, and a wronging and dishonouring of the Spirit of Grace, the Author of them. Which is an Evil, that I am persuaded the Reverend Recommender will desire to avoid.

2. A Person who thinks these Operations are not Fruits of the renewing Spirit, and Stirrings of the New Creature, but believes with the *Marrow*, that they are only legal Fits of Fear, and Motions arising from a common Work, and natural Powers in the unregenerate; when he finds they have annexed to them the Pardon of Sin by divine Promise, may be apt to conclude, that there is a certain Connection between the Endeavours and Actings in the Unrenewed, and the saving Grace of Justification, and that by God's own Promise. Which I charitably believe the Vindicator of the *Marrow* will account a *Pelagian Gangrene*.

3. This Doctrine, That Men are not to repent and forsake their Sins till they be justified, and know that their Sins are pardoned, where it is embraced, may have very bad Influence upon Peoples Morals, and be of dangerous Consequence to their Souls Salvation. For it teacheth and encourageth them to put *off* and delay the necessary Duty of Repentance: Whereas, our Lord in the Beginning of his public Ministry, called for this Duty in the first Place, *Matth. iv. 17. Mark i. 14. and the* Apostle placeth it the very first of the Principles of the Doctrine of Christ, *Heb. vi. 1. Therefore, leaving the Principles of the Doctrine of Christ, — not laying again the Foundation of Repentance from* dead Works, *and of Faith toward God*.

4. This Doctrine is apt to induce Sinners to make Light of Sin; as if it were no great Evil, nor so dangerous to the Souls of Men, nor displeasing and hateful to God, as some represent it: Seeing according to this Opinion, he justifies the Ungodly without Repentance, and pardons their Sins before they forsake them. Whereas the Scripture holds forth, that their God is *of purer Eyes than to behold Evil, Hab. i. 13. and that Sin is the abominable Thing* that he *hates, Jer. xliv. 4. And that* they are Seducers, *who speak Peace to Impenitent Sinners, and daub with untempered Mortar, and strengthen the Hands of the Wicked, that he should not return from his wicked Way, by promising him Life*, Ezek. xiii. 10, 22.

5. The Author of the *Marrow*, by this Doctrine takes off the Necessity of Repentance in Order to Salvation. For he admits of no Gospel Repentance before Justification and Assurance thereof, and the Repentance which he allows to flow from a Man's knowing the Love of God to him, in pardoning his Sins, is not necessary to Salvation. For suppose a Man is a true Believer and justified, and that he lives some Years trusting in the Lord, yet walking, and afterwards dying in Darkness, as to his Knowledge or Assurance of his justified State; he never arrived at Gospel Repentance, according to the *Marrow*: Yet being justified, he shall not perish, but be eternally saved without it: Whereas, Christ saith expressly, Except ye *repent, ye shall all likewise perish*, Luke xiii. 3.

CHAPTER VII

Containing Reflections on the Vindicator's Defence of the Doctrine of the Marrow concerning the Law of Christ, with XII. Positions concerning the Law.

We proceed to the chief Part of the *Letter* to a *Private Christian*, the main Scope whereof is, to vindicate the Doctrine of the *Marrow* concerning the Law, as *the Law of Christ*. Of this he saith, Letter, *Page 2, 3. It is again, and again asserted and instructed in the Marrow, that the Law is an eternal Rule of Righteousness, and obligeth every one to a perfect Conformity unto the same. I know that some have alleged, that tho' the Obligation of the Law be owned and pressed in the Book, yet it is not done in a Way sufficient to exempt it from the Charge. Because, say they, The Law is therein considered, not as the Law in the more general Sense; but particularly as the Law of Christ: This, I think, is the most engaging Consideration of it, and that instead of impairing, it greatly strengtheneth the Law's indispensable Obligation*. This to me is a very obscure Passage. The Vindicator doth not tell who they are that bring in the Charge against the *Marrow*, or what the Charge is; neither doth he explain what the Law in the more general Sense is, nor what the Law of Christ is, in the Opinion of the *Marrow*. It might have been expected, that he should, in the first Place, have plainly represented the Doctrine of the *Marrow* concerning the Law from the Book itself; and then either have vindicated it, if he thought it sound, or if otherwise, rejected it honestly, and retracted his Recommendation. But what he hath omitted, I shall endeavour to supply afterward. Meanwhile, seeing he pretends to set this Matter in a *just Light*, I shall follow him with some few Reflections.

He represents, *P. 3. That with Respect to the Law, we may be considered, either as in the State of Nature, or as in an Estate of Grace*. If in a *natural and unregenerated Estate, we are under the Law in its full Compass and Extent. It obligeth us no more than ever it did our first Parents, before our Fall. For it binds us as much unto perfect Obedience, as ever it did them, and now that we are fallen, it further obligeth us to suffer the deserved Penalty: Here sure there is* no Antinomianism.

The Law in its full Compass and Extent comprehends all the Obligations of the Covenant of Works; it obliged our first Parents to perfect personal Obedience, as their Righteousness, and the Condition of their obtaining Right unto the promised Eternal and Celestial Life. And if all the Unregenerate be under this Obligation, then are they bound, not only to perfect Obedience, but to obey the Law, that they may be thereby justified; and so to establish their own Righteousness, tho' they live under the Gospel Dispensation. This might have been let pass, as a Mistake dropped inadvertently from the Vindicator's Pen; but that he seems to have embraced it as his fixed Opinion; for he vents the same in his *Vindication of the Doctrine of Grace, from the Charge* of Antinomianism, P. 8. asserting, *That the Law or Covenant of Works is not abrogated, but standeth in full Force*, &c. And in his *Answer to the Snake in the Grass, P. 12*, 13. he says, *That the two Covenants of Works and Grace, were, and are standing at once, is a certain Truth, universally acknowledged by Orthodox Divines. — They who are in Christ, have escaped the Curse, and have really no more to do with the Law as a Covenant of Works. — Yet the Covenant of Works stands in full Force towards all who live and die out of Christ. — And that Covenant, tho' broken, yet stands in Force in Point of* Obligation. The peculiar and formal Obligation in the Covenant of Works as such, was, Do *and live, or do for Life*: And if this Covenant be in no Point abrogated, but stand in full Force, toward them who are out of Christ, then all the Unregenerate are under this formal Obligation. Again, P. 14. 'Tis *true, indeed, these* two Covenants *are not in Force towards the same* Persons, and at the

same Time. The Believer (tho' under the Law, as the sweet and indispensable Rule of Heart and Life) is yet freed from it as a Covenant of Works; as the Marrow teacheth pleasantly, and to great Length, &c. If this be the Privilege of the Believer, then the Unbeliever is still under *the Law* as a Covenant of Works, and so bound by its formal Obligation, to personal Obedience for his Justification. He said above, of this his Doctrine, *Here sure there* is no Antinomianism, but can he vindicate it from gross Legalism?

Incidit in Scyllam cupiens *vitare Charybdim*.

That is legal Doctrine, which teacheth Men to establish their own Righteousness, and to seek to be justified by their good Works done in Obedience to the Law. Now, what can be more so than to tell all in an unregenerated Estate, That they are under a standing un-abrogated Obligation of the Covenant of Works, to seek Justification, and a Right to Eternal Life, by their own perfect and personal Obedience? The Covenant of Works obligeth Men to seek Righteousness in their own personal Obedience; the Gospel obligeth Sinners to renounce their own Righteousness, and to betake themselves unto the Righteousness of the blessed Surety Jesus Christ, for their Justification: These Obligations are opposite and inconsistent: And Men in an unregenerate State, are, by the Command of God in the Gospel, brought under the latter Obligation: And therefore are no more under the former, of the Covenant of Works; which in so far is abrogated or antiquated.

Wherefore the Vindicator will do well to rectify this Notion, and declare plainly, That the Covenant of Works, as to its formal Obligation, Do *and live*, is not still standing in full Force, but abrogated, with Respect to all to whom the Gospel is sent. And that his Meaning is, That the Unregenerate are under the standing Curse, and penal Sanction of this broken Covenant; and that they are not freed from it, till, in Obedience to the Gospel Call, they *fly* to the Mediator's Righteousness for their Relief.

But I proceed with the Reverend Vindicator, who, to *set the Matter in a just Light, goes* on to tell *us, P. 3, 4. That the Believer stands in a quite other Relation to his Lord and Law-giver: That he is under the Law to Christ; who* is our *Judge, Law-giver and King: That by Virtue of his Adoption, he cometh under the pleasant* Obligation *to obey the Law, as his* heavenly Father's sweet Will. All good; but is this the Opinion of the *Marrow*, and all that the Author means by the Law of Christ? If not, then, tho' all this be most true, it makes nothing for the Vindication of the Marrow.

But he says more, P. 4, 5. That it is a *Prejudice to the Law's indispensable Obligation*, That as to *the Believer, it is considered in the* Hand of Christ, *who* is our Sovereign *Lord. This* detracteth not in *the least from the Obligation, which* it hath upon us *from the Authority of God, and by Virtue of the Precepts in their own Nature*.

But pray Sir, where doth the *Marrow* own this prior and indispensable Obligation of the Law to be still standing in Force upon the Believer, and that from the Authority of God, and by Virtue of the Precepts in their own Nature? If you had evinced this one Point from any plain Passages of the *Marrow*, I frankly acknowledge, it would have made more for its Vindication with me, than all you have said besides.

I find nothing adduced that hath any Show of Proof, except what he said, P. 3. *That* it is *again and again asserted and instructed in the* Marrow, *That the Law is an Eternal Rule of Righteousness*. This Epithet, I own, is given to the Law, *Marrow*, P. 156. But it will not hence follow, That the *Marrow* asserteth the Law's commanding Power, and indispensable binding Force upon the Believer, from the Authority of God. For *Antinomians* distinguish betwixt a Simple Passive Rule, and an authoritatively commanding and Binding Rule. An Artificer or Workman's Rule, is an Instrument for directing him in his Work; but it hath no Authority over him to command, and bind him to observe and follow its Direction. Even so, the Law, in the Opinion of the *Antinomians*, tho' it be to the Believer a passive Rule, whereby he may direct his Actions;

yet hath it no commanding Power over him, nor is it of a binding Force, to oblige him to obey, and follow its Direction. Thus the Author of the *Marrow*, tho' he gives the Title of an Eternal Rule of Righteousness unto the Moral Law, yet he will have the Believer to yield Obedience, or Work freely, and of his own Accord, without the Coaction or Compulsion of the Law, vid. P. 180. All the Coaction or Compulsion of the Law is moral, it consists in its commanding and binding Power, which it derives from the Authority and Power of God, the Sovereign Lord and Law-giver: And therefore, if the Believer be not under the Coaction or Compulsion of the Law, neither is he under its indispensable Obligation from the Authority of God the Creator and Law-giver. Hence P. 193. he says of the good Works of Believers, that they are *materially the Works of the Law, tho' produced by the Spirit of Christ in the Gospel. So* the Works of Believers are *materially* the Works of the Law, that is, they are agreeable to the passive Rule of the Law; but they are not *formally* the Works of the Law; that is, They are not done in Obedience to the compulsive Authority of the Law-giver, and commanding Power of the Law.

That this is no strained Interpretation, but the true Meaning of the Author of the *Marrow*, will appear from his *Evangelical Man Robert Town*; whom he quotes with Approbation in the Passages above-cited. *Town's Assertion of Grace, P. 137, 138. You are ever imperiously, by the Commandment of the Law, exacting and requiring this and that with* a mulct sub poena, it *must be done*, or smart *for Neglect*, &c. *little considering that Believers are of an ingenuous and free Disposition. It cannot be said that my Spirit doth that voluntarily, which the Command of the Law bindeth and forceth unto*; *'tis one thing for a Man, at his own free Liberty, to keep the King's high Way of the Law, and another to be kept in by Pales and Ditches, that* he cannot, *without some Danger, go out of it. Whilst the Child is under the Awe and Rule of his Tutor or Master, you cannot know his Disposition, altho' he live soberly and orderly: But free him from that Government, and leave him to himself, and you may soon know what to judge of him. — The Law doth not lose its*

Dominion, till Grace doth challenge us to itself. — If the Spirit be free, why will you control and rule it by the Law? *whereas the Nature of the Spirit is freely to conform the Heart and Life to the outward Rule of the Law, without the Help of the Law. As a crooked Thing is made straight, according to the Line and Square, and not by them. And thus, whilst a Believer serveth in* Newness *of Spirit, the Spirit freely and cheerfully moving and inclining him to keep the Law, which is merely passive herein. And P. 140. What Christ performed for us, we are freed from*, — that is, *Christ hath freed us from Subjection to the Moral Law. P. 141. The Allegory, (Rom. 7. 4.) runneth most aptly thus, The Law is dead to us, and* so it's *like Paul would have said, To show how we are by Faith freed from the Authority of it, but that he was loath to offend the weak Jews, who were* too *zealous of the Law. And P. 141, 142. The Law and Christ are set in Opposition, as two Husbands to one Wife successively, whilst the Law was alive in the Conscience, all the Fruits were deadly and accursed; but Christ taking the same Spouse to himself (the Term of the Law being expired) by his quickening Spirit, doth make her fruitful unto God, and so raiseth up seed to the former Husband: for materially these are the Works of the Law, tho' produced by the Spirit of Christ in the Gospel*. Here Town, quoted by the *Marrow*, plainly unfolds this *Antinomian* Mystery; he owns the Law to be a passive Rule of Righteousness, but disowns its indispensable Obligation from the Authority of God upon the Believer. Hence we may see, that the Vindicator has run into a Mistake, and Misrepresentation, when he represents to the Private Christian, that the Believer's receiving the Law as the Law of Christ, is, in the Opinion of the Marrow, no Prejudice to the Law's indispensable Obligation.

We go on to the grand Position, which the Vindicator, P. 6. undertakes to demonstrate, Namely, *that the Believer's looking upon himself as under the Law of Christ, and by Faith improving this Consideration, is the only Method towards effectual* Obedience to *the Law*.

What means he by *the Believer's looking upon himself as under the Law of Christ*? *It is* evident from what he said P. 4. That the

Believer cannot look upon himself as such, unless he know himself to be justified, adopted, and standing in Relation to God in Christ, as his reconciled heavenly Father; but this is true Assurance. And so he makes Assurance to be *the only Method*, and (as he says afterward) the *only adequate* and *proper Mean toward effectual Obedience to the Law*. Hence it will follow, that either there is no true Believer, who doth not know himself to be Justified, adopted, and in Favour with God through Christ: Or if he may be a true Believer without this Knowledge of himself; yet, until he hath attained unto it, and can look upon himself as such, he can perform no Right and acceptable Obedience unto the Law of God, being hitherto destitute of the only effectual Method, and the only adequate and proper Mean thereunto. This indeed is the Opinion of the *Marrow* held forth at large, P. 176. to P. 179. but its Vindicator will never be able to demonstrate, That the Opinion he hath here adopted, is agreeable to the Word of God, our Confession, or the harmonious Judgment of sound Divines. But I shall not divert into this Question.

What I again observe, is, That the Vindicator hath not yet showed unto the Private Christian the true Sense and Meaning of the *Marrow*, concerning the Law as it is the Law of Christ, nor hath he adduced one Passage from it to that Purpose. And therefore, all the Arguments he brings for the Believer's receiving the Law of Christ, come short of his main Scope; which is to vindicate the *Marrow*, and show its Orthodoxy in this Point.

To set this Matter in a further Light, for the Sake of Truth, and Benefit of the Private Christian, I shall give some Account of the Laws of Christ, before I exhibit the Doctrine of the *Marrow*. This I shall do in some brief Positions. And,

1. The Lord Jesus Christ the Mediator is Judge, Law-giver and King; and therefore, there are Laws prescribed by him unto Men, according to which they ought to serve him.

2. The Institutions of Worship in the Gospel, and all the Ordinances thereof, are a Part of the Law of Christ; and are to be observed in Obedience to his Authority. Also the Commands to Repent and Believe belong to the Law of Christ, being delivered by God in Christ unto Sinners. For if God had not purposed to reconcile an Elect World to himself in Christ, such Commands had never been given to fallen Mankind.

These are Christ's positive Laws, given by Revelation, and not deducible from the Law of Nature in its Primitive Constitution; tho', when revealed, the Law of Nature doth bind to the Observation of them, Seeing it obligeth to believe and obey God in whatsoever he shall reveal and command.

3. The Moral Law, or Law of Nature, which was imprinted in the Heart of Man in his first Creation, being of perpetual Obligation upon all Men, at all Times, and in every State, is necessarily taken into the Dispensation of Grace; and so it becomes also the Law of Christ. The Lord Redeemer enjoins Obedience to it by his Authority, without derogating from its Original commanding and binding Power, which it had from the Sovereign Lord Creator.

4. The Moral Law, by becoming the Law of Christ, and its being taken into the Dispensation of Grace, is so far from losing of its former Authority, that it receives the Addition of many Motives and Encouragements, which it had not in its original Constitution, whereby Obedience to its Commandments is powerfully enforced. Such are, the Manifestations of the Love, Mercy and Grace of God, in sending his own Son to be the Redeemer and Saviour of lost Sinners; the redeeming Love, and condescending Grace of the blessed Mediator, in his taking upon him Man's Nature, becoming a Surety for Sinners, humbling himself, and giving Obedience to the Law, even unto the cursed Death; His purchasing all Spiritual and Eternal Benefits of Grace and Glory: And his giving a perfect Pattern and Ensample of Obedience to this Law, in his own Life in the Flesh, for our Imitation: And the like. And by Reason of this Enforcement,

the Law of mutual Love is called peculiarly, the Law of Christ, *Gal*. vi. 2. and his new Commandment, Joh. xiii. 34.

5. Moreover, there is, in the Dispensation of Grace, whereinto this Law is incorporated, an Ability and Power conveyed, whereby Sinners, in themselves impotent and averse, by Reason of inherent Corruption, are enabled and inclined to give Obedience unto it. There is a Promise made, unto the Elect, of the Spirit, to subdue the Dominion of Sin, to implant in them a Principle of Spiritual Life, and Habits of Grace, and to excite these in them, unto the Exercise of holy and new Obedience.

6. The Laws of Christ, both Moral and Positive, bring an Obligation upon all to whom the Gospel is sent. They call the Wicked and Unconverted to Repent and Believe, and Believers unto all the Duties of Holiness in Heart and Life, in Obedience to the Moral Law, and Gospel Institutions.

7. All who are under the Laws of Christ, are freed from the Covenant of Works, as to its formal Obligation, do *and* live, or to perform perfect, personal Obedience for their obtaining Right to Eternal Life. Believers are also freed from its Curse, that it shall not be inflicted on them, who have fled to Christ for their Refuge: But all Unbelievers remain under the Curse of the broken Covenant of Works; and Wrath of God, for all their actual Transgressions; and these are under Gospel-Vengeance, who neglect *the* great Salvation. 8. Tho' by the Law of Christ, Men are not to seek Justification on Account of their own Righteousness; yet they are not loosed from the Law's Obligation unto Obedience for other Ends.

9. The Laws of Christ have annexed unto them Promises, both of this Life and that which is to come, which are Encouragements unto Obedience. For Godliness is great Gain.

10. That Jesus Christ the Lord Redeemer, his Offers of Grace, and his holy and righteous Laws may not be securely neglected and despised, by careless and profane Sinners; they

are armed with most terrible Threatenings of Wrath and Vengeance to be inflicted in Time, and through Eternity.

11. Tho' the Threatenings of Eternal Death shall be actually executed upon Unbelievers only, yet the Law is not stripped and deprived of its Penal Sanction, even with Respect to Believers. The Threatenings are also directed unto them, and are of Use to excite in them an holy Reverence unto God, the Sovereign Law-giver, who is a consuming Fire, and a solicitous Fear of the Evils threatened, which makes them watchful against Sin. And the Transgressions of Believers (tho' in a justified State) are truly Sins, and bring on them a Liableness unto the deserved and threatened Punishment from the Penal Sanction of the Law; but they have a Relief provided against the actual inflicting of this Punishment, in the Satisfaction of Christ their Surety, and Means appointed, which they are called unto, *viz*. Repentance toward God and Faith in the Lord Jesus Christ, that they may escape the Wrath and Curse of God due to them, by Reason of their Transgressions of the Law: And they are brought thereunto by the watchful Care of their Prince and Saviour, who is exalted to give Repentance and Remission of Sins. Otherwise it is true of sinning Believers, as well as others, that *except they repent, they shall all likewise perish, and without Faith it* is *impossible to please God*.

12. Believers ought to be influenced in their Obedience, not from the alone Motive of the felt Love of God, to them in particular, but also from the Love of God in Christ unto Sinners of Mankind, and the Authority of the Law-giver, and ought also to have a Regard unto the Promises and Threatenings annexed to the Laws.

CHAPTER VIII

Of the Doctrine of the Marrow concerning the Law of Works, and the Law of Christ.

A Charge brought against *The Marrow* of *Modern Divinity*, may afford some People a Handle, to expose the Charger as an Enemy to free Grace, and to arraign him as guilty of charging the Doctrine of Grace with the odious Name of *Antinomianism*. But while I account not the Marrow to be the just Standard of the Doctrine of Grace, the Apprehensions of such Treatment shall not deter me from exhibiting what after diligent Search, I conceive to be the true Opinion of the Author of the *Marrow* concerning the Law of God.

I do not blame him for every Thing that he delivers about the Law; for he hath advanced some Truths, and Things allowable. As,

1. Concerning the Moral Law, he owns a Law of Nature given to Man in his Creation, and that thereby Man was obliged to yield perfect and perpetual Obedience to God, tho' a Covenant of Works had not been made between them. *Marrow, Page 10. Though the Ten Commandments were not written in Tables of Stone, until the Time of Moses; yet were they written in the Tables of Man's Heart, in the Time of* Adam: *For we read that Man was created in the* Image and *Likeness of God. And the Ten Commandments* were nothing else but the *eternal Wisdom and Justice that is in* God. And Page 11, 12. Yea *indeed, perfect and perpetual Obedience* was required *from Man unto God, tho' God had made no Promise unto Man. — So that Man being God's Creature, by the Law of Creation he owed all* Obedience *and Subjection to God his Creator*. And Pag. 14. The Ten *Commandments being the Substance of the Law of Nature, engraven in the Heart of* Man in Innocency, *and the express Idea, or Representation* of *God's own Image; even a Beam of his own*

Holiness: They were to have been a Rule of Life both to Adam *and his Posterity, though they had never been the Covenant* of Works.

2. He distinguisheth betwixt the Matter and Form of the Covenant of Works. The Moral Law of Creation was the Matter of it. And the Form of it was God's requiring, and Man's undertaking perfect, personal Obedience to the Law, as the Condition of eternal Life promised, with a Threatening of Death upon his Failure. And herein *Adam* was the Head Representative of all Mankind. *Marrow, Page* 7, 8. "The Reason why I rather choose to call the Law of the *Ten Commandments*, the Matter of the Covenant of Works, than the Covenant itself, is because I conceive that the Matter of it cannot properly be called the Covenant of Works, except the Form be put upon it; that is to say, Except the Lord require, and Man undertake to yield perfect Obedience thereunto, upon Condition of eternal Life and Death; and therefore, till then it was not a Covenant of Works betwixt God and all Mankind *in Adam*." *And Page 15, 16*. "*Adam*, by his Fall, threw down our whole Nature Headlong into the same Destruction, and drowned his whole Off-spring in the same Gulf of Misery. And the Reason is, because by God's Appointment he was to stand or fall not as a single Person only, but as a common public Person, representing all Mankind to come of him, &c.

3. Concerning the Law of Christ, he saith, *Page 156. That the Moral Law was given of God to be a true and eternal Rule of Righteousness*, for all *Men of all Nations, and at all Times*. And Pag. *5. That the Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is the Matter of the Law of Christ, ought to be a Rule of Life to a Believer*. And he says further, *Pag. 171. If you have no Regard* to make the *Law of Christ your Rule, by endeavouring to do what is required in the Ten Commandments*, and *to avoid what is there forbidden, it is* a very Evil *Sign*.

I shall next represent what I conceive blameable in the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, about the Law of Creation, and the

Law of Christ; and his general Division of the Law; wherewith I shall begin.

First, Concerning the Division of the Law in General, he asserts, Marrow, Pag. 4. that In *the Scriptures there is mention made of divers Laws, but they may all be comprised under these Three, to wit, The Law of Works, the Law of Faith, and the Law of Christ*, Rom. iii. 27. Gal. vi. 2.

Will the Reverend Vindicator subscribe to this Doctrine of the *Marrow*? If he do, I pose him, and demand his Answer.

(1.) Under which of these three Laws, are the Commands to Repent and Believe the Gospel comprised? Not under the Law of Works, *for this, Marrow, P. 6. holds forth as much as the Covenant of Works*; which did not enjoin Faith and Repentance: For in the Covenant of Works, perfect Obedience was required unto Justification, and Death threatened upon every Disobedience, without Hope of Relief from that Covenant: Nor under the Law of Faith; for this hath neither Precepts nor Threatenings, according to the Account the *Marrow* gives of it, when he is expressly describing it, *Pag. 24. The Law of Faith is as much to say as the Covenant of Grace, or the Gospel, which signifies Good, Merry, glad, and joyful Tidings; that is to say, That God — before all Time purposed, and in Time promised, and in the Fulness of Time performed, the sending of his Son Jesus Christ into the World, to help and deliver fallen Mankind*. Nor are the Commands to Repent and Believe comprised under the Third, or Law of Christ; For, according to the *Marrow, Pag*. 157. The Law of Christ is to be *delivered by God, as he is a Redeemer in Christ, only to such as are in Christ*. Whereas, the Commands to Repent and Believe, are delivered also to the Unregenerate, that are out of Christ. Wherefore, he must either own, That these three Laws do not comprise all the Laws mentioned in Scripture, or that unregenerate and unbelieving Persons, are, by no Law of God, commanded to Repent and Believe.

(2.) In this Division, doth not the *Marrow* understand the Term *Law* in an Univocal Sense, as it denotes the Will of the

Sovereign Lord containing Precepts given out by his Authority, and enjoining Obedience under a Penal Sanction? Seeing in the Context, *Pag*. 3, 4, 5. the Question is about the Law, that ought to be a Rule of Life unto a Believer? How then brings he in the Law of Faith into this Division, when by the Description he gives of it, in the Passage above-cited, it contains neither Precept nor Threatening?

Secondly, Concerning the Moral Law, or Law of Creation, I conceive the Doctrine of the Marrow to be justly blameable in several Points. As,

1. He seems to deprive the Law of Creation of all Penal Sanction, and to derive the Penalty in Case of Transgression from the Form of the Covenant of Works, which was but *accessory* unto this Law. For in giving his Reasons why it was needful, that God should make a Covenant with Man, by promising him Life, and threatening him with Death; his 2d Reason, *Pag*. 12. is in these Words, *It was meet there should be such a Covenant made with him, to show that he was* not such *a Prince on Earth, but that he had a Sovereign Lord; therefore God set a Punishment upon the Breach of his Commandment, that Man might know his Inferiority. It is* then his Opinion, that before the making of this Covenant, there *was* no Punishment set to the Breach of any Commandment of the Law of Creation. But a Penal Sanction is inseparable from this Royal Law of Nature, tho' no Covenant of Works had been made; and that from the Perfections of God, the Dependency of the reasonable Creature upon his Sovereign Lord Creator, and the Nature of Sin in itself. This Law is a Beam and Expression of the Holiness and Purity of the Law-giver: And every Transgression of it must be hateful and detestable unto him, who is of purer Eyes than to behold Evil, and cannot look upon Iniquity. And therefore the reasonable Creature, if he transgress this Law of his Creation, must necessarily incur the Wrath and Displeasure of his Holy Lord Creator; Again, Man by transgressing the Law of Nature, shakes *off* his Subjection unto the Command of his Creator; and if he were under no Penal Sanction, then by Sinning he

would make himself independent upon his Sovereign Lord. But this cannot be; and therefore the Wise and Sovereign Law-giver, must certainly have provided for the maintaining of the Authority of his Infinite Majesty, and for the vindicating of the Honour of his Law, by arming it with a Penal Sanction, and setting a Punishment upon the Breach of it. Lastly, Sin does Dishonour unto the Wisdom, Holiness and Majesty of the Supreme Law-giver; and therefore deserves Punishment; and vindicative Justice will render to it what it deserves: And therefore, the Justice of God, which is an Essential Attribute, doth necessarily set a Punishment upon the Breach of his Law. And this was known by the Light of Nature unto the *Gentiles*, who, as the Apostle testifies, *Rom*. i. *32. knew the Judgment of God*, (τὸ δικαίωμα τοῦ Θεοῦ the Right of God, and what in Justice he was to judge and inflict) *that they which commit such Things are worthy of Death*.

2. I cannot approve his Saying, that this Law of Nature was *razed* out of the Heart of Man by the Fall. He says of the Moral Law, *Pag. 156. That it was given of God to be a true and Eternal Rule of Righteousness, for all Men of all Nations, and at all Times*. This, one would think, speaks fair for the Perpetuity and Extent of it: But it seems it is to be understood only of what God had ordered it to be, in Case Man had continued in his Original Integrity. For *Pag*. 158. he tells us of the Commandments of the Law of Nature, *That they were to have been a Rule of Life, both to Adam and his Posterity, though they had never been the Covenant of Works; but being become the Covenant of Works, they were to have been a Rule of Life to them, as a Covenant of Works; and then being, as it were, razed out of Man's Heart by his Fall, they were made known* to Adam, *and the rest of the believing Fathers, by Visions and Revelations*. Here we have his Account of what this Law was to have been in its Original Intent and Constitution; but being *razed* out of Man's Heart by the Fall, it was lost, till made known again by Visions and Revelations. Hence it will follow, (1.) That *Adam* by his Fall, lost not only his Original Integrity and Spiritual Wisdom, but also the very

Knowledge of the Law of Nature, to himself and his Posterity. And, (2.) That these who had no Visions and Revelations, and were not Believers, had no Knowledge of this Law. And a Law unknown to a Man cannot be a Rule of Life unto him. But this Doctrine is inconsistent with the remaining Light of Nature, and common Notions of Good and Evil: And contrary unto the Judgment of the Apostle concerning the *Gentiles*, who had not the Benefit of Revelation; For he testifies that *the Things which may be known of God were manifest to them, Rom. i. 19, 20. That these not having the Law by Revelation, are a Law unto themselves*; and show *the Work of the Law written in their Hearts*. Rom. ii. 14, 15. and that as to its Penal Sanction, they *know the Judgment of God, that they which commit such Things, are worthy of Death, Rom. i. 32. And* contrary to the *Marrow* itself. *Pag*. 264. where he says, *The Law is partly known by Nature*.

3. This Law of Nature, which was at first given to be a Rule of Righteousness unto all Men, being *razed* out of Man's Heart by the Fall, can no more, in this its Original Constitution, be a Rule of Life to any Man, and so not to the Believer. He allows indeed that the Believer recovers the Knowledge of it by Revelation, and that in Respect of this new Edition of it, it ought to be a Rule of Life to him: But in Respect of its Primitive and Original Edition, as it was the Law of Nature and Creation, engraven in the Heart of Man in Innocency, he denies it to be a Rule of Life to the Believer. *Marrow, P. 5. The Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is the Matter of the Law of Works, ought not to be a Rule of Life to a Believer*. We showed before, that he distinguisheth betwixt the Matter and Form of the Covenant of Works; The Law then as Matter of the Covenant of Works, distinct and severed from its Form, is what he calls the Moral Law, and Law of Creation, and the Ten Commandments, being the Substance of the Law of Nature engraven in the Heart of Man in Innocency, before it received the Form of the Covenant of Works. And of this Law he says, That *it ought not to be a Rule of Life* to a *Believer*. This Doctrine, I think, cannot be justified, seeing it looseth the

Believer from the Original Obligation of the Law of Nature and Creation, given forth by the standing Authority of the Sovereign Creator. It is true, he says, in the same *Pag*. 5. That *the Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is the Matter of the Law of Christ, ought to be a Rule of Life* to a *Believer*. But this respects only the new Edition of it, without owning its Primitive Obligation to be binding upon the Believer. And what his Opinion is of the Law of Christ, we shall afterward enquire.

This I take to be the Meaning of the *Marrow*; if the Vindicator be not satisfied with it, let him give a more consistent Explication, and reconcile the following Passages, P. 5. The Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is the Matter of the Law of Christ, ought to be a Rule of Life to a Believer. But the Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is the Matter of the Covenant of Works, is the same with the Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is the Matter of the Law of Christ: See P. 155, 156. Therefore the Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is the Matter of the Covenant of Works, ought to be a Rule of Life to a Believer. Whereas, P. 5. he says, It *ought not* to be so.

4. The Opinion of the *Marrow* appears further, from his maintaining, That a Believer ought not to receive the Law of the Ten Commandments from God, as he is Creator. In showing the Difference betwixt the Law of Works, and the Law of Christ, he saith, P. 157. "The one is to be delivered by God, as he is Creator, out of Christ, only to such as are out of Christ; the other is to be delivered by God, as he is a Redeemer in Christ, only to such as are in Christ. Wherefore, Neighbour *Neophytus*, sith that you are now in Christ, beware that you receive not the *Ten Commandments* at the Hands of God out of Christ; nor yet at the Hands of *Moses*, but only at the Hands of Christ, and so shall you be sure to receive them as the Law of Christ."

Here I observe, (1.) he says, The one is to be delivered by God as Creator. Was not the Law delivered when engraven in Man's Heart in his Creation, and is it yet to be delivered?

Again, When, as he says, it was *razed* out of Man's Heart by the Fall, how and when is it to be of new delivered by God as Creator out of Christ, to such as are out of Christ, and to such only?

(2.) What he says of the Law of Works, *That it was delivered by God, as he is Creator out of Christ*, is true of the Moral Law of Nature or Creation, which he calls, *The Matter of the Covenant of Works*: For it was given to be a Law to Man, before the erecting of the Covenant of Works, and before God manifested himself to fallen Man as a Redeemer in Christ; and therefore it was delivered by God, as he is Creator out of Christ. But now, doth the *Marrow* own that the Moral Law of the ten Commandments is still standing in Force upon a Believer, by the Authority of God as Creator? No. For he plainly teacheth the Believer to neglect the Authority of the Creator, and to regard this Law only as it is given out, and repeated by the Redeemer. *Beware (saith he) that you receive not the ten Commandments at the Hands of God out of Christ, but only at the Hands of Christ. If a* Believer ought not to receive the Law of the Ten Commandments at the Hand of God, as he is Creator out of Christ, then he is not under its Obligation, as it was delivered by God the Creator; but is loosed from all Obedience to it, as it was enacted by the Authority of the Lord Creator. And therefore as such (in his Opinion) it ought not to be a Rule of Life to a Believer.

(3.) I should have made no Quarrel with the *Marrow*, had he said, That a Believer is not under the Obligation of the Law, as it had the Form of the Covenant of Works put upon it, requiring perfect Obedience as the Condition of Eternal Life: And owned, That he is still under the standing Obligation of the Moral Law, which was the Matter of the Covenant of Works: And that he ought to receive and subject himself unto it, both as it stands enacted by the Authority of the Lord Creator, and as it is taken into the Dispensation of Grace, and established to be a perpetual Rule of Life by the Lord Redeemer. But I cannot approve his setting the Authority of

the Creator and Redeemer, in Opposition the one to the other, his exempting the Believer from the Law of his Creator, and his restricting him to receive the Ten Commandments only at the Hands of Christ. This Doctrine, I think, is injurious unto the Infinite Majesty of the Sovereign Lord Creator, and to the Honour of His holy Law. Doth God, as he is a Redeemer in Christ, divest himself of his Right, Power and Authority as Creator? Doth the Assumption of the Moral Law into the Gospel Dispensation, deprive it of its Original Binding Power on the Believer, as he is a Man, a reasonable Creature? Or doth the Grace of Christ exempt a Believer from Subjection to the perpetual Law of Nature? I cannot persuade myself, that the *Vindicator* will approve this Doctrine of the *Marrow*, seeing he has said, *Letter to a private Christian*, P. 4, 5. "It is no Prejudice to the Law's indispensable Obligation, that as to the Believer, it is considered in the Hand of Christ, who is our Sovereign Lord. This detracteth not in the least from the Obligations which lie upon us all from the Authority of God." He'll rather choose to shift off by alleging, That it is not the Doctrine of the *Marrow*. But besides what hath been said already, for clearing the genuine Opinion of the *Marrow*, it will be further confirmed from what follows.

5. He looseth the Believer from the Obligation of the Law, from its binding Power, and consequently exempts him from the Authority of the Law-giver, *Marrow*, P. 189. "The Spirit, according to the Measure of Faith, writes the lively Law of Love in his Heart, whereby he is enabled to work freely, and of his own Accord, without the *Coaction or Compulsion* of the Law. For that Love wherewith Christ, or God in Christ hath loved him, and which by Faith is apprehended of him, will constrain him to do so, according to that of the Apostle, *2 Cor. v. 14. The love of Christ constraineth* us."

Here a Coaction or Compulsion is allowed unto the Law, but the Believer is to work without it. The Compulsion of the Law is its binding Power and Moral Force, which it derives from the awful Authority of the Sovereign Law-giver,

commanding Obedience to his Law, and threatening Disobedience with Wrath: And if a Believer ought not to be influenced unto Obedience by the Compulsion of the Law, then is he set free from its binding Power, and commanding Authority. That this is the Mind of the *Marrow*, we have showed at large in the preceding Chapter, from several Passages of Mr. *Town*, whom he here quotes with Approbation. What we further take notice of here is, that in the Believer's working, he sets the Motive of God's Love in Christ to him, in Opposition unto the Compulsion of the Law; so as to exclude and discard the latter, as being inconsistent with the former. But why may not these Motives be conjoined in the Believer's Obedience? It is true, the Apostle saith, *2 Cor. v. 14. The Love of Christ constraineth* us: But this was not inconsistent with his Regard unto the awful Appearance before the Judgment Seat of Christ, and his knowing the Terror of the Lord, v. 10, 11. His Opinion then is, That a Believer is not under that Law, which hath in it any moral Coaction or Compulsion, any binding Force, or obliging Power, from the Authority of the Law-giver. But the Moral Law of Creation, as it stands enacted by the Authority of God as he is Creator, without the Form of the Covenant of Works put upon it, hath this Compulsion, this obliging binding Force inseparably attending it: Therefore, in his Opinion, a Believer is not under the Moral Law of Creation *as* such. He would have a Believer to act freely, and of his own Accord, from the alone Motive of the Love of God in Christ to him; and he thinks he doth not act freely, if he be not freed from the binding Force of the Law of Creation, and the commanding Authority of the Lord Creator. And so he would have the Law which a Believer is under, to be merely passive; a Rule that is a dead Instrument, without an obliging Power to move and influence him by its commanding Authority: as is more fully expressed in the above-mentioned Passages of *Robert* Town his *Evangelical Man*.

6. This his Opinion is further evident, in his Teaching, That a Believer in doing good, or eschewing Evil, ought not to be influenced by the Promise of Life, or threatening of Death, *Marrow, P. 175. And therefore I have no need either to eschew Evil, or do Good, for fear of Punishment, or Hope of Reward. P. 180. According to the saying of an Evangelical Man*, [Town's Assertion of Grace] *The Will and Affections of a Believer, according to the Measure of Faith and the Spirit received, sweetly quickens and bends to choose, affect, and delight in whatever is good* and *acceptable to God, or a Good Man; the Spirit cheerfully and freely moving and inclining him to keep the Law, without fear of Hell, or Hope of Heaven. P. 181. Would you not have Believers to* eschew *Evil, and do Good, for fear of Hell, or for Hope of Heaven*? *No indeed, I would not have any Believer to do either the one or the other; for so far forth as they do so, their Obedience is but slavish*.

If a Believer, in his eschewing Evil, and doing Good, ought to have no Regard to these Threatenings and Promises; then he is not under the Obligation of that Law to which they are annexed. But the Moral Law (even considered as distinct, and severed from the Form of the Covenant of Works) hath Threatenings annexed; for we proved before, that a Penal Sanction was inseparable from it: And now, that it is taken into the Dispensation of the Gospel, there are Promises annexed by free Grace unto the Duties of the Moral Law performed by Believers: Wherefore, in the Opinion of the *Marrow*, a Believer is not under the Obligation of the Moral Law, as it is distinct from the Form of the Covenant of Works. And if a Believer be not under the Moral Law, to which such Threatenings and Promises are annexed; then they do not belong to him: And tho' such Threatenings and Promises do abound in the Word of God, yet a Believer ought not to look upon them as spoken unto him. However absurd this Inference may be, it is plainly owned by the Author of the *Marrow*, which gives a further Evidence of his Genuine Meaning in this Matter, as follows.

7. *Marrow, Appendix*, P. 267. "If we would know when the Law speaketh, and when the Gospel speaketh; let us consider and take this for a Note: That when in Scripture there is any Moral Work commanded to be done, either for the eschewing of Punishment, or upon Promise of any Reward, Temporal or Eternal, or else, when any Promise is made, with the Condition of *any* Work to be done, which is commanded in the Law, there is to be understood the Voice of the Law. *And* p. 271, 272. Wherefore, when any Person or Persons do feel themselves oppressed and terrified with the Burden of their Sins, as happeneth sometimes to God's own dear Servants, who have soft and timorous Consciences: When such Souls, I say, do hear or read any such Places of Scripture, which appertaineth to the Law, let them then think and assure themselves that such Places do not appertain or belong to them. Nay, let not only such who are thus deeply humbled and terrified do this, but also let every one that doth but make any Doubt or Question of their own Salvation, through the Sight and Sense of Sin, do the like. — Let every true convicted Person then, who fears the Wrath of God, Death and Hell, when they hear or read any such Places of Scripture, which do appertain to the Law, not think the same to belong to them."

Here we have a pretty plain Account of what he means by that Law, from the Obligation and Authority of which he will have a Believer to be exempted. Whatever Law or Commandment of God enjoining any Moral Duty, hath annexed unto it a Threatening of Punishment, or a Promise of Reward, either Temporal or Eternal, it doth not appertain to a Believer, (in the Opinion of the *Marrow*) it is not spoken to him; nay, nor even to any true convicted Person, who fears the Wrath of God, Death and Hell: They are not to think that any such Law or Commandment doth belong to them. And if such Law be not spoken, nor belong to a Believer, then it ought not to be a Rule of Life unto him, nor is he under its commanding Authority, nor is he to be moved by its Compulsion or binding Force, neither is he to regard the Promises and Threatenings

annexed to it. But such is the Moral Law, without the Form of the Covenant of Works, which was accessory to it: And therefore, by the Doctrine of the Marrow, a Believer is not under the Obligation of the Moral Law, even when the Form of the Covenant of Works is removed from it.

I again pose the Reverend Vindicator, whether he goes in to this Doctrine of the *Marrow*, or not? If he does, he shall be heard in what he shall advance in Defence of it; if not, he might have spared his ample Recommendation, which hath done no Honour to the Truth of God in this Church. It will be in vain for him to pretend, that, by the Law from which a Believer is exempted, the Author of the *Marrow* understands only the Covenant of Works, as to the Form thereof; or the Personal Obligation to perfect Obedience, as the Condition and Ground of his Justification: For, whatever he pretend, we have demonstrated all along, That the Law, from which he frees the Believer, is the Moral Law, which he owns was the Matter of the Covenant of Works without the Form of it.

Before I go on to another Head, I shall make some Reflections upon this Doctrine of the *Marrow*.

1. If it were embraced, a very small Part of the Holy Scriptures would remain as a standing Rule of Life to a Believer. For hereby are cut off all Precepts and Exhortations unto Moral Duties, all Prohibitions, Dehortations and Admonitions against Sins, which have annexed to them any Promises or Threatenings; and all Promises of Reward, Temporal or Eternal, made unto the performing of any Duty of the Moral Law, or any other Duty whatsoever, except that of Believing: And this is the only Exception he admits, P. 268, where he says, *That all these* Promises *in the New Testament, which offer Christ upon Condition of our believing on his Name, are properly called the Voice of the Gospel. And therefore are spoken unto Believers*. And he gives several Instances of what belongs to the Law, and not to the Gospel, by which we are to judge of others of the like Nature, P. 267. Blessed *are the pure in Heart, for they*

shall see God, Mat. 5. 8. (and the like may be said of all our Saviour's Sermon on the Mount). Again, *Except ye be converted, and become as little Children, ye shall not enter into the Kingdom of Heaven*, Mat. xviii. 3. And *again, the Parable of the wicked Servant cast into Prison for not forgiving his Fellow*, Mat. xviii. 30. *The casting of the Rich Glutton into Hell*, Luke xvi. 23. *And again*, He that denieth me before Men, I will deny him before my Father which is in Heaven, *Luke 12. 9. with divers such other Places: All which, I say, do appertain to the Doctrine of the Law*. At this Rate, how small a Portion of the Word of God will be left, to be regarded by the Believer as the Rule of his Life?

2. This Doctrine, if put into Practice, would, as to Believers, take off all Respect unto the Divine Commandments, and all Use, Force and Influence of the Promises and Threatenings, which God in his Word hath appointed for promoting and encouraging true Religion, and Gospel-Holiness. And therefore it ought to be detested, as Prejudicial and Destructive unto all Godliness and Christian Morals. For setting this in a brighter Light, we shall apply his *Note* or Rule above-cited, unto some few Instances, *Luke* xiii. *3. Except ye repent, ye shall all likewise perish*. Here is a Work distinct from believing on Christ, *viz. Repentance*. It is commanded to be done for eschewing of Punishment, *viz. Perishing*. It is therefore (by his Rule) the Voice of the Law, which belongs not to a Believer. In the Opinion of the *Marrow*, a Man is not called to Gospel Repentance before he believe; and when he becomes a Believer, the Command to Repent doth not appertain to him. It must then be false, what the Apostle saith, Acts xvii. 30. *God commandeth all men every where to repent*. Again, 1 *Tim. 4. 7, 8. Exercise thy self unto Godliness*, here is a Moral Duty commanded, and is enforced with a Promise of Reward both Temporal and Eternal, *Godliness is profitable unto all things, having the promise of the Life that now is, and of that which is to come*. To this *Timothy* might have said, This is the Voice of the Law, and I am a Believer, it is not spoken to me; and therefore I am to have no Regard unto this Exhortation, in ordering my

Life and Conversation. Again, *Eph. vi. 2, 3. Honour thy father and mother (which is the first commandment with promise) that it may be well with thee, and thou mayest live long on the earth*. Here is a Moral Work commanded to be done, upon a Promise of Reward Temporal; and therefore it is the Voice of the Law, it doth not belong to a Believer, and he is to have no Regard to it in his Deportment toward his Parents. Again, 1 Thes. *iv. 3. This is the will of God, that ye should abstain from fornication*. Here is a Moral Duty commanded, and a Sin to be avoided. But it is enforced with a Threatening, *Heb*. xiii. 4. But *Whoremongers and Adulterers God will* judge. This is the Voice of the Law, and therefore must no way influence a Believer to abstain from Fornication and Adultery. *Again, 1 Thes. iv. 6. That no man go beyond, and defraud his Brother in any Matter, because that the Lord is the avenger of all such*. Here is a Moral Work commanded for eschewing of Punishment; it is therefore (by his Rule) the Voice of the Law: And a Believer must not be thereby restrained from cheating his Neighbour. I shall not add more Instances, these may suffice for a Sample of the Christian Morals of the *Marrow of Modern* Divinity.

3. I think the *Marrow*, however highly valued by some, is justly blameable in this, in that it advanceth this Doctrine as pure Gospel; and thereby, in Effect, exposeth the true Gospel of Christ unto Contempt and Reproach, as if it were such a Doctrine as the *Marrow* represents it. The awful Authority of God, as He is Sovereign Lord Creator, the binding Force of His perpetual Moral Law, and the Threatenings and Promises thereunto annexed, are appointed to be Restraints against Sin, and Ties and Encouragements unto Holiness: And when all these are taken into the Gospel Dispensation, with a Commandment unto Men to repent of their Sins, in Order unto the obtaining the Pardon of them, and a Denunciation of Wrath against the Impenitent; they become a Fence set by God, about the Offer of his Mercy and Grace, in the Gospel, whereby it is armed and guarded against Contempt and Reproach. But the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, before exhibited,

doth, as to Believers, take off these Restraints against Sin, loose the Ties and take away the Encouragements unto Holiness, and remove the Fence which God hath set for the Guard of his Gospel against Reproach. And to vent such Doctrine as Gospel, is highly injurious and reproachful unto the true Gospel of Christ. The Learned and Judicious Dr. *Owen*, hath a remarkable Observation to this our present Purpose, in his elaborate *Exposition of the Epistle* to the Hebrews, on *Chap*. vi. v. 2. whereof I shall transcribe some Parts. "*That any Person living in Sin, without Repentance, should have an Interest in Christ, or Christian Religion, is inconsistent with the Glory of God, the Honour of Jesus Christ, and would render the Gospel, if taught therein, an* Error *fit to be rejected by all Men. For* where is the Glory of *the Righteousness or Holiness* of God, if Impenitent Sinners *may be accepted with him*? — *And for the Lord Jesus Christ, it would plainly make him the Minister of Sin, the Thought* whereof *our Apostle so detests*, Gal. ii. 17. — And *the Gospel must then be looked on as a* Doctrine *to be abandoned by all wise and sober Persons, that which would tend unavoidably to the debauching of Mankind, and the Ruin of Humane Society. For, whereas it doth openly and avowedly pardon and declare the Pardon and* Remission of Sin, all *Sorts of Sin, to all Sorts of Persons that will believe and obey it, if it did this without any Respect unto its Promise the Condition of Repentance*, there was *there, nor can there be so great an Encouragement unto all Sorts of Sin and Wickedness*.

4. Our *Westminster* Divines have had this *Antinomian* Doctrine in View, when, in Contradiction to it, they so expressly assert the opposite Truths. *Confession, Chap*. xix. § 5. "The Moral Law doth for ever bind all, as well justified Persons as others, to the Obedience thereof; and that not only in Regard of the Matter contained in it, but also in Respect of the Authority of God the Creator who gave it. Neither doth Christ, in the Gospel, any way dissolve, but much strengthen this Obligation." § 6. "Although true Believers be not under the Law as a Covenant of Works, to be thereby justified or condemned; Yet it is of great Use to them, as well as to others; In that as a Rule of Life,

informing them of the Will of God and their Duty, it directs and binds them to walk accordingly. It is likewise of Use to the Regenerate, to restrain their Corruptions; in that it forbids Sin; and the Threatenings of it serve to show what even their Sins deserve, and what Afflictions in this Life they may expect for them, although freed from the Curse thereof threatened in the Law. The Promises of it in like Manner show them God's Approbation of Obedience, and what Blessings they may expect upon the Performance thereof, although not as due to them by the Law as a Covenant of Works. So as a Man's doing Good, and refraining from Evil, because the Law encourageth the one, and deterreth from the other, is no Evidence of his being under the Law, and not under Grace." § 7. "Neither are the forementioned Uses of the Law, contrary to the Grace of the Gospel but do sweetly comply with it; the Spirit of Christ subduing and enabling the Will of Man to do that freely and cheerfully, which the Will of God revealed in the Law requireth to be done." Thus our Confession of Faith plainly condemns and rejects the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, which teacheth, That the Moral Law ought not to be a Rule of Life unto a Believer, as it stands enacted by the Authority of God as He is the Creator; and which would have the Believer loosed from its Compulsion and binding Power, and freed, in his Obedience, from any Regard to the Threatenings and Promises annexed thereto.

It may be said, That though the Author of the Marrow would have a Believer freed from these Motives unto Obedience; yet he is not for his giving loose Reins to his Corruptions, and indulging himself in a licentious wicked Life. But laying aside those low and mean Motives, he may be influenced to do Good, and eschew Evil, from the more noble Principle of the Love of God in Christ, and to do the acceptable Will of the Heavenly Father, in a more sublime and disinterested Way: And, that he is not for casting off the Moral Law altogether. And as to the Matter of the Ten Commandments, *Page 156. he says*, "*That Evangelical Grace*

directs a *Man to no other Obedience, than that* whereof *the Law of the Ten Commandments is to be the* Rule;" but that he would have the Believer receive it at the Hands of Christ, and as the Law of Christ.

But this Apology, if any such shall be made, yields what we have been hitherto proving to be the Mind of the *Marrow, viz*. That a Believer is not under the Authority and Obligation of the Moral Law of Creation: And it opposeth these Motives one to another, which our *Confession* teacheth to be sweetly compliant with one another: And as to a Believer's receiving the Ten Commandments as the Law of Christ, we shall now come, in the next Place, to inquire more particularly about it.

CHAPTER IX

Of the Law of Christ, and a Believer's receiving it as such.

Having treated of the Laws which the Believer is not under, according to the *Marrow*; I come now to consider his Opinion concerning the Law, which he owns a Believer ought to receive as a Rule of Life. And this, he says, is the Law of the Ten Commandments as it is the Law of Christ. *Marrow, p. 155, 156*. "*Then, Sir, I pray you proceed to speak of the Law of Christ; And, First, let us hear what the Law of Christ is*? *Answer, The Law of Christ in Regard of Substance and Matter, is all one with the Law of Works, or Covenant of Works, which Matter is scattered through the whole Bible, and summed up in the Decalogue or Ten Commandments, commonly called the* Moral Law."

I shall, (as on the former Head) take Notice of what I judge blameable in the Doctrine of the *Marrow* concerning the Law of Christ. And,

1. I think the *Marrow* blameable in this, that when he teacheth the Moral Law of the Ten Commandments to be the Law of Christ, he doth not ascribe unto it the Authority and Force of a Divine Law, with a commanding and binding Power; but makes it a passive Rule, a Doctrine, a mere Monitory directing and instructing a Believer in the Knowledge of Good and Evil.

For (1.) He doth not ascribe unto it a commanding Power and binding Force, by Virtue of the Authority of God as he is Creator. For he says, "*It is not delivered by God as he is the Creator out of Christ, and that a Believer is not to receive it at the Hands of God as such*:" This we showed at large in the preceding Chapter, from p. 157. of the *Marrow*, and from Mr. *Towne* there cited. Herein the *Marrow* cannot be justified, if we maintain, as we ought, that the Lord Redeemer assumes the Moral Law of Nature into the Dispensation of Grace, without

diminishing its Authority, or detracting from its Original Obligation. Yea, our Lord owns and establishes the Original Authority, and perpetual Obligation of the standing Law of Creation, when he argues from it against the *Pharisees* in the Matter of Divorce, *Matt*. xix. 8. "*But from* the *Beginning it was not so*;" *and Mark x. 6*. "*But from the Beginning of the Creation, God made them Male and Female*."

(2.) He doth not allow unto it a binding Power from the *Sinaitic* Promulgation; for *Marrow* p. 157. he forbids a Believer to *receive the Ten Commandments at the Hands of* Moses. And why not at the Hands of *Moses*? Is it not the perpetual standing Law of the most High God? And was not *Moses* who delivered it in his Name, a faithful Servant, and commended as such in the New Testament? *Heb*. iii. 2, 5. Why then may not Believers receive it at the Hands of Moses, as faithfully recorded by him? Believers under the Old Testament received this Law at the Hands of *Moses*, and why may not Believers now receive it at the Hands of the same faithful Servant? It is said, *Marrow p. 159*. "*As they were delivered by* Moses *unto the believing Jews from the Ark, and so as from Christ, they were a Rule of Life unto them till the Time of Christ's coming in the Flesh*." *If* they were a Rule of Life unto Believers then, as delivered by *Moses*, why not also unto Believers now, if they ought to receive the Old Testament as the Word of God? But what means he by their being delivered by *Moses* unto the believing Jews, from the Ark, as from Christ? Where is it recorded that *Moses* delivered the Ten Commandments from the Ark? Were they not delivered unto Believers among the Israelites, when they were first spoken immediately by the Voice of God, unto the whole Congregation? *Exod. xx*. And afterward, when they were written upon the two Tables of Stone by the Finger of God, before the Ark was made? And again, when they were repeated by *Moses* at the End of the Forty Years, *Deut*. v. Were they not delivered as vested with the same Authority and binding Power as at first, even the Authority of the Sovereign Lord and Law-giver, saying, I am *the Lord* (Jehovah) *thy God*?

Yea, was not the Law at Mount *Sinai*, given then by Christ, and so His Law? Was He not the *Angel* that spoke to *Moses* in the Mount *Sinai*, and gave to him the lively Oracles? Acts vii. 38. Why then says *he, from the Ark, as from Christ*? This therefore is but a pitiful shuffling; as is also the Reason he gives, why a Believer ought not to receive the Ten Commandments at the Hands of *Moses*, which we have, *Marrow* p. 159. "Since Christ's coming in the Flesh, they have been, and are to be a Rule of Life, both to believing *Jews* and believing *Gentiles*, unto the End of the World; not as they are delivered by *Moses*, but as they are delivered by Christ: For when *Christ* the Son comes and speaks himself, then *Moses* the Servant must keep Silence, according as *Moses* himself foretold," Acts iii. 22. — "And a Voice came out of the Cloud, *saying, This* is my *beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased, hear him*. As if the Lord had said, You are not now to hear either *Moses* or Elias, but my well *beloved Son*; and therefore I say unto you, *Hear him*."

This bids fair for rejecting the whole Old Testament; for if this Reason be good, that, because Believers now are to hear Christ, therefore they are no more to hear *Moses* and the *Prophets*; then ought they to receive only the New Testament, where the Words of Christ, after his coming in the Flesh, are recorded and spoken in it to them: And they are to regard no more the Old Testament, because Moses and the *Prophets*, (Servants now no more to be heard) speak there. But I conceive the true Reason, according to the Principles of the *Marrow*, is, that if Believers now were to receive the Ten Commandments as delivered upon Mount Sinai, they would then become bound unto Obedience, by the Authority of the Sovereign Lord Jehovah their God, which he thinks is inconsistent with the Liberty, wherewith Christ has made them free: And they contain Promises and Threatenings enforcing Obedience, which, according to his above-cited Note or Rule of Difference betwixt the Law and the Gospel, are the

Voice of the Law, and belong not, nor are spoken to a Believer. See *Marrow* p. 267, and 277, above cited.

(3.) In describing the Law of Christ, he doth not attribute unto it any commanding and binding Force derived from his Divine Authority as Mediator. The Reason he assigns why the Ten Commandments are the Law of Christ, is because, p. 160. "Though we find not they are repeated in such a Method as they are set down in *Exodus and Deuteronomy; yet so long as* we find that Christ and his Apostles did require and command these Things that are therein commanded, and reprove and condemn those Things that are therein forbidden, and that both by their Lives and Doctrines, it is sufficient to prove them to be the *Law of Christ*." And then goes he on to show, that the Substance of the several Commandments is repeated in the New Testament; and that therefore they are the Law of Christ, p. 161, 162, 163. But all this may agree to a simple Doctrine, and passive Rule. For when he says, That *Christ and* his *Apostles did require and command, reprove and condemn*, [not by his Kingly Power, but] by *their Lives and Doctrines, and that this is sufficient to prove them to be the Law of Christ*: This will not import, that he owns a proper Authoritative commanding Power given by Christ unto this Law. And thus he represents Christ under Specious Titles, as a King and Law-giver, commanding and forbidding the Substance and Matter of the Ten Commandments, not by his Divine Authority and Sovereign Power; but by the Lives and Doctrines of Himself and His Apostles. And this agrees very well with a *Recommendation*, without the commanding Authority and obliging Force of a Law: To this Purpose he expresseth his Mind, *Marrow*, Part 2d. *Page* 166. "Yet notwithstanding the Matter contained in this Law, even those Precepts and Prohibitions, which I have now delivered unto thee, being the Mind and Will of my Father, and the eternal and unchangeable Rule of Righteousness, and that which is in my Heart, Psal. xl. 8. Yea, and that which I have promised to write in the Hearts of all those that are mine, *Jer*. xxxi. 33. Yea, and

that which I have promised to make them yield willing Obedience unto, *Psal*. cx. 3. I and my Father do commend it unto thee, as that Rule of Obedience, whereby thou art to express thy Love and Thankfulness unto us for what we have done for thee." And if he does not allow the Moral Law to have a commanding and binding Force upon a Believer, from its being delivered by the Authority of God the Creator in Man's Creation, nor from the *Sinaitic* Publication; to what Purpose should he ascribe this Power unto it, from its being delivered by Christ? Is it supposable that he would teach, that this Law, as to a Believer, is stripped of the commanding and binding Power, which it had from the Authority of God as he is Creator, and as the God of *Israel* and of his People in Covenant with him; and yet maintain that the same Power and Force is of new restored to it over a Believer, by the Authority of the Lord Redeemer? For as to this Law's obliging Power over a Believer, is not the Authority of the Lord Creator, and of the Lord Redeemer, one and the same; Seeing *there is one Law-giver, who is able to save and to destroy*, James iv. 12. Yea, if the Law of the Ten Commandments as delivered by Christ, had derived unto it from his Divine Authority a commanding and obliging Power over a Believer, it would bring the Believer, in his Obedience, under the *Coaction or Compulsion* of the Law, which would hinder him from working freely and of his own Accord, in the Opinion of the *Marrow*, as was formerly observed from *Page* 180.

2. The ample Authority of our Lord Jesus Christ, as King, Law-giver and Judge, is too much limited by the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, which confines the Law of Christ unto Believers, that it reacheth not unto the Unregenerate, nor lays them under any Obligation to obey him. For *Marrow* p. 157. he says expressly, "*The other [the Law of Christ] is to be delivered by God, as he is a Redeemer in Christ*, only to such as are in *Christ*." So then, they who are out of Christ, all the Unregenerate, are freed from the Obligation of the Law of Christ, and exempted from his Authority and Jurisdiction, even though they live

under the Dispensation of the Gospel. But how then doth Christ *say, Matt*. xxviii. 18. All *Power is given unto me in Heaven and* in Earth. How shall *he take Vengeance on them that obey not his Gospel*? 2 Thess. i. 8. I take it for granted, that the Gospel, to be obeyed, is the Law of Christ; now if Unbelievers were under Obligation to obey, how shall he take Vengeance on them for not obeying?

I demand of the Reverend Vindicator, if he will vouch this Doctrine of the *Marrow*, or not? If he does, I ask him, by what Law are the Unregenerate Hearers of the Gospel bound to Repent and Believe in Christ? Not by any Law or Command of Christ, or God, in Christ, for that in the Judgment of the *Marrow*, is delivered *only* to such as are in Christ; Nor by the Law, as it was the Covenant of Works; for as such it made no Provision for Repentance, and required of Man Personal Obedience for his Righteousness unto Justification: Whereas the Command to Believe in Christ, obligeth Sinners to seek Righteousness for their Justification in the Obedience of another, even the Surety of the better Covenant. If he shall say that the Unregenerate are bound to Repent and Believe, by the Moral Law, as distinct and severed from that Form of the Covenant of Works: Then he must grant, that even the Unregenerate are freed from *the formal Obligation* of the Covenant of Works; and that the Moral Law without the Form of the Covenant of Works, is a standing and binding Law from the Authority of God as he is the Creator. Again, I would know how he understands this Moral Law: If he understands the Law of Nature in the more strict and proper Sense, as it equally binds all Men every where, and without any positive Commands and Institutions superadded by Revelation; Then the Commands to Repent and Believe in Christ, would be deducible from the Moral Law thus strictly taken, without the Benefit of Revelation: And so the Gospel would not be necessary for revealing the Remedy, and making known the Commandment to Believe in Christ. Or if he understand the Moral Law in a more large Sense, as comprehending also

positive Laws and Institutions that are made known by Gospel Revelation; because the Moral Law obligeth Man to believe and obey God, in whatever He reveals and enjoins by positive Laws. But if he take it in this Sense, then the Commands to Believe and Repent shall become really the Laws of Christ. For they are delivered by *God as in Christ, reconciling the World to himself,* 2 Cor. v. 19, 20. Rom. xvi. 25, 26. and by Christ in the Exercise of his Mediatory Office, *Mark i. 15. Repent* and believe *the Gospel*. John xiv. 1. Ye *believe in God, believe also* in me. And these positive Laws in the Gospel are established by Christ's Authority, *as having all Power in Heaven and Earth*, Matt. xxviii. 18, 19, 20. and therefore they are really the *Law of Christ*. And if they belong to the Law of Christ, then they are delivered *only to such as are* in Christ. And therefore, in the Opinion of the *Marrow*, the Unregenerate Hearers of the Gospel are under no Obligation by any Law of God, to repent of their Sins, and believe in Christ. 3. I think the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, concerning the Law of Christ, culpable in this, That he doth not allow any Promise of Eternal Life, to be annexed unto it, but only temporary Rewards in this Life. *Marrow*, p. 209. "The Reward which the Law of Christ promiseth unto Believers, and which they may hope for, answerably to their Obedience to it, is a comfortable Being in the Enjoyment of sweet Communion with God in Christ, even in the Time of this Life, and a Freedom from Afflictions, both Spiritual and Corporal, so far forth as they are Fruits and Effects of Sin, as it is any Transgression of the Law of Works."

By this Doctrine, all Commands and Exhortations, which are enforced by Promises of Eternal Happiness, are excluded from the Law of Christ. Such are the Commands to repent, Isa. lv. 7. Acts iii. 19. and to believe, *Mark xvi*. 16. John iii. 16, 36. Acts xvi. 31. The Exhortations unto Godliness, 1 Tim. iv. 8. and unto Perseverance, *Matt. x. 22. James i. 12. Rev*. ii. 7, 10. These, and the like, belong not unto the Law of Christ, according to this Doctrine of the Marrow.

4. He teacheth, That the Law of Christ hath no Threatening of Eternal Death, no Penalty of the Wrath and Curse of God annexed to it, in case of a Man's Disobedience to it; but only the Threatening of Fatherly Chastisements, and Temporal Afflictions. *Marrow*, p. 157. "The one [the Law of Works] saith, If thou do it not, thou shalt die; the other [the Law of Christ] saith, If thou do it not, I will chastise thee with the Rod." *And* p. 216. "The Penalty which the Law of Christ threateneth to you, — and which you are to fear, is the Want of near and sweet Communion with God in Christ, even in the Time of this Life, and a Liableness to all temporal Afflictions, as Fruits and Effects of the transgressing of that Law." See also p. 204, 205, within. Hence observe,

(1.) By this Doctrine, the Commands to repent and believe are again excluded from the Law of Christ; because they have Threatenings of Wrath and Damnation annexed to them, Luke xiii. 3, *5. Mark xvi. 16*. John iii. 36. As also all Exhortations unto Godliness, and Dehortations from Apostasy, which have such Threatenings, as Heb. vi. 4, 5, 6. and x. 26—31. and xii. 28, 29. These, and the like, though directed unto Believers, yet belong not to the Law of Christ, they are the Voice of the Law, and not of the Gospel: And therefore belong not to Believers.

(2.) Seeing, by the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, a Believer is not under that Law, which hath a Threatening of Eternal Wrath, or the Curse of God annexed to it; but under the Law of Christ, which hath no such penalty annexed; then Believers' Transgressions of the Law he is under, are not Sins which have any Guilt or Liableness unto that Penalty attending them: And hence will follow, that they are not Sins for which Christ suffered; nor is there any need of the Death and Satisfaction of the Surety for their Expiation: For he was made a Curse for them, that were under the Curse of the Law; but the Sins of Believers deserve no Curse by the Threatening of the Law they are not under: And therefore there was no Cause of Christ's being made a Curse for their Expiation. The Guilt of their Sins contracted before they were Believers, is expiate by the Blood

of Christ, and so pardoned for his sake: But as to their Sins committed after they are once Believers, whence is their Guilt expiate, and how are they Pardoned? Are they pardoned without any Satisfaction at all made to Divine Justice for them? or may Believers themselves make Satisfaction for them? In the Judgment of the *Marrow*, they are of such a venial Nature, that Believers themselves may expiate their Guilt by their Obedience and Amendment: *Marrow Part 2. p. 170*. "*Though Faith in Christ's Blood takes away that Guilt which subjecteth you to the Legal Curse; yet* Obedience *must take away that Guilt which subjecteth you to a Fatherly Displeasure*." Whatever the Reverend Vindicator may think of this Doctrine, I conceive the Apostle was of another Mind; and that he placeth the Believer's Relief against the Guilt of all his Sins, and even of these Sins which he commits after he is a Believer, in the Blood of Christ, 1 John *i. 7, 8. The blood* of Jesus *Christ his Son cleanseth us from all Sin. If* we say we *have no Sin, we deceive ourselves*. And 1 John *ii. 2. He is the Propitiation for our Sins*. And our *Confession* and *Catechisms* know of no Law of Christ, the Transgressions whereof do not deserve Death, nor need the Blood of Christ for their Expiation. See *Confess. Chap*. 6. 6. and *Larg. Cat. Quest. 152. Every Sin, even the least, being against the Sovereignty, Goodness, Holiness of God, and against his righteous Law, deserveth his Wrath and Curse, both in this Life, and that which is to come; and cannot be expiated but by the Blood of Christ*. See also above, Chap. 8. where we proved, That the Penal Sanction is not to be derived only from the Form of the Covenant of Works; but that it is inseparable from the Royal Law of Creation, which every Man is under, though no Covenant of Works had been made.

5. I conceive the Author of the *Marrow* justly blameable, that when he teacheth that the Moral Law of the Ten Commandments is become the Law of Christ, he not only strips it of all Promises of Eternal Life, and Threatenings of Wrath and Eternal Death, but even deprives it of these Temporal Rewards and Punishments, which he seemed to

allow unto it. For by his above-cited *Note* of Difference betwixt the Law and the Gospel, he makes it to be the Voice of the Law, when in Scripture there is any Moral Work commanded to be done, either for the eschewing of Punishment, or upon Promise of any Reward, *Temporal or Eternal*. See p. 267. And he would have not only Believers, but all truly convinced Persons to assure themselves, that this Voice of the Law is not spoken, nor doth belong to them; *see* p. 271, 272. and he makes all Promises and Threatenings whatsoever needless and useless to a Believer, when he teacheth him to have no Regard unto them in his doing good, or eschewing Evil; and that not only as to Promises of Eternal Life, and Threatenings of Eternal Death, which he reckons peculiar to the Law of Works; but also as to the Rewards and Punishments Temporal, which he allows to be annexed to what he calls the Law of Christ. *Marrow p. 216*. "*This is that Goodness of God which will lead you to a free Obedience: So that if you do but apply the Goodness of God in Christ to your Soul in any good Measure, then will you answerably yield Obedience to the Law of Christ; not only without having Respect either to what the Law of Works either promiseth or threateneth, but also without having Respect to what the Law of Christ either promiseth or threateneth. — And this is to serve the Lord without Fear of any Penalty* which *either the Law of Works or the Law of Christ threateneth, in Holiness and Righteousness all the Days of* your *Life*." Thus, that Believers' Obedience may be free, he would have them not to regard Promises or Threatenings: *For* (saith he) p. 181. "So *far forth as they do so, their Obedience is* but slavish."

I shall expose the Unsoundness and Vanity of his Doctrine in a few Reflections. (1.) When *the* Sovereign Lord in his Infinite Wisdom hath annexed his Promises and Threatenings to his holy Laws, both Moral and Positive, and doth direct them unto Believers as well as others, as was showed before: To say that they ought not to have Regard or Respect thereunto, is to teach them to contemn and despise the Authority and Wisdom of the most high God.

(2.) When a Believer, in his Obedience, is influenced by a Respect unto the Promises and Threatenings of the Word; to misrepresent this as not free, but mercenary and slavish, is to reproach the holy Scripture, which enforceth Obedience by these Motives.

(3.) This Doctrine is cut out for cherishing presumptuous Pride and vain Glory in Men; as if their Obedience were more free, pure and noble, than that of Christ himself. For the Scripture testifies of him, That *for the joy* that *was set before him, he endured the Cross*, Heb. xii. 2. And the *Marrow* saith, p. 27. That *he* "*undertook to obey and suffer under the Penalty that* we as Man were to *have undergone*." (A horrid Expression, and injurious unto the Honour of the Son of God.) Was then Christ's Obedience less free, and more Mercenary and slavish, than that of Believers? Are they to be accounted sound, humble or modest, who pretend to outdo our Saviour in Self-denial, and a more noble Way of obeying God?

(4.) I hope the Reverend Vindicator will not own this Doctrine: For I cannot reconcile it with what he says in his Letter to a *private* Christian, p. *14, 15*. "*All who fear God will own, That it is necessary the Believer have Promises to encourage his Obedience. — These are Effects of Christ's Purchase, and Motives needful to influence the Believer's new Obedience, and therein to encourage* him." But, I subsume, the Author of the *Marrow* doth not own the Necessity of Promises to influence and encourage the Believer's Obedience; but would have him to yield Obedience, without having Respect to what the Law of Christ either promiseth or threateneth. And therefore, in the Judgment of the Reverend Vindicator, the Author of the *Marrow* was none of them who fear God.

(6.) He would have a Believer to *receive the Ten Commandments, as the Law of Christ*, *Marrow*, p. 157. Now his receiving it under this Reduplication, as *the Law* of Christ, in his Sense, supposeth, That he must know that his Sins are pardoned, that he is justified, and that he stands in Relation to

God as reconciled to him in Christ: For he must receive it as a Law, which hath no Penalty of the Wrath and Curse of God annexed; And so must know himself to be delivered from the Curse of the Law: And they who do not receive the Law as such, are not under it as such: Hence it will follow, that none are under the Law, as it is the Law of Christ, but Believers who have attained unto Assurance of their Interest in Christ. This again further restricts the Dominion of Christ, and the Authority of his Law, that it reacheth not unto Men who want this Assurance; But this will be a further Restriction, in *the Opinion of the Marrow*, who had restricted it to Believers before: Seeing as was already observed, he makes Assurance to be of the Essence of Faith, and necessary unto all sincere Obedience. See p. 176, to 179. of the *Marrow*.

CHAPTER X

Of the six Antinomian Tenets maintained in the Marrow, by the Distinction of the Law of Works, and Law of Christ.

This Doctrine of the *Marrow* concerning the Law of Christ, which the Believer is under; and the Law which he calls the Law of Works, and from which he would have a Believer altogether free; is contrived and calculated to support and palliate the six *Antinomian* Errors, mentioned in p. 198. of the Marrow, and are these.

1. A Believer is not under the Law, but is altogether delivered from it.

2. A Believer doth not commit Sin.

3. The Lord can see no Sin in a Believer.

4. The Lord is not angry with a Believer for his Sin.

5. The Lord doth not chastise a Believer for his Sins.

6. A Believer hath no Cause, neither to confess his Sins, nor to crave Pardon at the Hands of God for them, neither yet to fast, nor mourn, nor humble himself before the Lord for them.

Of these he says, p. 199. "In *one Sense, they may, all of them, be truly affirmed; and in another Sense, they may, all of them, be truly denied*. Wherefore, *if we would clearly understand the* Truth, we *must distinguish betwixt the Law, as it is the* Law of Works, *and as it is the* Law of Christ:" And so goes on to show that they are all true, with Respect to the Law, as it is the *Law of Works*.

Will the Reverend Vindicator undertake to gloss these Errors into Orthodoxy? Will he *say*, That they may, all of them, be truly affirmed, in any Sense? For they are linked together into a Chain: That because a Believer is *altogether* delivered from the Law; therefore he doth not commit Sin. And because

he hath no Sin in him, therefore God cannot see, nor be angry, nor chastise him for that which is not. And that a Believer hath no Cause to confess, crave Pardon, or humble himself for his Sins, because he hath no Sins to repent of. Will he say, that it is for the Honour of God, or the Reputation of the Gospel of Christ, or the Advancement of true Religion and real Godliness, that he defend these six Positions, by distinguishing betwixt the Law, as it is the *Law of Works*, and as it is the *Law of Christ*, in the Sense of the *Marrow*? For we have impartially exhibited the Genuine Meaning of the *Marrow*, in the preceding *Chapters*, as to the Law, which, he says, the Believer is altogether delivered from; and as to the Law he owns he is still under. And if he shall defend this Distinction of the Law, in the Sense of the *Marrow*; he must maintain all these Articles to be sound Divinity, which we have observed to be justly blameable in the Doctrine of the *Marrow*.

We have already laid a sufficient Foundation for overthrowing this groundless Distinction, and the Superstructure built thereupon. For the whole Art of the *sly Antinomian* lies in the Ambiguity of Words. He assumes some Scripture Phrases, and imposeth his own false Meaning upon them, and then vents them for pure Gospel Truths. To *set* this Matter in a clearer Light, I shall make some Remarks.

(1.) When the Marrow distinguisheth betwixt the Law, as it is the *Law of Works*, and as it is the *Law of Christ; if by the Law of Works*, he mean, the Covenant of Works, as to its Form, requiring Man's perfect and personal Obedience for his Righteousness unto Justification: I own the Phrase is Scriptural, for thus is the Law of *Works* to be understood, as opposite to the Law of *Faith, Rom. iii. 27. And the* Believer is not under this *Law of Works*, requiring personal Obedience for Justification. And it is distinct from what he calls the *Law of Christ*, which hath neither Promises of Eternal Life, nor Threatenings of Eternal Death annexed to it. But his Distinction in this Sense, can do him no Service for supporting

the above-mentioned *Antinomian* Positions. For, (1.) The Distinction itself is lame, seeing there are divers Laws, which are neither the *Law of Works* in the Sense proposed, nor the *Law* of Christ as by him described. Such are the Moral Law of Nature established by God as he is Creator, and promulgated in the Ten Commandments to the Church at Mount *Sinai*, and the positive Laws of God added by Revelation, as the Commands to Repent, to Believe, and to persevere therein, which have Promises of Life, and Threatenings of Wrath annexed. Seeing then this Division doth not comprehend all the Kinds into which the Law is to be divided, it is but a false and deceitful Distinction: And therefore, (2.) It cannot support the Fabric that is built upon it; not one of these *Antinomian* Positions can be verified from it. For though a Believer be freed from the *Law* of Works, in the Sense proposed; yet being under these other Laws, beside *the Law* of *Christ*, as by him described; it is false, that he is not under the Law, but altogether delivered from it: And when he transgresseth these other Laws, beside the Law of Christ; it is false, that he doth not commit Sin, and that the Lord doth not see, is not angry, and will not chastise him for his Sins. And, if a Believer has sinned against these other Laws, it is false, that he hath no Cause to confess his Sins, and to crave Pardon for them, and to fast, mourn and humble himself before the Lord for them. And to show further how groundless and unserviceable to his Purpose, this Distinction is, I shall observe, (3.) That what he says of a Believer, p. 199, 200, 201. the same may be as truly said of an Unbeliever, as to this Sense of the *Law of Works*. Thus, the Law as it is the *Law of Works*, obligeth Men to seek Righteousness for Justification in their own personal Obedience; But Unbelievers, living under the Gospel Call, are under an opposite Obligation, to renounce their own Righteousness, and to seek Righteousness for Justification in the Obedience of another, even Jesus Christ. And seeing they cannot be under opposite Obligations at the same Time, it may therefore be truly said, of these Unbelievers, that they are not

under the Law, as it is the *Law of Works*, requiring personal Obedience for their Justification: For they are delivered from the formal Obligation, though not from the Penal Sanction of the broken Covenant. And (as the *Marrow* says of Believers, p. 199.) if these Unbelievers be not under the Law, but are delivered from the Law, as it is a *Law* of Works, then though they sin, yet do they not transgress *the Law of Works*: For where no Law is, there is no Transgression. And if these Unbelievers sin not against the *Law* of Works, then can God see no Sin in these Unbelievers, as a Transgression of that Law, they are not under the Obligation of. (See p. 206.) And if God can see no Sin in them; then assuredly he is neither angry, nor doth chastise these Unbelievers for their Sins, as Transgressions of that Law: Now, if the Lord be not angry with these Unbelievers, neither doth chastise them for their Sin, as it is a Transgression of the *Law of Works*, they being under the opposite Obligation; then need they not to confess their Sins unto God, nor to crave Pardon for them, nor yet to fast, nor mourn, nor humble themselves for them, as conceiving them to be *any* Transgression of the Law, as it is the *Law* of *Works*. I have kept mostly the Words of the *Marrow*, p. 200, 201. only putting *Unbelievers* for *Believers*. Thus we see, that if we consider the Law in this Sense, all that he affirms of the Believer, may be as truly affirmed of the Unbeliever who lives under the Gospel: Which sufficiently evinceth the Absurdity of his Distinction in this Sense.

(2.) If, by the *Law* of Works in this Distinction, he meaneth all Divine Laws whatsoever, besides the *Law of Christ* as by him described, which he makes the other Member of his Division of the Law: And so, if under the Name of the Law, as it is the *Law of Works*, he comprise not only the *Law of Works* properly taken, or the Form of the Covenant of Works, (of which before) but also the Moral Law of Nature, established by the Authority of God, as he is Creator, which he owns to be the Matter of the Covenant of Works; and also all the positive Laws of God, which have Promises of Life, and Threatenings

of Wrath annexed; such as the Commands to Repent, Believe and Persevere: Then have we the native Meaning of the *Marrow*, and the full Import of the Law of *Works* in his Sense, as was above evinced. And in this Sense, and upon this Supposition, I acknowledge all his Antinomian Points will readily follow: For if under the *Law of Works* there be comprised, not only the Formal Law or Obligation of the Covenant of Works, Do *and live*; but also all the other Laws of God, Moral and Positive: And if a Believer be altogether delivered from the Obligation of all these Laws; then he cannot transgress the Law he is not under, nor doth God see Sin in him, which is not; and so of the rest. But then (1.) This is not the Scripture Meaning of the *Law* of Works, but his own Sense unwarrantably imposed upon the Words of Scripture to deceive the Simple: For no where in Scripture is the *Law of Works* taken in this Sense. And (2.) It is most false, that a Believer is loosed from the perpetual binding Obligation of the Moral Law of Nature, as enacted and established by the Authority of God in the Creation of Man, and as delivered to his Church in Ten Commandments from Mount *Sinai*. Neither is the Believer freed from the Obligation of the Law of God, *commanding all Men every where to repent*, Acts xvii. 30. nor from the *Commandment of God, to believe on the Name of his Son Jesus Christ*, 1 John iii. 23. nor from the Command, *Be thou faithful unto death, and* thou shalt receive *the Crown of Life*, Rev. ii. 10. And this Supposition being false, all the *Antinomian* Superstructure built upon it must fall to the Ground.

(3.) As to the other Member of his Distinction, the *Law of Christ*, it is indeed a Scriptural Expression, *Gal. vi. 2. Bear ye one another's Burdens, and so fulfil the law of* Christ. But there it plainly signifies the Law of mutual brotherly Love, which Christ calls his New *Commandment*, John xiii. 34. because he enforceth it upon his Disciples by new Motives, especially that of his own Love to them even unto the Death. I grant also, That Believers are under the Law to Christ, as the Apostle says of himself, 1 *Cor. ix. 21. Being not without the* Law to *God, but*

under the Law to Christ. And the Moral Law, when taken into the Dispensation of Grace, may be called the *Law of Christ*. But then Christ doth not divest it of its original Authority, binding Power, and Penal Sanction, but admits it into his Gospel as the indispensable Law of God the Creator, and the perpetual binding Rule of Life unto all Men, Believers as well as others. The *Law* of Christ, in this Sense, is the very same with the Moral Law, or Ten Commandments; And if this Moral Law enacted by God the Creator, be what he calls the *Law of Works; Because, as he says, it was the Matter* of *the Covenant of Works*: Then the Law of the Ten Commandments, as it is what he calls the *Law of Works*, is really the *Law of Christ*; his Distinction therefore of the Law is false and absurd; because the Members into which it is divided do not differ the one from the other, but really coincide. And in this Sense of it, not one of his *Antinomian* Positions can be truly affirmed: For if a Believer be under the Law of *Christ, then he is under* the *Law* of Works, seeing they are both really the same Law of the Ten Commandments. And if he sin against it, as it is the *Law of Christ*, he sins also against it, as it is the Law of Works, and so of all the rest. Now, the Author of the *Marrow* does not take the Law of *Christ* in this sound Meaning, but affixes unto the Expression his own false Sense; representing it as a passive Rule, without any binding Force from the Authority of the Divine Law-giver, obliging a Believer unto Obedience; and without any Promise of Life, and Threatening of Wrath annexed to it. And this his Sense of it will be grateful and pleasing unto the *Antinomian Libertine*, in whose Favours he has contrived it. For though he be under the *Law of Christ* in this Sense, yet having persuaded himself that he is a Believer, he is left at Freedom from any commanding Power, or constraining Authority of this Law: And though he do transgress this Law, yet his Sins are no Violation of the Authority of the Law-giver, nor do they deserve his Curse from any Threatening of the Law he is under. Hence God doth not see them, nor is angry for them, as deserving his Wrath.

And though a Believer do sin against the Law of *Christ*, yet in this Sense of it, he hath no Cause to confess that he has neglected the Authority of the Law-giver; neither hath he Cause to crave Pardon, or pray that he may be delivered from the Wrath and Curse of God deserved for his Sins against this Law; for they deserve no Curse from, and by the Threatening of this Law. Nor hath he Cause to apply unto the Blood of Christ, for the Remission of his Sins against this Law; for they need not the Satisfaction of Christ for their Expiation, a Man's own Obedience must take away the Guilt of them, according to the Opinion of the *Marrow*, as was showed more fully in the preceding Chapter.

These six *Antinomian* Tenets, which we have been considering, have a plain Tendency to cause People make light of Sin, to loose their Obligation unto Obedience, both of the Moral Law of Creation, and Positive Laws of God in the Gospel, and to cause them slacken their Diligence in following Holiness, without which no Man shall see the Lord. And if the Author of the *Marrow* had not himself been an *Antinomian*, he would rather have rejected these Errors with Detestation, than have farded them over with the false Colours of a groundless Distinction; And his Reverend Vindicator might have been better employed, than in representing to the private Christian, the Doctrine of the *Marrow* concerning the *Law of Christ*, as if it were a Doctrine that points out *the only Method towards effectual Obedience to the Law, and demolishing Antinomianism, under whatsoever Disguise it may be covered*.

CHAPTER XI

In the Opinion of the Marrow, the Law of Christ neither justifies nor condemns.

I shall add to the former a further Observation on the Doctrine of the *Marrow*; That it makes the Law of Christ a very low and mean Thing, and Christ himself a very despicable *Law-giver and* Judge. For, as we have showed, It is, in his Account, a Law without a commanding Power, and binding Authority to enforce Obedience, and without a Promise of eternal Life to the Observers, and Threatening of Wrath against the Contemners and Transgressors of it. And it follows, That it is a Law by which no Man shall be judged, absolved, or condemned. This Inference is expressly owned by the *Marrow, p. 163. For* (saith he) "as it *is the Law of Christ, it neither justifies nor condemns*."

I shall offer some Reflections upon this Point.

1. Properly, it is the Judge who justifies or condemns: But by a Metonymy, the Law is said to justify or condemn, because it is the Rule, according to which the Judge gives his Judgment in Justifying the Righteous, or condemning the Guilty. And a Law which neither justifies nor condemns, cannot be a Rule to the Judge, neither can he in Judgment have any Regard to it, seeing it is of no Authority either to justify or condemn. Hence it will follow, That God the Judge of all, will have no Regard to the Law of Christ, it is not a Rule by which He will judge of Men. Is not this in Effect to make the Law of Christ most base and despicable? Is not this to teach Men securely to contemn it? For this Doctrine tells them upon the Matter, Ye need not be careful about the Law of Christ; for though ye answer its Commands, God will not acquit you by it; nor will he condemn you, though ye contemn and transgress it; because it is not to be the Rule of his Judgment concerning you.

2. Not the Moral Law only, but all Gospel Commands, as was observed before, belong unto the Law of Christ. For they are given forth by God in Christ, reconciling the World to himself, and are founded upon the Covenant of Redemption, and God's constituting and appointing His only begotten Son to be the Mediator, Redeemer and Saviour of Sinners: And these Gospel Commands and Institutions are Christ's Laws; seeing to Him as such, all Power in Heaven and in Earth is given, and all Judgment committed: And by this his Power and Authority, He gives them out in the Gospel as Commands, Matt. xxviii. 18, 19, 20. He commissions His Apostles to disciple all Nations, *Teaching them (saith Christ) to observe all Things whatsoever I have commanded you*. Our Lord here owns the Gospel Commands to be His Law; and as they were His Law to His Apostles whom he commanded, so they were His Law to the Nations who were to observe them. The Gospel then is the Law of Christ unto all who hear it, enjoining them to receive, believe and observe what Things soever He hath commanded. Now this Gospel, as it is to be obeyed, is a Rule by which He will judge all to whom it is sent; and the not obeying of it, shall be a Ground of their Condemnation, 2 *Thess*. i. 8. The Lord *shall take* vengeance *on them that know not God, and obey not the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ*. And, 1 Pet. iv. *17. If judgment first begin at us, what shall the end of them be that obey not the gospel*? Wherefore whatever the *Marrow* say of his imaginary Law of Christ, it is false, That the true *Law of Christ* doth neither justify nor condemn.

3. To evince further the Falsehood of the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, we shall consider an Instance of a Gospel Command, 1 *John* iii. 23. This *is God's commandment, That we should believe on the Name of his Son Jesus Christ*. This is a Law of Christ, for it is founded upon God's Love, in giving His only beloved Son, *John iii. 16. God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son*; and hereupon he hath established this Law and Gospel Statute, *That* whosoever *believeth in Him, should not perish, but* have *everlasting life*. And it is delivered by Christ among these

Things, which He commanded his Apostles to teach all Nations, *Mark xvi. 15, 16. Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature; he that believeth, and is baptized, shall be saved, and he that believeth not shall be damned*. Here is a Gospel Command, a Law of Christ, which is a Rule established by God himself, according to which he will judge the Hearers of the Gospel. He *is just, and the Justifier of him that believeth in Jesus*, Rom. iii. 26. And so this Gospel Statute, as a Rule justifies the Believer, Acts xiii. 38. And as God will condemn the Unbeliever, so this Rule condemns him also, *Mark xvi. 16. He that believeth not shall* be *damned*: And more expressly, *John xii. 48. He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: The word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day*. Wherefore the Gospel or *Law of Christ* is an established Rule of Judgment, and as such it both justifies and condemns.

If it shall be said in Behalf of the *Marrow*, that Unbelievers are under the Curse and Condemnation of the *Law of Works*; that the Gospel or *Law of Christ* holds forth, and calls them unto the Remedy provided in Christ, which, if they reject, they remain under the Curse of the broken Covenant of Works, as in *John iii. 18. He that believeth not is condemned already*: And therefore it is the Law of Works, and not the Gospel or *Law of Christ*, that condemneth the Unbeliever, I answer, This doth not invalidate what we have advanced against the Doctrine of the *Marrow*. For, (1.) It is true, the Unbeliever is under the Curse of the Covenant of Works, and so condemned already; but when he rejects the Relief offered in the Gospel, he comes under a further Condemnation, as follows in John *iii. 19. And this is the condemnation, that Light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light*. So that the Unbeliever is under a double Condemnation from the *Law of Works*, and also from the Gospel or *Law of Christ*. And it remains still a certain Truth, what our Saviour said, *John xii. 48. The word that I have* spoken, and which the Unbeliever hath rejected, the *same shall judge him in the last day. (2.)* As the Unbeliever by Disobeying the

Gospel, contracts new Guilt, and deserves further Punishment; so the Gospel threatenings shall not prove empty *Scare-crows*, but shall be found freighted with Gospel Vengeance, *Heb. x. 29, 30. Of how much sorer punishment, suppose ye, shall he be thought worthy, who hath trodden under foot the Son of God*? — *Vengeance belongeth unto me, and I will* recompense, *saith the Lord. And, (3.) If the Law of Works* only, and not the *Gospel*, be the Rule in Judgment which condemns the Unbeliever, as this Exception importeth; then the same *Law* is the Rule in Judgment, which Justifies the Believer. But this is false: for by the Law of Works requiring Personal Obedience for Righteousness, no Man can be justified. But as the Obedience of the Surety is admitted unto the Justification of the Believer, who receives and rests upon it; so the Gospel Statute, Acts xiii. 38. By *him, all that believe on Him, are justified*, must be admitted as the Rule of Judgment, in justifying the Believer. And if this Law of Christ, as a Rule in Judgment, justify the Believer, it also condemns the Unbeliever.

If it shall be further objected in Favour of the *Marrow*, That the *Law of Christ*, as he takes it, is delivered only to Believers. Now, Believers are supposed to be justified before they receive this Law, and there is no Condemnation to them that are in Christ Jesus; and therefore the Law of Christ respecting only justified Believers, neither justifies nor condemns: I own the reasoning to be just upon the Principles of the *Marrow*. But the Supposition, That the Law of Christ reaches only to Believers, is false. And this I mentioned before among the Points blameable in the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, that hereby he unduly cramps and limits the ample Power and Authority of the Lord Jesus Christ, who is Head over all Things to the Church. And again I ask, By what Rule of Judgment is the Believer Justified? Not by the Law of Works; *For by the works of the Law shall no flesh be justified*, Gal. ii. 16. He is therefore justified by the Gospel *Law and* Statute, admitting the Satisfaction and Obedience of the Surety, or by no Rule of Judgment at all. From what hath been said, we may see how

groundless this Doctrine of the *Marrow is, viz*. That *the Law of Christ* neither justifies nor condemns; but it discovers the Cunning of its sly *Antinomian* Author. For in this Passage, p. 163. he pretends to plead for the Law against *Antinomists*, that a Believer is not quite freed from it, but is still under the Law of Christ; and, as we observed in the preceding *Chapter*, he teacheth that when a Believer doth transgress this Law of Christ, he commits Sin, and God sees it, and is angry with him for it. Yet here he gives a Cordial, or rather a *Soporific* that may be grateful and pleasing unto the *Antinomian*, where he tells him, *This Law of Christ neither* justifies nor *condemns*. And therefore he may be easy about it, though he be under it: For God will not make it a Rule according to which He will judge Him, either to acquit or condemn. He shall never be brought to the Question about it, whether he hath obeyed or disobeyed this Law. He shall not be much restrained in his Liberty by it, for it shall not condemn him, though he contemn and neglect it. This is so far from being Religious *Marrow*, that it will be a choking Bait to be avoided, by all that are exercised unto Godliness, and who Reverence the Son of God.

CHAPTER XII

The Doctrine of the Marrow concerning Sanctification is Antinomian, and disowns Good Works to be necessary to Salvation.

What hath been said of the Law, the Believer is freed from, and the Law he is still under, according to the Doctrine of the *Marrow*, may lead us on to consider what he teacheth concerning Sanctification, and the Necessity of Holiness and Good Works: And to do Justice to the Author of the *Marrow*, I frankly own, that he is not for a Believer's giving loose Reins to his Corruptions, or that he should indulge himself in vile Lusts and Sensuality, to work all Manner of Wickedness with Greediness. I own, he saith in his *Preface*, That *there are some that talk like Believers, and yet do not walk like Believers; that have Language like Saints, and yet have Conversation like Devils; These are they that are not obedient to the Law of Christ; and therefore are justly called* Antinomians. And he sets up for a Middle Way betwixt them and the *Legalists*. I grant also, that all these Passages are in the *Marrow*, which its Vindicator hath cited in a small Pamphlet, entitled, *Some few of many Passages, collected from the Marrow of Modern Divinity, for clearing it from the Charge of Antinomian Licentiousness*. Yet this doth not purge and clear the *Marrow* from the Leaven of *Antinomianism* in this Point. It was on this Account that when I mentioned that *Pamphlet in Chap*. 1. I called it a poor Performance: And I shall now give some Reasons of that my Opinion of it, because they also make for the present Purpose.

1. The Vindicator of the *Marrow*, in that *Pamphlet* misstates the Question, when he undertakes to clear the *Marrow* from the Charge of Antinomian Licentiousness. For the Author of *the Preface* to the late Edition of our *Confession*, whom he pretends to answer, had said (p. cxxxv.) concerning the *Marrow*, that "*There are in that Book many Passages, which, if they* do not

dissolve *the Obligation to Obedience, and openly allow to Christians a licentious Liberty; yet mightily* weaken its *Force and Efficacy, tend to cool the Zeal and Vigour of Christians in the Study of Holiness, and to give them mean and languishing Thoughts of it, as of no great Importance or Necessity in* Christianity." This plainly supposes, that though the *Marrow* may openly profess and declare against Licentiousness, yet he may, and doth advance and maintain such Tenets, as tend to weaken and loose the Believer's Obligation unto Obedience, and to slacken his Diligence in the Study of Holiness and Good Works, as not necessary unto Salvation. This being the true Charge against the *Marrow*, the Passages adduced in the *Pamphlet* do not clear him of it, though they expressly declare against Licentiousness. 2. I think it a weak Performance for Vindication of the *Marrow*, because the Second, Third and Fourth Passages cited in the Pamphlet, are not to the Purpose. For they all speak of the Law, which was in the Covenant of Works, from which, in the Opinion of the *Marrow*, a Believer is altogether delivered, and no more under its Obligation. The first Passage cited from *Marrow p. 22. saith, That the Law forbiddeth* all *Habitual Concupiscence*; The second Passage from p. 23. That, *though Strength to obey be lost, yet the Obligation to Obedience remains still*; The third Passage from p. 51. saith, *The Lord may justly require perfect Obedience at all Men's Hands, by Virtue of that Covenant which was made with* them in Adam. Now when the Marrow teacheth, that a Believer is not only freed from the formal Obligation of the Covenant of Works, but also from the Law, which was the Matter of it; these Passages make nothing to his Purpose: And therefore, upon the citing of these Passages, he might have forborne his insulting Question, Is this *Antinomian* Licentiousness? Seeing they are not pertinent, and the *Marrow's* loosing a Believer from the commanding Power and binding Authority of the Moral Law of Creation, doth tend to encourage Licentiousness.

3. The other Passages of the *Marrow* adduced in its Vindication, contain no more than what other *Antinomians* do as expressly assert. This may be evinced by comparing those Passages of the *Marrow*, with the like Expressions of that Evangelical Mr. *Towne*. In the fifth Passage quoted from *Marrow p. 98, 99. Evangelista* challengeth *Antinomista* for saying, That he could rejoice *evermore in Christ, and live merrily, though he were never so vile or sinful a Creature*; and tells him, *That he questioned whether he had truly* believed *in Christ for all his Confidence; because he hath heard that his Conversation is not such as becometh the Gospel of Christ*. And tells him further, *p. 101. That true Faith produceth Holiness of Life. Mr. Towne* saith as much against Licentiousness, *Assertion of Grace*, p. 134. "We maintain that the Spirit of Christ leadeth freely and cheerfully in all the Ways of God. Your Lawless Spirit is still wide, and beside the Rule of the Law, in condemning us of *Libertinism*, which we detest and oppose with as much *Zeal* as yourself." And p. 138. Then speaking of the Believer's Liberty from the binding Authority of the Law, saith, "Those sin wickedly, who hence take Liberty to Sin. And they also speak lewdly, who teach, that by this Means the Bridle is given to our Lusts." And p. 171. "This discovereth the Vanity of their Profession and Faith, in whom Christ, and the Love of God in him, doth not effectually move and constrain to walk worthy of so high and heavenly a Calling: Such have not heard Christ, nor been taught by him; as the Truth is in Jesus: True Faith purifieth the Heart, &c." In the sixth Passage, from Marrow p. 156. The Law of the Ten Commandments is said *to be given of God, to be a true and Eternal Rule* of *Righteousness for all Men*. And *Towne* says the like, *Assert. p. 6*. "*Yet I wish that I be not mistaken, for I never deny the Law to be an Eternal and Inviolable Rule of Righteousness*;" Though he had said before, p. 3. that by the Law the Believer is not under, he understood the *Moral Law* or *Decalogue, with all its Authority, Dominion, Offices and Effects*. But by the Eternal Rule of Righteousness, he means the Matter of the Law without its commanding Authority and binding

Power; Ibid. p. 170. "True, and the Law, in the Matter of it, so far as I know, was never denied to be the Rule, according to which a Believer is to Walk and Live: Therefore I take the contrary Imputation to be an impudent Slander:" And so speaks the *Marrow, p. 102. Friend Antinomista, you have offended on the left Hand, in not walking according to the Matter of the Law*.

The seventh Passage from *Marrow* p. 167. "A Christian Man is not at Liberty to do these Things that are ungodly and wicked. — But a Christian Man doing against those Things, which He commanded in the Decalogue, doth sin more outrageously than he that should so do, being under the Law, so far off is he from being free from those Things that be there commanded. Wherefore, Friend *Antinomista*, if either you, or any Man else, shall under a Pretence of your being in Christ, exempt yourselves from being under the Law of the Ten Commandments, as they are the Law of Christ, I tell you truly, it is a shrewd Sign you are not yet in Christ." Here I observe, 1. He speaks of doing against the Things commanded in the Law, but not against the Commandment or Law itself; And this is agreeable to the Antinomian Doctrine, which makes the Matter of the Law without its commanding Authority, to be the Rule to a Believer. And how a Man can sin against the Things commanded, or Matter of the Law, and not against the Authority of the Law and Law-giver, is what I cannot comprehend. 2. He had said in the preceding *Page 166*. "*Now this is most* certain, *that the Ten Commandments do no Way work Transgression, Anger, Curse and Death, but only as they are the Covenant of Works*." Then the Ten Commandments, as they are the Law of Christ, do no Way work Transgression, Anger, Curse and Death. How then can a Christian Man's doing against them be a Transgression, or a more outrageous Sinning? 3. If a Believer's doing against the Law of Christ be a Sinning more outrageously, then it would be more displeasing to God, and deserve a heavier Curse; But it is not so in the Opinion of the *Marrow*, for the Law of Christ hath no Curse annexed unto the Transgressions of it, but only fatherly

Chastisements: And therefore any Sinning against this Law is not so outrageous, as to deserve a Curse from its Threatening. *Towne* also speaks against a Believer's taking Liberty to sin, Assert. p. 172. "Christ within would frame his Mind better, than the Law could constrain by Threatening and Terrifying: Hereby that Calumny is cleared, that if Christ free us from the Subjection of the Law, it brings Liberty to sin. For Christ doth not send his out to an unbridled Wantonness, that without Modesty they should exult as Horses let loose in the Fields; but he brings them to a Course of living agreeable to the Law."

The eighth Passage from *Marrow* p. 168, 169. concerning Marks and Signs, I considered already in Chap. III. and there I also adduced Mr. Towne speaking the like Language with the *Marrow*, which I shall not here repeat.

Wherefore, seeing the Antinomians say as much against Licentiousness as the Marrow doth; the above Passages collected from it, are so far from clearing it from the Charge laid against it in the *Preface* to our Confession, that they show its Agreement with other Antinomian Writings on that Head.

The Truth is, the more sober *Antinomians*, with whom I rank the Author of the Marrow, do exclaim against the lewd and licentious Practices of the more Gross *Libertines*; and are not for Believers giving up themselves to unbridled Lusts and vile Affections, but teach that true Faith leads to Holiness of Life; yet they entertain several unsound Notions, which tend to weaken a Believer's Obligation unto Obedience, and slacken his Diligence in the Practice of Holiness. They are not for Believers being bound to do Good and eschew Evil, by the commanding Power of a Law, and Divine Authority of the Law-giver; lest the Moral Coaction of the Law should hinder their Freedom in doing Good of their own Accord. But they would have Believers to be only under the Physical Operation and Impulse of the Spirit, whereby they are excited and carried on to the Good Things commanded, which are the Matter of the Law. And so they set the holy and binding Rule

of the Law, in Opposition unto the gracious Operation of the Sanctifying Spirit, as if these were inconsistent in a Believer's Obedience. *Towne* saith, *Assert. p. 138*. "*If the Spirit be free, why will you control and rule it by the Law*? *whereas, the Nature of the Spirit is just to conform the Heart and Life to the outward Rule of the Law, without the Help of the Law*." And the *Marrow* copies after him, saying, p. 180. "*The Spirit writes the lively Law of Love in his Heart, Whereby he is enabled to work freely and of his own Accord, without the Coaction or Compulsion of the Law*."

Hence they do not allow inherent Holiness, and the Practice of Good Works to be necessary unto Salvation, by the Command of God, and even as a Means appointed of God, and necessary to fit the Believer for the Possession of Glory. When we assert the Necessity of Holiness and Good Works, we do not mean that they are the Matter and Ground of our Justification, or that they are meritorious of Salvation, or the procuring Cause of the Right and Title to Eternal Life. Nor do we *say* that Good Works are necessary in these that die in Infancy, or even in the Adult, if they be taken *away* soon after their Conversion. *Rutherford* says well, *Survey of Antinomianism, p. 62*. "*We say not they are so necessary, but that any savingly believing at the nick of the Extremity of his twelfth and last Hour, God taking away all Opportunity of Good* Works, *is undoubtedly saved: But in the Work of that Faith there is a Seed and Supernatural Disposition to Good* Works." But in Believers that are continued some time in this Life, we say they are necessary by the Commandment of God, and as Means to make them meet for the Inheritance of the Saints in Light. *Antinomians* oppose this Doctrine, and the *Marrow* agrees with them therein: This will be evident from the following particular Instances.

1. Towne Assert. p. 14. "*Corrupters of the* Word (saith he) I *mean such as so teach* Faith, as *withal they maintain and foster that Pestilent Opinion, that Works also, and the keeping of the Law are necessary to Salvation*." *Again, Dr. Taylor* had said of Good Works, God enableth to them, but Man worketh them, and

walketh in the Way of them to Blessedness: Not that our Works are Causes, but Conditions, without which Blessedness is not attained. To this Mr. *Towne* answers, *Assert*. p. 65. "If you could be contented with the Simplicity of the Gospel, then Christ alone and his Works, which is not I and my Works of Sanctification, will suffice to lead and bring to Heaven; so that you walk therein by Faith. Is not Christ the *Way, Truth and Life*? John xiv. 6. Hath he not *consecrated a New and Living Way by* his Flesh? Heb. x. 20. Should we know any other Way to Heaven, to God, or Happiness, or can we walk in or keep this Way save only by Faith? *The Just liveth by Faith*; and *as he receiveth Christ, so he walketh in him* by Faith," Col. ii. 6.

This Passage of *Towne seems* to have been in the View of the Author of the *Marrow*, when he says, p. 184, 185. "*Nomista*, Then, Sir, it seems that Holiness of Life and Good Works, are not the Cause of Eternal Happiness, but only the Way thither. Evan. Do you not remember that our Lord Jesus himself saith, I am the Way, *the Truth and* the *Life*? John xiv. 6. And doth not the Apostle say to the Believing *Colossians, As ye have received Jesus Christ the Lord, so walk in him*, Col. ii. 6. That is, as ye have received him by Faith, so go on in your Faith, and by his Power walk in his Commandments: So that Good Works (as I conceive) may rather be called, a Believer's walking in the *Way* of Eternal Happiness, than the Way itself." He (the *Marrow*) will not own, Holiness and Good Works to be so much as the Way to Salvation; though it be granted to him that they are not the Cause. But we have better Authority than that of *Towne* and the *Marrow* to depend upon, when God himself calls Holiness the *Way, Isa. xxxv. 8, 9. And an High-way* shall be *there, and a Way, and it shall be called the Way of* Holiness, — *The Redeemed of the Lord shall walk there. And Heb. xii. 14. Follow Holiness, without which no Man shall see the Lord*, shows the Necessity of it. And *Eph. ii. 10. Good* Works are ordained that a Believer should *walk* in them. May not then Good Works be called the Way wherein they walk, as our *Westminster* Divines term it, *Larger Catechism Quest*. 32. It is true, Christ is called the

Way; but though Christ be the Way, as he is the Author of Salvation, by the Merit of His Obedience, and Efficacy of His Grace; yet that doth not hinder, but that Holiness and Good Works may also be called the Way, as Means appointed and commanded, in Order unto the Believer's obtaining the Possession of the Heavenly Inheritance. And by the same Reason of Christ's being called the Way, they might also deny Faith to be the Way of our obtaining Interest in Christ, and a Title to Eternal Life: And therefore the *Marrow* is not very consistent with itself, when in the same *page* 185. it is said, "*This we may assuredly conclude, that the Sum and Substance* both of *the Way and walking in the* Way, consists in *the receiving of Jesus Christ by Faith, and in yielding Obedience to his Law*."

The Learned and Godly Mr. *Rutherford* is so far from agreeing with the *Marrow* in this Point, that he expressly refutes it as an Antinomian Error, in his *Survey of Antinomianism*, p. 60. Where he shows, 1. "God commandeth Good Works through the whole New Testament. 2. They are so necessary, as without them Faith justifies us not. 3. They are the End for which Christ redeemed us. 4. They are Conditions without which we cannot be saved." *And p. 39*. "*That which Crispe* saith, is much of God; *But withal (saith he) I must tell* you, that *all this Sanctification of Life, is not a jot the Way of a justified Person to Heaven. It* is true, they are not the Meritorious, the Efficient Cause of Way, nor the formal Covenant Condition, but a Way they are, as Sowing is to Harvest, Running to the Garland, Fighting to the Victory." *And* p. 61. "Therefore they must be commanded as the Way of Salvation, and not as arbitrary Acts of Good Conversation before Men. But I shall here answer Mr. *Towne's* Objections tending to prove, that Good Works are not so much as the Way to Salvation." And after this he proposeth and answereth *Towne's* Six Arguments against the Necessity of Good Works, as the Way to Salvation. As the *Marrow* holds this Tenet, so he agrees with *Antinomians* in their Principles, upon which they found it. For,

2. *Antinomians (as Mr. Rutherford* saith, *ibid*. p. 63.) ever confound Justification and Salvation. And when they place complete Salvation in Justification, Good Works can be no more necessary unto Salvation than to Justification. Saltmarsh, *Free Grace, Edit. 10th. p. 111*. "*The* Spirit *of Christ sets a Believer as free from Hell, the Law and Bondage here on Earth, as if he were in Heaven; nor wants he any Thing to make him so, but to make him believe, that he is so*."

Towne Assertion, p. 53. "*First, Justification, Salvation, and Blessedness are attained by the Gospel, in Order of Nature; and then Sanctification* followeth, *and floweth thence, as an Effect or Consequence, in the Justified, saved and blessed. Then Good Works cannot consist, or stand in Competition* with *Faith, either as Causes or Conditions in the compassing of true Happiness. For how can they be required as necessary Conditions towards the attaining of that which is effected and possessed, before they can come into Presence, or yet have any Being at all*." It doth not satisfy Mr. *Towne*, That a Believer in Justification obtain a Right and Title to Eternal Life and Salvation, but he will have Faith to enter him also into present Possession of all Happiness, *Assertion, p. 54*. "*Thus Faith first saveth a Man from all his Sins, from Wrath, Death and the Devil; — and then putteth him into a* present Possession of all Happiness." p. 60. "In Effect Dr. Taylor *saith, That our Faith in Christ gives us only the Right and Claim to Happiness; and when there is an Addition of Good Works too, we become capable of Possession*." *p. 88*. "*No sooner can a Man be justified, but forthwith he is saved in the same Instant. Then the Presence of Good Works* will not be *suffered in this Point*."

Here it is laid down as a Principle, That in Justification a Believer is put into present Possession of all Happiness: And hence it is inferred, That Holiness and Good Works are not necessary unto Salvation, because the Man is saved already before he can do them.

We find the same Reasoning in the Marrow, *p. 153*. "*And if it [the Law] yet reply and say, but Good Works must be done, and*

the Commandments *must be kept, if thou wilt obtain Salvation: Then answer you, and say, I am already saved before thou camest; therefore I have* no need of thy *Presence: For in Christ I have all Things at once, neither need I any Thing more that is necessary to Salvation*."

The *Marrow*, in these Words, does plainly deny the necessity of Good Works, in Order to Salvation, and that upon the *Antinomian* Principle, That a Believer is already saved, and needs nothing more that is necessary to Salvation: And therefore Holiness and Good Works, in his Opinion, are not necessary to Salvation.

If it shall be said in Favours of the Marrow, that he means only that Good Works are not necessary in the Case of Justification. I answer, (1.) He speaks expressly of the *Salvation* of the justified Believer; and so this Apology yields upon the Matter, That the *Marrow* confounds Salvation with Justification, as do other *Antinomians*; seeing he makes the justified Believer *to say, I am already saved, and need not any thing more that is necessary* to Salvation. (2.) From the Context it is evident, That *Evangelista* is speaking to his Convert *Neophytus*, as a justified Believer, and is teaching him from p. 150. how far he is delivered from the Law, as it is the Covenant of Works. And he supposeth several Cases and Objections, and instructeth *Neophytus* what he shall answer to each of them: As, *First*, In p. 151. he says: *Though hereafter you [being now justified] do through frailty transgress any of all the Ten Commandments, — and hear such a Voice as this*; If thou wilt be saved, keep the Commandments; or, Cursed is every one that continueth not in all Things which are written in the Book of the Law, to do them. In answer to this, He shows him, That God doth not now speak to him in the Terms of the Covenant of Works, or, that he is not under the formal Obligation of the Covenant of Works, requiring personal Obedience for Justification. In p. 152. He makes a second Supposition, *If the Law of itself should presume to come into your Conscience, and say, Herein thou hast broken me, and owest so much to Divine Justice,*

which must be satisfied: Then answer you, and say, O Law, be it known unto thee, that I am now married unto Christ. And so shows him, That he hath a Relief provided in Christ, against the Curse of the Law. But he doth not rest satisfied with the Believer's being delivered from the formal Obligation, and Curse of the Covenant of Works, unless he be also set free from the binding Authority of the *Moral Law*; For he supposeth a third Case, p. 153. in the Words above recited; as if he had said, If the Law presuming to come into your Conscience of itself, that is, without Authority and Commission from God, shall yet reply, Ay, though you be justified freely, and so no more under the Law as a Covenant of Works, to be thereby justified or condemned, yet the Obligation of the Moral Law of God the Creator strengthened by Christ in the Gospel, doth still lie upon you, and you are still bound to walk in Holiness of Life as the Way, though not the Cause, which God hath appointed for your attaining unto Eternal Salvation. This is plainly the Case supposed. Now, what Instruction gives he to *Neophytus* in this Case? Does he teach him to answer, True, the Moral Law doth forever bind all, and me a justified Person, as others, to the Obedience thereof, and that not only in Regard of the Matter contained in it, but also in Respect of the Authority of God the Creator, who gave it. And seeing he hath appointed Good Works done in Obedience to His Commandments, to be the Way unto the heavenly Inheritance; therefore it is my sincere Resolution, in the Strength of His Grace, to follow Peace with all Men, and Holiness, *without which* no Man shall see the *Lord*? Does he give him any such Instruction? No. But he teacheth him to take a shorter Way: Then *answer you*, (saith he): I am *already saved before thou camest, O Law*! *therefore I had no need* of thy *Presence*, to command and bind me, by thy Authority, to do Good Works, that I may obtain Salvation; *for I have already every Thing that is necessary to Salvation*. And this is the short Way of *Antinomians. Mr. Rutherford Survey of Antinom. Chap*. 41. p. 44, 45. represents and refutes this *Antinomian Error*. "*Antinomians* say, We are

completely saved in this Life, as in Heaven. So we think *Antinomians* fail wickedly, who say, We *are as actually saved, and as perfectly as the Glorified in Heaven*; and *not in Hope only, or in real Beginning, in Regard* of *Christ's sitting in Heaven: And* therefore Good *Works can no more be the Way to Heaven* (saith Towne) *than my walking in the City, in which I am already, can be my walking to the City*." *In* Answer to which Mr. *Rutherford* saith, That so, while we are absent from the Lord in the Body, even in this Life, we should be in Heaven: Whereas the Dissolution of our earthly Tabernacle, the raising of us up at the last Day, are between us and the full Redemption of our Bodies. *Paul* saith, We are saved by Hope, and we hope not for what we have already, *Rom. viii. 24. Our Life* is hid with Christ in God, *Col. iii. 3. 1 John* iii. 2. and to their main Objection, He *that believeth* hath *Life*, he answers, "Not in the complete and full Fruition. Yet, 1. Really in the certainty of Faith and Hope. 2. In the Right and Claim purchased by Christ. 3. In the Beginning Fruits, and in the Degrees of Grace, tending to Glory."

If it shall be further advanced in Defence of this Passage of the *Marrow*, that his Meaning is, That the justified Believer is already saved, not in himself, but in Christ; seeing he adds expressly as an Explication, *For in Christ I have all Things at once, neither need I any Thing more that* is *necessary to Salvation*. I own he says so, and *Towne* explains himself after the same Manner. *Assert*. p. 156. he lays his proposition thus, A *Believer is as well saved already, as justified in Christ, and in him*. And p. 158. he states the Question thus, *viz. Whether a Believer* may be *properly said to be presently saved in this Life* (that *is) in Christ, as I always said, for I hold no Perfection in the Flesh*.

Now, I would gladly know the Sense and Meaning of this, That a *Believer is already* saved, *and hath all Things at once in* Christ.

First, If the Meaning be, That Christ by his Obedience unto the Death, did purchase Salvation, and all Things necessary

thereunto; then it may be as properly said, That a Believer was saved about 1700 Years ago, when Christ, by his own Blood entered once into the Holy Place, having obtained eternal Redemption; and so he was already saved, long before he had a Being: Whereas, unto the proper Salvation of the Elect, there must be an Application of the purchased Redemption made unto them, else they cannot be saved.

Secondly, If the Meaning be, That a Believer is in Christ, and united to him, who is a perfect and complete Saviour, as by the Merit of his Obedience, so also by the Efficacy of His Grace; and so they may be said to be already saved, in Respect of Christ, who is the Cause and Author of complete Salvation. But neither on this Account can a Believer be properly said to be already saved, and to have all Things at once in Christ. It is true, a Believer is in *Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us* Wisdom, *Righteousness, Sanctification and Redemption, 1 Cor*. i. 30. But though Christ be the Author of these Benefits, yet they are not all given at once; a Believer is not perfectly sanctified in this Life, he waits for the Redemption of the Body, and for the purchased Possession, *Rom. viii. 23. Eph*. i. 14. Neither will it follow from this Meaning, that Holiness and good Works are not necessary to Salvation; for although all Things necessary to Salvation be in Christ as the Cause, Holiness may nevertheless be commanded as a Means to fit a Believer for the Possession, without which he is not saved already.

Thirdly, If the Meaning be, That a Believer is saved already in Christ as Head and Representative, and hath all Things necessary to Salvation at once in Christ by Imputation: This, (I own) I take to be the Sense of *Antinomians*, and of the *Marrow*, who *adds, Christ* is my *Righteousness, my Treasure, and my Work*, that is, as Christ's Righteousness is imputed to a Believer for his Justification, so Christ's Works of Holy Obedience are imputed for his Sanctification. This is another *Antinomian* Principle, upon which they reject the Necessity of Good Works: And therefore I shall consider it in the following Instance.

3. Antinomians confound Justification with Sanctification, and thence put off the Necessity of inherent Holiness. They hold, That in Justification, a Believer is freed not only from the Guilt and Punishment of Sin, but also from the Spot of it, and that he is sanctified imputatively by Christ's being holy for him. *John Eaton* in his *Honey-Comb*, holds two Parts of Justification: the first "being by the Power of God's Imputation clothed with the Wedding Garment of Christ's perfect Righteousness, that of unjust, we are made just before God; have thereby all our Sins, that we feel daily dwelling in us, so quite taken away from before God, and so utterly abolished out of his Sight, that we have not one Spot or Wrinkle of Sin, or any such Thing, in the Sight of God:" *And he describes the second Part, p. 257*. "*to be that whereby* we are without the Help of any Good Works to make us righteous, made perfectly Holy and Righteous in the Sight of God." And p. 169. "Evangelical Mortification is, Believing with the Heart, and confessing with the Tongue, That the Blood of Christ hath made us clean in the Sight of God from all Sin." And p. 171. "Yea, this very Opinion of mortifying Sin ourselves by the Spirit properly, out of the Sight of God, is the very Heart of Popery." John *Saltmarsh Free Grace*, p. 71. "All these Scriptures set forth Christ, the Sanctification and Fulness of His, the All in All. Christ hath believed perfectly, he hath repented perfectly, he hath sorrowed for Sin perfectly, he hath obeyed perfectly, he hath mortified Sin perfectly; *and all is ours*." *And p. 72*. "*We* are to believe our Repentance true in him, who hath repented for us; our mortifying Sin true in him, through whom we are more than Conquerors; our new Obedience true in him, who hath obeyed for us; our Change of the whole Man true in Him, who is Righteousness and true Holiness." And Mr. *Towne Assertion*, p. 118. "By Faith we being united and married to Christ, do by him bring forth Fruits to God, even by perfect Obedience imputatively, and inchoative Holiness, through the Operation of His Spirit." And p. 122. "Doth not Justification imply an Expiation and Abolition of Sin? — Christ did come to purge us

from Sin, and not from the Guilt and punishment alone, — and yet Sin remaineth in the Flesh, wherein is Imperfection." Thus we see *Antinomians* set up an imputative Sanctification, Christ hath repented, mortified Sin, and obeyed for them: And the Marrow joins in to the Opinion of his Brethren. For in the Passage above cited, from p. 153. to avoid the Necessity of Holiness and Good Works, from the standing Obligation of the Law, he teacheth his Convert to *say, I am saved already, for in Christ I have all Things at once that are necessary to Salvation*. Then Mortification of Sin, and Inherent Holiness, are none of these Things necessary to Salvation, for they are not wrought at once; Sanctification is a progressive Work. Imputative, and not Inherent Holiness is sufficient to Salvation; for he adds, *Christ is my* Righteousness, my *Treasure and my Work*: As Christ is his Righteousness by Imputation, for his Justification; so he is his Work imputatively, for Sanctification. And this appears yet more evidently to be the Mind of the *Marrow*, from what follows, ibid. "I *confess, O Law*! *that* I am *neither Godly nor Righteous*;" then he may want Inherent Godliness in Heart and Life, and yet have all Things necessary to Salvation. "*But* (saith *he) this I am sure of, that he is Godly and Righteous for* me." Here is imputative Godliness. Hence he concludes against the Necessity of Obedience to the Commands of God, or doing good Works in Order to Salvation: "*Wherefore* (saith *he) I will be bold to bid Moses with his Tables, and all Lawyers with their Books, and* all *Men with their Works, hold their Peace, and give Place: So that I say unto thee, O Law, be gone*."

Here he plainly casts off inward Holiness and Good Works from being necessary unto the obtaining of Salvation; and that upon the *Antinomian* Principle of imputative Sanctification: Whereas real Internal Holiness and Sanctification, is a Branch of our Blessedness, and Eternal Salvation.

The Orthodox Doctrine is mentioned by *Mr. Rutherford Survey of Antinomianism, Chap*. 16. p. 17. "Justification to us is not as *Antinomians* dream, an utter Extirpation of Sin in its Essence, Root and Branch: we judge Justification to be a

judicial and Law-removal of the Guilt or Obligation to Eternal Punishment, — it removeth Law-guiltiness to die, but not the intrinsical inherent Blot of Sin." *And p. 41.* "*Antinomians say, To repent and to mortify Sin, is to believe that Christ repented, and mortified Sin for us, and obeyed the whole* Law *for* us. — I must needs *say*, This is a shorter Cut to Heaven, and a more Honey Gospel than Christ and his Apostles knew. For they command us to mortify our Members that are on Earth, Fornication, &c. Antinomians free us from all personal mortifying ourselves, and put us on an imputative Mortification, to believe that Christ — abstained from Fornication and Lying, for us. This is to blow up all Sanctification, and to make Justification all:" See also p. 61. 4. Another Antinomian Principle is, That a Believer is not under *the commanding Power of the* Law; and therefore the doing of Good Works is not necessary by the Command of God. They hold, That a Believer is not only freed from the Form of the Covenant of Works requiring perfect personal Obedience as our Righteousness for Justification; but also from the Compulsion of the Law, from its Authority and Moral Force, binding to Obedience; and that on Account of Christ's having obeyed for him. *Saltmarsh Free Grace, p. 103*. "*The* Law can *only tell a Believer he sins, but not tax him for any*." *And p. 116*. "*The Gospel persuades rather than commands, exhorts rather than bids*," *p. 117*. "*The Gospel commands rather by Pattern than Precept, and by Imitation than Command*." *Towne Assert*. p. 3. tells us, That by the Law, a Believer is freed from, he understands *the* Moral *Law, or Decalogue, with all its Authority, Dominion, Offices and Effects*. And p. 140. "you say *Christ was the End of the Moral Law, because he obeyed the Law*, &*c. And what Christ performed for us, we are freed from: Now you are* within *that is, Christ hath freed us from Subjection to the Moral Law*."

The Author of the *Marrow* teacheth the same Doctrine, p. 153. above-cited. For having declared a Believer free from the Obligation to perfect Obedience for his Justification, and from the Curse of the Covenant of Works, which is true; he proceeds to bring in the Law commanding Good Works as

necessary to Salvation, and saying, "Ay, but Good Works must be done, and the Commandments must be kept, if thou wilt obtain Salvation." And in Answer hereunto, he teacheth his Convert to decline the Authority of the Law, and to refuse all Subjection unto it; for he bids him *say*, I am *already saved, I have no need of thy Presence, O Law; For in Christ I have all Things at once, neither need I any Thing more that is necessary to Salvation: Christ is Godly and Righteous for me. It maketh no Matter what I am, but what Christ my Husband is, hath done, and doth for me*. And so concludes with a rejecting of the binding Power of the Law, and a renouncing of Subjection to its Commands, saying, I *will be bold to bid* Moses, *with his Tables, and all Men, with their Works*, hold *their Peace, and give Place; so that I say unto thee*, O *Law be gone*, &c. And that the Doctrine of the *Marrow* frees the Believer from the commanding and binding Power of the Moral Law, I have evinced before at more Length; and though he saith, A Believer is under the Law of Christ, yet he makes that but the Matter of a Law, without any obliging Authority, or binding Force, as I showed already, from several Passages of the *Marrow*. See also p. 102.

In Opposition to this Doctrine, *Rutherford Survey of Antinomianism*, saith, p. 94. "We are not delivered from the Commanding, Directing, Obliging and Binding Power of the Law; as a binding Rule of Life, so as Believers, once being Believers, sin not; because they are under no Law. p. 95. The Law as it is an Instrument of the Covenant of Works, and justifieth or condemneth, ceaseth to be the Law to the Believer. — But it was never *Luther's* Mind, that the Law *Simpliciter* ceaseth to be the Law Commanding and Obliging to Holy Walking. p. 96. That the Law be urged in Tenor of a mere Covenant of Works, — is accidental to the Law, not essential. — But *Antinomians* will have the Gospel-Grace to loose a Man from all Commanding Laws, because he is pardoned; and because he getteth a Pardon for Adultery, Murder and such like, they conceive — he sinneth now against no Law; Hence

believe and be pardoned, (saith the *Antinomian*) and sin if you can."

5. Another Antinomian Principle is, that Sin in a Believer is not hurtful to him, nor displeasing to God; and if so, then by the Law of Contraries, his following Holiness, and doing Good Works in Obedience to God's Commands, is not necessary to Salvation. They hold, that Sin is quite abolished in Justification, not only as to Guilt, but also as to the Blot of it. *Towne Assert. p. 68. Dr. Taylor* chargeth this as an *Antinomian* Error, That the *Justified is freed from all Spot of Sin. Of this, saith Towne*, "*True* imputatively, *but that Sin and Pollution should not be in the Flesh, was ever denied and detested*." And p. *97. present Sins are become a Nullity with the* Lord; And *p. 96. That though the Just do sin objectively, yet God is not displeased nor angry with them. Saltmarsh, Free Grace p. 164*. "*No Sins can make God, who loves for ever and unchangeably, love us less; and yet a Believer will grieve for Sin; because it grieves the Spirit of his* God."

The *Marrow* teacheth the like, p. 154. "And if Sin offer to take hold of you, — then say you unto it; *Thy Strength, O Sin, is the Law*, 1 Cor. xv. 56. And the Law is dead to me; so that, O Sin, thy Strength is gone; and therefore, be sure thou shalt never be able to prevail against me, nor do me any Hurt at all." And p. 206, 207. "And therefore, whensoever your Conscience shall tell you, that you have broken any of the Ten Commandments, do not conceive that the Lord looks upon you as an angry Judge. No, assure yourself, that your God in Christ will never unson you, nor unspouse you; no, nor yet as touching your Justification and Eternal Salvation, will he love you ever a Whit the less, though you commit never so many or great Sins." Sins in Believers, though never so great or many, Blasphemy, Murder, Adultery, &c. are become very innocent and harmless Things; for in the Opinion of the *Marrow* they cannot hurt at all, nor will God love them ever a Whit the less. Godly Mr. *Rutherford* detested such Doctrine, *Survey of* Antinomianism p. 227. "But that when the Justified Person sinneth, whores, swears, kills the Innocent, — denieth the

Lord Jesus, as did *Peter and David, God* loves them as much as when they believe, pray, and walk in all holy Conversation; and that God is not a Whit displeased with the Saints for these Sins, because all his Displeasure or revenging Justice, was drowned and swallowed up in Christ's Sufferings, is to us abominable." *And* p. 60. "Sin pardoned to *Antinomians* and *Papists*, who are harmonious in this Point, are no Sins, Nothing, be it Adultery, or Parricide, or any Work of the Flesh committed after Justification, can be Sin; for it is against no Law, by *this Way*; and doth not so much as prejudge Salvation by Demerit: It only scandalizeth Men, but cannot offend God. *My Soul enter thou not into these Men's Secrets*."

If it shall be said in Defence of this Passage of the *Marrow*, that he doth not say absolutely, *God will not love you ever a Whit the less, though you commit never so many or so great Sins*, but with this Restriction, *viz. as touching your Justification and Salvation*: That is, no Sins of the Justified shall hinder their Salvation; Because God's Eternal Love and Unchangeable Purpose hath made a sure Connection betwixt Justification and Eternal Salvation. For it follows in *the Marrow, p. 207*. "*This is a certain Truth, that as no Good either in you, or done by you, did move him to Justify you, and give you Eternal Life; so no Evil in you, or done by you, can move him to take it away from you, being once given*." *I* answer, 1. That from this Gloss, it is still nevertheless the Opinion of the *Marrow*, that Sins of the Justified, be they never so many or so great, shall not hurt, hinder or prejudge their Eternal Salvation; and therefore, their abstaining from these Sins, their mortifying the Deeds of the Body, their studying Holiness in Heart and Life, in Obedience to God's Commands, are not necessary to their obtaining Salvation; they are not more requisite unto their Eternal Salvation, than unto their Justification in the Judgment of the *Marrow*.

2. It is true, there is a certain Connection betwixt Justification and Salvation; But there is also a Connection betwixt Sanctification as the Means appointed of God, and Salvation as

the End. And the Means ought not to be separated from the End. As it is true, that the Elect shall be justified and saved: So it is false, that they shall be justified, though they continue in Unbelief; Because God hath appointed Faith in Christ to be a necessary Means of Justification. Even so, it is false that the Justified shall be saved, though they live after the Flesh, and their Sins be never so many and so great; because God hath appointed Holiness to be a necessary Means of Eternal Salvation, and will exclude the Unholy as well as the Unbelieving, out of the Heavenly *Jerusalem*. For saith the Apostle, *2 Thess. ii. 13. God hath from the Beginning chosen you to Salvation through* Sanctification *of the Spirit, and Belief of the Truth*: Rom. viii. *13. If ye live after the Flesh, ye shall die: But if ye, through the Spirit, do mortify the Deeds of the Body, ye shall live. Gal. v. 21. They which* do *such Things* [the Works of the Flesh] *shall not* inherit *the Kingdom of God*. And *Heb. xii. 14. without Holiness no Man shall see the Lord. As* the justified Believer shall be saved, as surely he shall be inwardly sanctified, he shall be brought to repent of his Sins, to mortify the Deeds of the Body, and to be zealous of Good Works, in Order unto his Salvation. Now this is the Error of the *Marrow* and *Antinomians*, that they separate Salvation from Sanctification, and hold that a justified Believer shall be saved, though he be not inherently sanctified; (for imputative Sanctification they do allow of) and so disown holy Obedience to be necessary to Salvation. For, as I conceive, *he who commits never so many* and *great Sins*, lives after the Flesh; and brings forth the Works of the Flesh very plentifully, he does not mortify the Deeds of the Body, he does not follow after Holiness in Heart and Life; And *if God loves such a Man never a Whit the less, as touching his Eternal Salvation*; then, though he live after the Flesh, he shall not die; though he bring forth all the Works of the Flesh, he shall nevertheless inherit the Kingdom of God; though he do not through the Spirit mortify the Deeds of the Body, yet he shall live; and though he do not follow Holiness, yet he shall see the Lord; all which are contrary to the express Scriptures above-cited. This Opinion of

the *Marrow*, disowning any Necessity of Holiness and Good Works, follows from his Doctrine concerning Repentance; For as we showed before in *Chap*. V. he holds that Gospel-Repentance goes not before Remission of Sins; and as we showed in *Chap*. VIII. from p. 267, and 271, 273. of the *Marrow*, the Command to Repent doth not appertain to the justified Believer, it being the Voice of the Law, and not of the Gospel. And if a Believer be not bound to Repent, then he is under no Obligation to turn from his Sins, be they never so many or so great, nor to Purpose and endeavour after New Obedience. And hereunto agrees what *the Marrow* teacheth, Part 2d, p. 171, 172. He had said before at p. 167. "*God doth require, that every true Believer do purpose, desire, and endeavour to do his best to keep all the Ten Commandments perfectly*." This seems pretty fair, but turn over to p. 171, 172. And you'll find the Want of these made to be no Way hurtful to, or inconsistent with Eternal Salvation. Ant. saith, "But, Sir, what if I should not purpose, desire, and endeavour to yield Obedience to all the Ten Commandments, as you say, the Lord requireth, What then?" *Evangelista* answers, "Why then? although it is true, you have no Cause to fear that God will proceed against you as a wrathful Judge against a Malefactor, yet you have Cause to fear that he will proceed against you, as a displeased Father doth against his offending Child; that's to *say*, although you have no Cause to fear that he will unjustify you, and unson you, and deprive you of your Heavenly Inheritance, and inflict the Penalty of the Covenant of Works upon you, yet, &c." Here we have an Answer agreeable to the Antinomian Doctrine of the *Marrow*. But I conceive the Answer of the Apostle *Peter to Simon Magus*, would have been more suitable to the Case *supposed, viz. Acts viii. 21, 22, 23. Thou hast neither Part nor Lot in this Matter, for thy Heart is not right in the Sight of God. Repent therefore of this thy Wickedness, and pray God, if perhaps the Thought of thy Heart may be forgiven thee. For I perceive that thou art in the Gall of Bitterness, and in the Bond of Iniquity*.

When the *Marrow* supposes Corruption to remain in a Believer, and that he may commit never so many and great Sins; Whence is it that Sin can do him no Hurt at all, and that God loves him never a Whit the less, as touching his Salvation? The Answer will be, that they are no more the Believer's Sins but Christ's, the Believer having given them all to Christ his Husband, in Return for all the Benefits he has received from Christ, by Marriage-Union with him. *Marrow* p. 145, 146. "Wherefore, you being now married unto Christ, you must give all that you have of your own unto Him, and truly you have Nothing of your own but Sin; and therefore, you must give him that: I beseech you then, say unto Christ with bold Confidence, I give to thee, my Dear Husband, my Unbelief, my Mistrust, my Pride, my Arrogancy, my Ambition, my Wrath and Anger, my Envy, my Covetousness, my evil Thoughts, Affections and Desires, I make one Bundle of these, and all my other Offences, and give them unto Thee." And thus, 2 Cor. *v. 21. Christ was made Sin for us, that knew no Sin, that we might be made the Righteousness of God in him*. Here is an easy Way to get rid of Corrupt Affections and all Sins, a short *Way* of Mortification, but without Scripture-Warrant; for that Text, *2 Cor. v. 21*. is most impertinently applied, seeing it speaks of God's imputing, and not of the Believer's giving his Sins to Christ.

More Instances might have been given of other Errors *in the Marrow of Modern Divinity*; but these already treated of, may suffice for a Proof of the *Antinomianism* of its Author: I have showed that he agrees with *Antinomians*, in teaching that a Believer is not obliged to mourn for Sin; and that Faith is not to be tried by distinguishing Marks, seeing he makes Assurance, to be of the Nature and Essence of Faith. That he maintains the *Antinomian* universal Atonement, and makes Pardon of Sin to be prior to Believing, seeing he'll have the Sinner called directly to believe, that his Sins are pardoned; and so makes Justification by Faith, to be but declarative. That he denies, that true Repentance goes before Justification, and

that Ministers of the Gospel ought to call Sinners to repent or forsake their Sins, in Order to the Pardon of them; and holds that all Gospel-Repentance flows from a Man's Assurance of the Love of God to him, in pardoning his Sins; and that when a Man becomes a Believer, the Command to repent of his Sins, doth not appertain to him. That by his Account of his Threefold Law, of Works, *of Faith, and of Christ*, Faith and Repentance are excluded from the Commands of God. That he will have the Moral Law of Creation deprived of all Penal Sanction, before the Form of a Covenant of Works was put upon it. That under the Law of Works, from which he will have a Believer set free, he comprehends not only the Form of the Covenant of Works, requiring perfect, personal Obedience, as the Condition of Eternal Life; but also the Moral Law, as enacted and established by the Authority of God the Creator, and as delivered to the Church by the Angel of the Covenant from Mount *Sinai*: Yea, he comprehends all Divine Laws, which have any Authoritative Compulsion or Binding Force to influence Obedience, and which have Promises of Eternal Life, or Threatenings of Wrath, and Eternal Death annexed to them. And hence maintains, That a Believer is not under the Law, but is altogether delivered from it; That a Believer doth not commit Sin; That the Lord can see no Sin in a Believer; That the Lord is not angry with a Believer for his Sins; And that a Believer hath no Cause, either to confess his Sins, or to crave Pardon at the Hand of God for them, neither yet to fast, or mourn, or humble himself before the Lord for them. That the Law of Christ, in his Account of it, is a mere passive Rule, and the Matter of the Law, without a commanding, binding Power, to enforce Obedience from the Authority of the Divine Law-Giver; and without a Promise of Eternal Life, or Threatening of Wrath annexed to it. A Law, which commandeth no Moral Duty to be done, either for eschewing of Punishment, or upon Promise of Reward Temporal or Eternal. A Law which is delivered only to such as are in Christ, and doth not reach unto the Unbelieving Hearers of the Gospel. And a Law,

which neither justifies nor condemns. That he agrees with *Antinomians* in denying Personal Holiness and Good Works, to be necessary to Salvation; and maintains this *Antinomian* Tenet upon Antinomian Principles, in that he confounds Justification with Sanctification, which he makes Imputative, asserting, that Christ is Godly for the Believer; and in that he will have the Believer freed from the Commanding Power of the Law, so as Holiness may not be necessary by the Command of God, nor Sin in a Believer be either hurtful to him, or displeasing to God.

In detecting those Errors of the *Marrow*, I have suggested some Things to contribute unto the Vindication of the Fifth Act of the General Assembly 1720, and to show that they had good Ground and Reason to pass their Censure against that Book, when they found it so highly recommended, and industriously dispersed among People in several Parts of this national Church.

And though I think I have evinced, to the Satisfaction of every Judicious Reader, that all those Errors are contained in the recommended *Marrow*; yet I do not charge them all upon its Recommender. I am persuaded they are inconsistent with his former Principles and Profession; and I hope he shall never undertake the Defence of them. He'll rather choose to deny that the Marrow *teaches* those Errors; though even that ought not to be done against Conscience. By the rash Step of an ample Recommendation, he may think his own Reputation some Way engaged with that of the *Marrow*: But I hope he is acted from a better Principle, than to suffer his Concern for his own, or the *Marrow's* Reputation, wholly to prevail in him against the Zeal he owes to the Glory of God, and the Honour of Divine Truth; which he and every Minister of the Church of *Scotland* stand solemnly engaged to maintain and adhere to.

FINIS.